i like you a latte

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31464713.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra), Mara (She-Ra), Light Hope (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Deaf Character, Deaf!Adora, Pre-Law Student Catra, Sports Medicine Adora, Alternate Universe, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Fluff, Fluff and Smut, Fluff and Humor, Coffee Shops, Alternate Universe - Coffee Shops & Cafés, Alternate Universe - College/University, College, goal keeper Adora, it's a good gay time, minor glimbow, Eventual Smut, NSFW, Strap-Ons, Oral Sex, Fingerfucking, Nonbinary Catra (She-Ra)

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by sherassword

Summary

There that six foot goddess is, standing by the line of the goal, the game had paused while Scorpia was off of the pitch, so she was standing still but signing with someone who was standing at the sidelines beside the goal. She lifts the hem of the bottom of her shirt, revealing toned abdominal muscles and smooth soft looking skin as she does so. She uses the fabric to wipe her brow of sweat, giving Catra a generous view of her abs and the grey sports bra she was wearing.

Catra's breathing picks up so much she thinks she might die.

What Idubbed as COFFEE SHOP AU on T witter but is also kind of a college AU :) (Adora is Deaf in this AU)

Notes

Okay, so, Adora is Deaf in this AU. The first chapter is written entirely in Catra's POV but we will learn more about Adora and get Adora's POV later (next chapter actually). I really love the Deaf Adora HC and felt inspired to write this.

Just a few things to note, Catra and Adora speak in ASL but there are many types of sign languages out there. To make the fic more reader friendly I've simply made words that are signed italicised within speech marks. Whenever characters speak (who have previously signed) around Adora, they will always also sign their words. Sentences are not exactly what would be signed irl. I've done research, and my dad is hard of hearing himself, but I am not personally deaf so I defer to actual deaf

people on this and they can feel free to dm me on twitter or leave comments here if they believe there is something Ican fix/do to improve the fic in terms of Deaf culture relating to Adora.

Adora has been classed medically as severe to profoundly deaf since she was five years old, she communicates almost entirely through sign language except in very rare circumstances. She views her Deafness as something that is apart of who she is as a person. We'll find more out about Adora as the fic progresses.

Isee this fic being about six chapters in length, not entirely sure how updates will be since Ihave another ongoing fic but hopefully not too long between! Also, this fic is rated EXPLICIT , there WILL be smut in future chapters and tags will be updated in future chapters as well. This fic is mostly fluff though :) And I hope you enjoy these gays falling in love.

Anyway, please enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

coffee for your thoughts

And Idon't know how it gets better than this

You take my hand and drag me head first

Fearless

And Idon't know why

But with you Id dance in a storm

h my best dress

Fearless

- Taylor Swift, Fearless

Autumn

Catra sighs as she looks out of the window near the coffee machine. t was a slow day - probably because it was raining outside. Catra was *bored,* and she still had about two hours left of this shift. She was busy watching the orange leaves on the ground outside blowing around in the gentle autumn breeze. She had been sketching the scenery in her sketchbook that sat open on top of the metal table that the coffee machine sat on top of too. The rain was slowing down and the orange sun was starting to dip down, slowly setting. t doused everything in a beautiful and warm orange glow. Catra loved

autumn, it was her favourite season. The colours, the turn in the weather which meant it was just slightly cooler than summer , but not the freezing temperatures of winter , the days were only getting shorter by a little, it was the perks of summer and winter in one.

The bell above the door rings, signalling a new customer , Kyle was taking the orders and Catra was making the coffees, so she didn't bother to look up to see who it was. Truth be told, this job was temporary. Her scholarship - that she worked her ass off to get - plus her moms were helping her with the costs of studying, but Catra wanted to work a little just so she could have some spare cash to eat and do other stuff. Just some extra cash.

It wasn't that bad, it was a campus cof fee shop, so it was rare that they had customers who weren't students, which means significantly less Karens than if Catra worked in a chain restaurant like Starbucks. Still, sometimes she got some jackass customers, some ordering weird ass coffees that Catra's sure tasted awful but her job wasn't to judge - just make monstrosity of cof fees apparently.

Catra hears Kyle say something and she glances over to see what the hell was taking him so long to pass her this new coffee order when she sees what the issue is. "Oh, uh.uh.Let me see if we have some menus."Kyle says. Catra looks at the patron, and she almost drops her pen at the sight. She's *godly* . And she looks *sad* .

"Kyle."Catra says, shaking her head. "I got this."Catra steps up to the counter. The girl is seriously beautiful, her hair is tied back in a tight ponytail, with a poof at the front that probably belongs in the 80s, she's wearing a red and white varsity jacket with a pin on the

left side of the lesbian flag. Catra's eyebrows raise immediately at that. She's wearing a tight fitted white shirt, from what Catra can see, and her jeans are tight too, clinging to powerful thighs. She' s jacked and so *sexy* . Catra has never felt so gay in her entire existence.

" *Hi, I'll take your order.* "Catra signs slowly . t' s been a while since she's ever actually practised, her moms had taught her growing up, for situations like this she supposes. The girl *lights* up. She brings her hands up and begins to sign very quickly and excitedly . *Oh no, she's cute* . Catra blinks, she's moving too quickly for Catra to understand anything - and *maybe* she was distracted by those long slender fingers the woman is signing with. *Her nails are short too… Focus Catra!*

Catra holds her hand up after a moment. " *Sorry.* "Catra feels a little bad for interrupting. " *Can you go slower? I'm a little rusty.* "The woman nods enthusiastically. Despite the nod, she doesnt immediately start signing. Instead, she *stares* . Catra blushes a little from her gaze. Those baby blue eyes of hers were *gorgeous,* and Catra could see herself losing herself in their soft welcoming hue if she wasnt careful.

" *Sorry* ."The blonde signs, she' s moving slower now so Catra can understand. " *I got excited you could understand.* "Catra smiles at her and she's rewarded with a soft gentle smile back. Catra *swears* she just found the most beautiful person on this planet. She seems nice, soft, happy.

" *What would you like?* "Catra asks. She spots Kyle staring at them and she turns her head in his direction to glare at him. "Kyle. Go

clean some of the mugs.”She hisses. She doesnt like prying eyes. He scurries away qickly and Catra turns back to the woman with a smile.

“ *Nothing fancy,* ”The blonde signs. “ *Sorry to disappoint, just an iced latte, please* .”

“ *Name?* ”Catra takes the pen that she had shoved behind her ear and picks up one of the cups.

“ *You want to know my name?”* She asks. Catra watches her hands curiously as she sees the blonde stumble over a few of her movements, coming out a little clunky. She smiles at that. This girl clearly knows how to sign, has probably done it for years, yet she’s almost stuttering in her hand movements. t has the same ef fect as someone verbally stuttering. t’ s endlessly cute, and Catra likes that she clearly makes this woman nervous.

“ *For the cup.”* Catra explains. The woman’ s eyes widen in realisation and she blushes a wonderful crimson. She begins to spell her name out and Catra writes down each letter until she has her name. *Adora* . t’ s almost too perfect for her.

Catra gestures for her to wait at the end and then she goes about making the coffee. She doesnt bother to call Kyle back to help, she can handle this by herself, besides, it wasnt like anyone else was waiting in line. Catra can *feel* the blonde’s eyes on her. *Okay, so she’s a lesbian* , *that doesn’t mean anything* . Well, if you put aside

the fact that Catra finds her insanely attractive, and she would be writing her number on the blonde's cup right now if she wasn't currently making the latte for it.

Just because Adora was a lesbian did not mean that she was interested. Catra has plenty of gay friends, friends she hasn't dated, and friends she isn't attracted to, like Scorpia. Scorpia is her best friend and, while they'd maybe had a thing in the past, that had always felt kind of awkward - they were meant to be *friends,* not more. Now Scorpia has a girlfriend. The *point* that Catra was *trying* to make was that just because Adora was a lesbian didn't mean that she found Catra attractive, and Catra didn't want to take advantage of her barista position by scribbling her name and number down on her cup. Hell, maybe that wasn't even her jacket and the real owner of it was a lesbian. … *Yeah, that was probably a stretch.*

Okay. Cool . Catra could do this. No way one cute blonde girl was going to take her down. She pours the ice into the cup after pouring in the latte and then she turns around. Catra almost drops the damn cup. Adora *is* staring at her and, as soon as she notices that Catra is looking right back at her, she gets this absolutely *adorable* smile on her face.

Catra places the cup down on the counter, her hand lingering for a little longer than it probably needs to, before she steps back. Adora thanks her, and then she pauses. " *I like your nails* ."Catra glances down at her hand in slight confusion. Her nails were sharp, and Catra usually painted them black, but she hardly thought they were worth- Catra's eyes widen. Adora was referring to her index and middle fingers. Catra *always* kept those two clipped short - for *reasons* . She looks back up at Adora who seemed to be smirking knowingly. *Lesbian indeed* .

Catra thanks her and then Adora's smirk turns into a gentle smile. She thanks her *again* and then she goes to take a seat at one of the tables. Catra watches her closely. She places her latte down on the table and then removes her backpack. In gold lettering on her back was the name 'GRAYSKULL' and the number '01'. So she was clearly a jock then - Catra *maybe* has a type. Adora pulls out a laptop and sets it atop the table and then she pulls out a heavy looking textbook.

Catra has a sudden desire to follow after Adora, sit down across from her and just hang out with her. She has never felt this weird connection before, this *strong* of a connection. Catra sometimes has the tendency to be a little closed off, it's just a defence mechanism, she'd rather have people think she's a bitch then for them to get close to her and hurt her, but Adora. Something about her has Catra feeling goo-y right from the get-go. Catra puts on a hard front, but, in reality, her heart is incredibly soft. Maybe she just met Adora, but she knows that she has the potential to break Catra's heart.

She isn't sure what it is about her. Catra doesn't normally do relationships. Every single one she's ever had has fallen apart in the end. Usually she does hookups if she's feeling...well, *horny*, for lack of a better word. A girl has needs, and sometimes it's nice to just be with people, even if it is just for a night. The last serious relationship she had was Scropia and Catra had felt bad when she just hadn't felt that spark after a week of dating. And sure, Catra was physically attracted to Adora, she would drag her out back and make out with her and maybe more if she had the courage, but it was *more* than that. Catra knew it wasn't just physical. She wanted to get to *know* Adora.

Adora wiggles out of her jacket and Catra swears Adora knows exactly what she's doing. The white shirt she is wearing *is* fitted, and it hugs those toned biceps of her's so well. *Is it hot in here?* Catra can't seem to stop staring at her. She's kind of a stereotype if Catra is honest. She can see now, since Adora was playing with her ponytail, her undercut, her tight jeans are cuffed at the bottom, she's wearing canvas sneakers, her shirt is tucked into *high waisted* skinny jeans, not to mention her short nails. Catra's gaydar was practically a fire alarm in a drill right now. If the pin hadn't given it away, all of *that* definitely would have.

Catra is *so* regretting not writing her number on that cup.

Catra picks up her sketchbook and she starts drawing. She flips the page from her drawing of the landscape outside the coffee shop and focuses on Adora. She had a much prettier subject now. Adora was clearly *in the zone* and Catra still had a couple of hours left to kill in this dead shift.

She felt like some teenager, pining over some high school crush - *a jock no less* - but Catra really doesn't give a shit. Adora seemed so nice, so… *genuine*. That's rare. Catra sounds *insane.* She literally just met Adora and yet. She doesn't know what it is about her, she really doesn't, but it's *something*.

Catra spends about an hour sketching out various drawings of Adora, she even comes for a refill, happily signing to Catra. Catra figures out Adora is deaf, and not just mute, when *Kyle* drops a whole bunch of metal trays causing everyone to fall silent and stare

but Adora doesnt so much as flinch. Signing doesnt always mean deaf, but, it appears, with Adora, that is the case.

"Catra, it' s your last break."Kyle says nervously . Catra glances at him and then at Adora. She really doesnt want to leave, but her feet are kind of killing her and she doesnt want to invite herself to Adora's table without her permission. She nods and packs up her sketchbook, moving to the break room with her own iced latte and her phone. She decides to text Scorpia her gay panic, knowing her friend would have the advice she needed in this situation.

Wildcat

Here' s this really cute girl who just came to the cof fee shop.

Help.

Best Hugger

Oooo, do you have a crush? What' s she like? What does she look like? Are you going to ask her out?

Wildcat

Are you crazy? I'm not going to speak to her!

Best Hugger

Come on Wildcat! You deserve happiness too

Wildcat

Im perfectly happy .

Best Hugger

Just give her your number , what's the worst that could happen?

Wildcat

She could say no!

Best Hugger

Iwould buy you ice cream and watch movies with you if that happened.

Catra rolls her eyes as she types out her response to Scorpia. There was no way that Catra was going to ask Adora for her number. Scorpia continues to encourage her to do so anyway.

t' s not that Catra doesn't want to, she's just extremely afraid of rejection. At least when she hooks up with girls on one night stands she knows that they're interested in her , but if Adora was interested then surely she would have asked for her number herself by now? But, then again, Catra was into her and she hadnt exactly told Adora

that. She sighs as she looks at her open sketchbook. *Fuck it* . She'd do it.

Catra pockets her phone and returns back to the front of the store, determined to ask the blonde for her number when she sees the spot Adora had been occupying *empty* . "Kyle," Catra says, grabbing the boy by his apron. "Where did Cute- the blonde girl, who was sitting there, go?"

"Oh. She left." Kyle answers. "I think she asked where you went, I tried to tell her you went on your break and she looked sad and then packed up and left." He explains and Catra almost growls. Kyle was an *idiot* . He probably made her think that Catra's shift had ended and that she had gone home.

Catra lets the boy go and groans. So she definitely missed her shot there and now she might never get to see Adora ever again. Catra glances at her sketchbook. *Should've written her damn number on the cup* .

***

Catra is awoken at an ungodly time on a *Saturday* morning when her phone rings on her nightstand. Catra reaches out and grabs the device, lifting the phone to her ear while she tries to push her curly hair back and out of her face. "Whoever you are, I am going to kill you." Catra says, instead of the usual hello - but *seriously* , 7 am on a *Saturday* ?!

"I'm so sorry Wildcat," Scorpia sounds genuinely apologetic, and Catra has never been good at staying mad at Scorpia. Catra sits up and stretches her back, letting out a soft moan of pleasure as her muscles stretch.

"What do you want?" Catra asks. She still isn't fully awake, she needs roughly about two hours after waking up before she can start communicating with people - she especially dislikes being rudely awoken from her sleep when she thought she had significant more time. As a pre-law student, sleep is *precious* .

Catra sighs as she moves her curls out her face again, trying (and failing) to keep her bangs from falling into her eyes. "I forgot my left arm this morning when I left for practice," Scorpia begins as Catra stands up properly - *how do people just spring out of bed in the morning? They aren't human* . "I can usually manage, and I didn't mean to wake you-"

"It's fine, Scorp," Catra interrupts. "I'll bring it, but you'll have to text me where you guys practice."

"You'd know if you actually came to practice when I invited you." Scorpia says playfully and Catra rolls her eyes as she exits her room and crosses to the bathroom.

"Okay , well, that's just not fair ." Catra says as she sits down on the toilet. She's grown *exceptionally* close with Scorpia, to the point

where Catra has even gotten into the habit of leaving the bathroom door open when she goes to the bathroom - a habit that she's starting to break after Perfuma started staying here a few nights a week, sometimes for days in a week. Not that Perfuma was shy, she even did *naked yoga* in the living room and invited *Catra* to do a session. Catra had declined, but she really hadnt expected to see that before she left for her afternoon classes.

"You know Ilove you, but Idont love anything enough to sit through *sports* for." Not that Catra didnt value fitness, she just didnt derive pleasure from *watching* sports. She got the most pleasure from performing sports rather than viewing. She had once been a promising gymnast in her youth and teen years, but now Catra was just a casual gym goer - and strong advocate of embarrassing dudebros at the gym. Catra is aware her muscles may look lean, but she is *toned,* and her looks deceive her - she's bench pressed plenty of guys under the table before and she *adores* embarrassing them.

Scorpia makes a gasp on the other end of the line. "Did you just admit you love me?" Scorpia asks and Catra rolls her eyes as she stands up from the toilet and flushes it. It really must be early if Catra is making casual declarations of love.

"Shut up," Catra says, though her voice is soft and fond rather than carrying any signs of malice. "I'll bring you your arm, no worries, text me the address. Igot to get dressed though, might as well." Catra was awake now so she figured she may as well make the most of the day, get in some hours of studying and then relax for a few hours. She didnt have work today , so she didnt have to worry about that.

They say their goodbyes, Catra hangs up the phone and climbs into the shower, hearing her phone chime with the text from Scorpia. After Catra's failure at getting Adora's number, Catra had kind of sulked the past few days. Scorpia had asked for details, and Catra had given her very few, leaving out her name and sticking with a physical description.

She couldn't stop thinking about the blonde, it was like a disease. Catra has never really thought of herself as a *romantic,* or as a *pining* type of girl, but something about letting Adora get away like that, felt like a missed opportunity. An opportunity to try something for *real*. Or, at the very least, the opportunity to kiss a very tall, strong and sexy blonde.

Catra doesn't bother with getting seriously ready, once she'd showered, and feeling hygienically clean, she sets about getting dressed, throwing on an oversized hoodie, wiggling into her ripped skinny black jeans and pulling on her black combat boots. She grabs an oversized bomber jacket to throw over her hoodie in case it rained, or was cold, and then she ties her hair up into a messy bun of curls which she keeps out of her face with a red headband. She picks up Scorpia's arm from her room. She knows she's bound to get some strange looks, but she doesn't particularly care if she's honest, Catra has never really cared what people think about her and she isn't about to start now. Catra leaves their shared apartment, locking the door behind her, and she makes her way to the address that Scorpia had sent her.

And that is how Catra ends up at the university's fancy sports fields and stadium at about 7:45 am. Scorpia told her that they were on one of the soccer fields and, after a little bit of searching, Catra manages to track it down. She barely has time to look around before

Scorpia is yelling at her form the middle of the field "Wildcat!" Scopia calls, jogging over to Catra at the sidelines. "Thank you so much, oh my gosh, you're a lifesaver." Catra has no time to speak before Scorpia picks her up in her one arm in a tight *squeezing* hug.

"No problem, big gal, but can you please put me down."

"Oh." Scorpia says as she sets Catra back down. Scorpia is so tall, probably about six foot six, way taller than Catra anyway, and she's got *so many* muscles - Catra looks tiny compared to her. She offers Scorpia her left arm and Scorpia takes it gratefully, slipping it on so she had both of her prosthetics on.

"So." Catra says. "What are you guys up to?"

"We're just playing a friendly game," Scorpia says happily as she turns towards the field so Catra can see. "Hey, I can introduce you." Catra has no intentions of meeting anyone right now, and Scorpia's excited chatter becomes like background noise as Catra looks out at the field. BMU's soccer team was called Rebels, or something like that, and their uniform was light purple with white shorts and darker purples for the numbers, but the goalie- Catra freezes when she sees *her*.

Catra almost doesn't believe it.

There that six foot goddess is, standing by the line of the goal, the game had paused while Scorpia was off of the pitch, so she was standing still but signing with someone who was standing at the sidelines beside the goal. She lifts the hem of the bottom of her shirt, revealing toned abdominal muscles and smooth soft looking skin as she does so. She uses the fabric to wipe her brow of sweat, giving Catra a *generous* view of her abs and the grey sports bra she was wearing.

Catra's breathing picks up so much she thinks she might *die.*

She looks hot - literally and in the attractive sense - she's sweating, and her hair is a little loose from the game she's been playing, but she is so insanely attractive that Catra just can't stop *staring* . She's the goalie, so she's swearing gloves, and her uniform is white with gold to compliment;instead of short sleeves, she wears long sleeves, probably to protect her elbows or something, but she looks… *Incredible* .

Catra connects eyes with those baby blue eyes of hers and she actually *yelps* . She grabs Scorpia by her shirt. "Why didn't you tell me Cute Girl played for your team!?" Catra asks desperately - *is this what gay panic feels like?* Scorpia looks thoroughly confused.

"Who?" Scorpia asks as she looks up. "You mean Adora? You never told me her name."

“How did you know Iwas talking about Adora?”Catra asks - considering, currently, there was a whole field of girls to choose from.

“... Because she’ s jogging over here?”Scorpia says with confusion. *What?!* Catra turns sharply back towards the pitch and, surely enough, Adora was already half-way over to them. *Shit* . She shouldnt look that hot while just jogging across a field - that isnt fair.

Catra starts to panic for real but she manages to keep herself relatively calm on the surface as Adora stops at the sidelines. “ *Coffee girl.* ”She signs happily and Catra feels that panic absolutely evaporate at the sight of Adora’s happy expression and gentle, yet slow, hand movements. Catra spells her name out for Adora and Adora smiles. She signs her name back, finger-spelling it, before she nods. “ *I know. Your name tag*.”She explains. “ *Thank you for telling me.* ”Catra feels herself smile a little. “ *Scorpia is your friend?* ”She asks and Catra nods.

“ *Roommate.* ”Catra corrects and then Adora gets a *look* .

“ *Girlfriend?* ”Catra snorts and Scorpia looks at her with confusion - but she’s still smiling. Catra shakes her head.

“ *Friend. Best friend.* ”She signs again, making it clear that they were not romantically involved. “ *Jealous?* ”Catra teases, smirking a little as Adora becomes flushed.

“ *No. Curious* .”Adora signs but her soft smile turns into a small grin of amusement. “ *I wanted to ask you something?* ”Catra raises her eyebrows, signalling for Adora to ask what it was that she wanted to ask.

Catra suddenly felt nervous, she wasn't sure why - *Adora hadn’t even asked her anything yet!* “ *The team is going bowling next Saturday after the game* ,”Adora signs slowly and Catra can tell that she’s also a little nervous. Adora gives Catra the vibes of being a fast signer when nervous, but she’s consciously slowing herself down so that Catra can keep up with her, which is somewhat sweet and warms Catra’s insides. “ *Team bonding* .”Adora explains. “ *Would you be willing to come?* ”Adora asks. Catra blinks. W as Adora asking her on a date? Surely not if she invited her to hang out with her entire team..but then it kind of felt like Adora *was* asking her on a date - especially with her clear nerves.

Catra looks at her for a moment, taking in all of Adora, from the cleats on her feet, to the shin guards and grass stained white uniform, and she knows there is absolutely no way she is going to say no to this question. When Catra signs her next answer , she also speaks so that Scorpia can hear. “ *Sure, I can’t make the game but I assume you guys will go home and change before you go bowling? Scorpia can take me.* ”Catra says and signs, smiling when Adora nods in acknowledgement. Truthfully, Catra was interested in going to the game - which was a first - but she had work, which she knew only because Scorpia put her games on the calendar that they kept on their fridge.

“Oh, you're coming bowling, Wildcat”? Scorpia asks excitedly . As Scorpia starts speaking, without thinking, Catra starts translating. She doesn't even think about it, as soon as Scorpia speaks she begins to move her hands so Adora can follow along. Adora makes a sound beside them somewhere between choking and a sob and Catra turns to her in alarm. The blonde's eyes are shining and she looks somewhere close to crying.

" *Are you okay?* "Catra signs quickly in worry and Adora nods.

" *Thank you."* She signs, with a big wide smile. " *People don't usually do that,* "Adora gestures to Catra's hands. " *You actually involved me.* "That’s almost sad if Catra is honest. Just the simple action of signing speech someone else is saying around Adora has her looking like she might cry. *How often has Adora been excluded from things simply because she can’t hear?*

Catra nods and speaks as she signs, including all three of them in conversation. “ *Of course, I’ll see you next Saturday.* ”Adora *beams,* and it is the cutest thing that Catra has ever seen. How can one person be so genuinely *good* ?

“ *Can I get your number?* ”Adora asks and Catra nods with a smile. She assumes Adora probably doesn't have her phone on her so she hands her own phone over to her to let her type her number in. Once she’s done, she hands her phone back and Catra takes it. She sends a quick text saying ‘ *Hey Adora ;)* ’before she pockets her phone again with a smile.

They stand there for a moment, just looking at each other and smiling like giddy schoolgirls, before Scorpia interrupts. "We should get back before coach gets agitated." Scorpia says as Catra signs. Adora nods in agreement. Catra watches as Scorpia jogs away back onto the field.

" *I'll see you later, Catra.* " Adora signs and Catra agrees with a nod.

" *See you later, Adora* ." Catra finds that she likes the way that Adora's name feels as she spells it out with her fingers. Adora blushes a little and Catra doesnt really know *why* - maybe she is flirting *a little* but she wasn't aware she could project that through sign language, though she supposes that body language goes a long way too.

Adora hesitates before she turns and runs back out onto the field. Catra watches for a little, but she can tell her presence is somewhat distracting to Adora so she leaves. She feels warm and happy and *excited.* Yeah, there was definitely *something* about Adora.

***

Catra felt like a teenager again. Her shift ended just after the game should've ended and she'd hurried home to get changed and showered. This felt too much like a date for Catra, and she wasnt even sure it *was* a date. Scorpia comes home at some point, informing Catra that they had won the game while Catra stood in the doorway of the bathroom, her curls dripping and a toothbrush in her

mouth. Scorpia commandeers the bathroom after that, insisting that she needs a shower, and Catra makes her way to the bedroom. She hates to admit it but.she'd already thought out her outfit the night before and had laid it out just before she left. She was putting so much thought into this, and the closer it got to them actually hanging out the more butterflies Catra was experiencing.

She had spent the night before making sure she was ready in advance for her studies, so she could just enjoy her evening out, and she'd been texting Adora - *a lot*. She had learnt that Adora was a sports medicine major and that in the future she wanted to be a physical therapist, or a sports doctor specifically. Catra had told Adora that she was pre-law, looking to go to law school after undergrad at Harvard or Columbia. She'd also told Adora that one of her moms was from Colombia and the other was from Persia;she could speak Spanish, Farsi, English and she also knew sign language - plus, being pre-law, she knew how to read Latin too. Adora had called her a nerd but Catra knew for a fact that Adora was a *dork*.

She was funny too, like really funny, a teaser, her sarcasm was a perfect match for Catra. In fact, their personalities complimented each other almost perfectly. Catra has *never* fallen this fast for someone before, and she *is* falling. She thinks about Adora whenever they're not talking, she texts her at every chance she gets, she finds herself daydreaming about her, and about five pages of her sketchbook are full of Adora from this week alone.

God, she really was acting like some love sick puppy.

She dries herself down, blowing out her curls and then tying them back in a ponytail. Catra usually got her hair cut short in spring and then she let it grow out so that by winter it was about shoulder length, or a little longer, and could provide her with a little protection against the cold. Then she cut it short again in spring, rinse and repeat, she'd done it at first in her teen years when she'd first figured out she was a lesbian, it just became a pattern after that. Since it was getting closer to the winter months, her hair was touching her shoulders, and Catra preferred it be out of her face - at least definitely while bowling.

She steps into fishnet stockings that sit at her waist and then she wiggles into her skinny black ripped jeans - she liked the effect of the fishnets being seen through the rips - she then pulls on her sports top bralette that was black with a white band around the bottom and then she grabs her mesh top that Scorpia had gotten specially made for her that said "Wild Cat" across the front. The mesh top was a crop top, technically, and with the fishnets, and the bralette, Catra was showing off a generous amount of stomach - and those abs she had worked so hard to maintain. Lastly, she laces up her boots and then she adds minimum makeup, just eyeliner, before she exits her bedroom.

"Ready to go Wild-" Scorpia stops mid sentence when she sees Catra standing there. Catra suddenly feels a little self conscious. "Wow. you look"…

"Is it too much?" Catra asks with worry. "Should I go change?"

"You look great!" Scorpia says happily.

"You don't think I'm over-dressed?" Catra asks. If she's honest, she doesn't think she is but it seems as though she can't stop over thinking when it comes to Adora.

"No way! You look fantastic, Adora will be blown away." Catra scoffs as she picks up her keys and starts walking towards the door, Scorpia trailing behind her.

"Whatever, I didn't dress like this for her." Catra says. She locks the door after Scorpia exits and then they begin walking down the stairs to exit their apartment complex. She knows that her answer hadn't been very convincing, but Catra wasn't about to admit that she had a crush on Adora - not yet anyway.

They had decided to walk, since the venue wasn't too far from campus and thus their apartment. Scorpia starts to make conversation while Catra's nerves slowly crawl up and up and *up*. "What do you want to do for your birthday?" Scorpia asks, bringing Catra's attention back to her presence.

She was starting to get *cold*. The air had a chill to it tonight and Catra, admittedly, wasn't really dressed for the cold. "What we do every year, Scorp. Throw a party on Halloween and just combine the two." Catra replies. Her birthday wasn't on Halloween, technically, but having both parties in one was just a time saver. She didn't have to throw two parties, plus Catra loved Halloween - though the costume part could be annoying.

"Do you want to invite Adora?" Scorpia asks and Catra blushes. She grumbles halfheartedly at Scorpia before she hurries up her steps. Yes she did want Adora to come, but that was besides the point.

Catra is relieved when they enter the bowling alley. It's warm and it's also dark. The place was clearly built for students, at least this late at night, there were no families in sight, neon signs everywhere and the place was a restaurant/bowling alley hybrid - it even had a *bar*. Catra could see the soccer team down by the lanes, divided into groups, separated. Catra was suddenly nervous.

"Scorpia!" Catra knows that voice belongs to Perfuma. She skips up the steps and kisses her girlfriend and Catra steps out the way. "And Catra! Scorpia mentioned you were coming." Perfuma says happily. Catra really doesn't understand how one person can be so cheerful and positive all the time. Don't get her wrong, she's not negative *all* the time, but Catra has also never met anyone as positive as Perfuma. She just thinks it's healthy to have a *little* negativity in life. "Adora is down in the last lane."

"I see Scorpia told you something else too." Catra says, glaring at her best friend as she steps up to the counter for some shoes - she forgot she'd have to wear those god awful things.

"Sorry Wildcat," Scorpia says timidly as she too requests shoes. Catra begins taking off her boots with a huff. "I tell Perfuma everything."

I'm aware." Catra says, handing her boots to the guy behind the counter while she slips on the bowling shoes. "I *don't* have a crush on Adora." Catra says, unconvincingly . Perfuma gives her a *look* but she doesn't press it any further.

"Babe, Mermista and Sea Hawk want to play us in lane three, is that okay?" Perfuma asks.

"Oh, I" Scorpia looks at Catra and Catra rolls her eyes.

"Relax, I'm a big girl, I'll go find Adora." Catra says.

Once she's changed her shoes, she bids goodbye to both Scorpia and Perfuma and then makes her way down to the lanes. She was nervous. Like, *beyond* nervous. The place must have been booked by the soccer team beforehand, or they were insanely lucky that the lanes were free, because about half of them, if not more, were taken by team members - and Catra had seen a few eating in the restaurant.

Catra sees Adora before she sees her. She's talking to two people, one of who Catra doesn't know , the other. She knows. Adora is dressed in a white hoodie, her varsity jacket is on the back of the seat behind her and she's wearing those wonderfully tight denim jeans - Catra has to admit that her ass looks good in them, but you really can't blame her , she's gay and she has *eyes* . She's wearing

those stupid bowling shoes too. Seriously, bowling shoes? They were more like clown shoes if you asked Catra.

Adora turns and catches Catra's eye. She freezes for a half second before she seems to realise that Catra is *actually* there, then she turns to face her and gives her a wide bright smile. She starts to jog over to her and stops just a few feet away. "*You came."* She signs but Catra can tell from her movements that she's both excited and surprised.

"*I said I would*." Catra points out fondly.

"*You should be on my team*," Adora says with a smile. "*Glimmer and Bow*," She finger-spells those names, though Catra already knew Glimmer, she assumed the other person with them was Bow. "*want to do couples. You're my partner.*"

"*We're a couple now?*" Catra signs with amusement and Adora rolls her eyes fondly.

"*We are for tonight.*" That shouldn't give Catra butterflies but it really does. Adora offers her elbow and Catra takes it. "*You look good*." Adora signs and Catra feels her cheeks flush - thank *god* it was dark.

"*Thank you.*" Catra signs back. "*You too*." And Catra means it. Adora gives her simple dresser vibes, casual, pants and shirt and

she’s done, but it really *really* works for her. Now that they’re joined by elbows, Catra can *feel* Adora’s bicep below even the fabric of her hoodie - this girl could probably bench press *Catra* .

When they reach the lane, Glimmer’s eyes immediately widen when she sees Catra standing there, arm in arm with Adora. “Y ou.” Glimmer says, standing up. She signs her words so that Adora can follow along.

“Hey Sparkles, miss me?” Catra asks with a sharp grin. Adora, beside her, frowns softly.

“ *Sparkles?* ”She finger-spells and Catra laughs softly .

“ *Nickname* .”She explains.

“Annoying nickname,”Glimmer says and signs. “I can’t believe *Catra* is the girl you’ve been gushing about.”Glimmer says, looking at Adora. Adora blushes right from her neck to her ears and Catra finds the sight absolutely *glorious* .

“ *I-* ”Adora pauses her hands. “ *How do you know each other?* ” Adora asks. Catra notices that she didn’t deny the fact that she had been *gushing* about Catra. Every time Glimmer replies, she both speaks and signs. Catra is relieved that Adora’s friends at least appear to make an effort to involve the blonde;she'd been so happy

at practice that Catra had involved her in the conversation that Catra was worried.

"We had a class together," Glimmer explains and Catra nods as she takes a seat. "We got a little...heated." Catra snorts in amusement. Heated might be putting it lightly. In fact, they clashed almost completely, but Catra suspected it was probably because they were so similar and just as stubborn as each other. They had shared a class together in the first year and they'd argued and disagreed with each other on pretty much every topic. Catra secretly liked Glimmer, if they'd hung out beyond classes, she's sure they'd have the kind of friendship where they insult each other lovingly.

Glimmer was wearing denim shorts, a purple shirt that was somewhat of a crop top, and that had a tiny semi circle cut out of the chest (a boob window), and she was wearing a light blue and white Letterman jacket. Her pink and purple hair was down and ruffled. Glimmer is very pretty, Catra can admit to that, but it would never work between them - maybe a fling, nothing serious. Beside her is a boy who was looking at her with a soft expression. He was wearing a crop top, with a heart in the centre, Catra could make out what looked like the ends of scars on his chest, he was wearing jogging pants as well as a choker that also had a heart on it. "I'm Bow." He introduces himself and Catra takes his offered hand. Catra could already tell she liked Bow.

"So," Bow says happily as he signs his words. "Glimbow versus Catradora?" He asks and Catra laughs at the names. Adora nods enthusiastically and steps up to the machine to set up their game, imputing the dumb names Bow just gave them.

"How did you meet Adora again?" Glimmer asks as Adora was busy setting the game up.

"She came by the cof fee shop on campus, Iwork there sometimes."

"She really hasnt stopped talking about you all week." Catra feels herself blushing a little at that but she decides to let the topic drop when Adora turns around proudly after setting up the game. She puts her hands on her hips and *grins* . She looks downright adorable and Catra was right, she totally *was* a dork.

" *Do you want to go first?"* Adora asks Catra and Catra shakes her head.

" *You go* ." Catra says. Adora nods and picks up a bowling ball. Catra really has to stop checking out her hands - like she hasnt made it painfully obvious that she's a huge lesbian.

Catra watches Adora as she lines up her shot. "Fuck it," Glimmer says, distracting Catra. "Im going to give you the speech now ." Catra frowns a little as Adora *kisses* her bowling ball - yup really, *totally* , a huge dork. "f you hurt Adora, Iwill hurt you." Glimmer threatens and Catra rolls her eyes.

"Idont plan on hurting her , Sparkles," Catra says as she watches Adora move her arm back. "Besides, wee friends." *Were they even*

friends? Catra had literally met Adora only a week ago, and yet this felt *significant* .

"Just.treat her right. Then we wont have any issues."Glimmer says.

"She' s a grown up, Sparkles,"Catra says dismissively as Adora takes her shot. "I'm not going to hurt her and, if Idid, we could figure it out together."

"I know she' s a grown up but-"Glimmer 's words are cut off when Adora hits a strike. Catra grins so wide her face might get stuck that way if she wasnt careful. Adora throws her hands up in triumph and she gestures to the lane in a way to say ' *did you see that?!'.* Catra nods enthusiastically, smiling even wider - if that were possible - when Adora smiles so proudly at her.

" *I saw* ."Catra says and Adora puf fs her chest up proudly before she turns to Glimmer and Bow.

" *Suck it.* "She signs and Catra lets out a bark of laughter .

" *You're on Grayskull* ."Glimmer signs back as Bow stands to take his shot. Adora sits down beside Catra and turns to her with a big smile.

“ *Nice aim* .”Catra says to her . Adora leans in close.

“ *Thanks* ,”She signs. “ *I have* ***exceptional*** *coordination and precision.* ”Catra isnt sure what it is, but that all seemed kind of sexual, and like Adora was flirting with her, especially the way that her fingers kind of linger . Unfortunately, Bow is also a skilled bowler, and he manages to hit a strike too.

Catra stands and picks up a ball. She stops, staring at the thing, and she sees Adora shift out of the corner of her eye. “ *Want my help?* ” She offers. Catra knows how to bowl, but was she going to say no to Adora possibly putting her hands on her? *No* .

Catra nods and Adora stands up, following her to the lane. Adora lays her hand over Catra’s on the ball as she positions her arm. Catra gets goosebumps from her touch and she shivers a little. Adora is pressed to her back and Catra is starting to think this was an excuse by *Adora* in order to get to touch her. Catra can feel her hot breath brush over the back of her neck and then Adora pulls her hand back and gestures for Catra to bowl the ball. Honestly, Catra kind of forgot she *was* bowling;she was that distracted by Adora’ s body pressed to her. Adora steps back and, *yep,* that was totally an excuse just to touch her . Catra lines up her shot and manages to win them a spare but, in her defence, Adora kind of totally distracted her there.

They continue like that. Catra is actually having a good time, and she’s pretty sure Adora is flirting with her. Glimmer and Bow start kissing at some point and Adora pulls a face, telling them to get a room. Even Glimmer is okay. Catra gets the impression she’s

protective of her friends, and Catra can appreciate that, so she wasn't really that put off by her 'speech' at the beginning of the evening. Catra likes Bow too, he's nice and calming, he definitely keeps Glimmer's more chaotic tendencies in check, kind of like an impulse control, even though all three of these friends feel like they're chaotic when they're together - Catra's sure they've gotten up to no good together plenty of times before, you know, friend stuff.

"*No pressure*," Adora signs. "*But our victory rests on you getting a strike*."

"*No pressure?*" Catra signs sarcastically and Adora grins, nodding. Catra rolls her eyes as she steps up to the lane. She takes her time, lining up her shot, she takes a deep breath and then she bowls. She doesn't release that breath until the ball hits a *strike*.

Adora makes a sound of triumph and Catra lifts her arms up in victory as she turns to Adora with a big wide smile. Adora *picks her up* off of the ground and spins her around. Catra laughs the entire time, right up until Adora stops. Adora doesn't put her down right away, just holds her. Catra has her legs wrapped around her waist. They stare at each other. The air around them seems to shift, and Catra's hands somehow find their way to Adora's sharp and strong jawbone. She could just lean down, it would be so easy. She could just *kiss* Adora.

Their moment, however, is interrupted by Glimmer and Bow who walk up to them. Adora slowly sets Catra back down onto her feet and then Catra turns to Glimmer and Bow smugly. "Congratulations." Glimmer says and signs.

“ *Would you like a drink?* ”Adora asks Catra. Catra nods and grabs Adora’s sleeve before she could leave.

“I think the losers should buy .”Catra says with a smirk. Adora lets out a small huff of laughter and Glimmer groans. Both Bow and Glimmer give them money to buy drinks and Catra happily takes it, making a show just to rub their win in that little bit more, before she accompanies Adora to the bar. Catra orders the drinks, non-alcoholic since she wasn’t quite twenty-one yet - just another couple of weeks - and then she turns to Adora while they wait.

“ *So, we make a pretty good team* .”Catra points out and Adora smiles.

“ *Yes we do* .”Adora agrees and Catra plays with the change in her hand before she shoves it into her pocket. “ *You look really,* ”Adora emphasises her movements when she signs ‘really’ and Catra feels a smile tug at the corners of her lips. “ *Good* .”

“ *You said that already* .”Catra points out with great amusement.

“ *I wanted to say it again* .”Adora smiles and Catra rolls her eyes but, she has to admit that, Adora’s words do make her heart speed up a little in her chest. They take Glimmer and Bow drinks and then they retreat back to the restaurant. Adora orders them a bowl of fries and they share it between them.

“ *Favourite animal?* ”Catra asks.

“ *Horse* .”Adora answers and Catra raises an eyebrow at her .

*“Horse ”?*She signs again in question and Adora nods quickly . “ *What are you? A country girl?* ”Adora lets out a little sound of laughter before she begins signing again.

“ *What? Didn’t get that from my accent?* ”She asks and Catra lets out a loud bark of laughter that has people looking at them. When Catra manages to rein her laughter in, she sees Adora looking at her with shiny eyes, she looks soft, and so happy, then she begins to sign again. “ *I like making you laugh* .”Catra isn't sure what it is about that that makes her feel so completely *warm* .

They enjoy each other ’s company, making casual conversation. As it turned out, Adora really was a country girl. She told Catra that she knew how to ride a horse, and swore she’d take Catra to a *ranch* her foster mom had taken her to when she was younger. That was something else Catra had learnt, Adora hadn’t gone into super detail, and Catra didn’t want to depress her by forcing her to go into detail, but Adora was fostered - Catra figured Adora would tell her more one day when she felt comfortable.

Catra didn’t even know how much time had passed until Scorpia told her she was leaving and staying at Perfuma’s and to not wait up for

her. She checks her phone to see it was almost midnight. “ *I’ll walk you home* ”Adora of fers. Catra shakes her head.

“ *I don’t want to put you out* .”

“ *It’s no problem* ,”Adora signs dismissively . “ *I can’t let you walk home alone.* ”Catra wants to protest that she is completely capable of walking home alone but she would feel safer having someone with her.

“ *Fine,* ”Catra concedes. “ *But only if I get to return the favour in the future* .”Adora smiles brightly and nods. She goes to retrieve her jacket and say goodbye to her friends before they exit the bowling alley together.

As soon as they step outside, Catra realises that the chill has only gotten chillier. She wraps her arms around herself and tries to hide her shiver. She fails miserably. Without saying a word, Adora reaches over and places her jacket over Catra’ s shoulders. Catra wants to protest, but Adora just gives her a serious look that tells her she should just accept the jacket. So she does. Catra wraps the thing around her tightly, letting the warmth of Adora, warm her too. She sinks into the fabric as they walk the short distance to Catra’s apartment building. They walk in silence, but Catra is stunned by how *not* weird it is.

Catra only expects Adora to walk her to the outside of her building but she follows her inside and up to her front door. Catra turns to her

when she reaches it and gestures. “ *This is me.* ”She tells Adora as she begins to shrug off the jacket, but Adora shakes her head.

“ *Keep it* ,”She signs. “ *Give it back to me some other time.”* Catra sinks back into the jacket, feeling warm for so many more reasons than just the jacket on her shoulders. That meant that Adora wanted to see her again.

That tension from when Adora had lifted her in the bowling alley comes back tenfold. It’ s like they’re opposite ends of a magnet, and Catra feels *pulled* towards Adora in a way she has never felt before. Adora lifts her hands.

“ *Can I* ”.She pauses her movements before she continues. “ *Kiss you?* ”Catra takes a sharp breath in at the question. *Adora just asked to kiss her!* Catra really was having a gay panic now. It takes her a moment to fully recover from the question before Catra nods her consent. Adora moves towards her and Catra leans against the door for support.

Adora enters her space slowly, Catra lifts her hands to grip at the material of Adora’s hoodie. They stay like that for a moment, with Catra trapped against the door, her hands gripping Adora’s hoodie, and breathing each other’s air, before Adora leans in to close the tiny space between them.

It’ s *incredible* .

Catra can't even begin to express how the kiss makes her feel. It makes her feel *alive*, she imagines it feels like seeing colour for the very first time - like she was seeing in black and white and Adora kissing her made her see *every* shade. Adora breathes life back into her through that kiss. Her lips are soft, and they taste like cherry from her coke that she'd had at the bowling alley. Catra thinks she could kiss Adora forever and it still wouldn't be enough.

Catra moves her hands up Adora's body and then slides her fingers into her soft blonde tresses. Adora makes a low noise of approval as she turns her head to the side to kiss Catra at a new angle. Catra has *never* been kissed like this - not even by past girlfriends - Adora is a perfect mix of soft and gentle to hard and firm.

She lifts her hands to gently cup Catra's jaw as her lips move skilfully against Catra's. Catra feels like she might be melting, the kiss is that good. She seriously doesn't want it to stop, and she drinks *all* of Adora in - as much as she possibly can. She wants to drag Adora inside and kiss her all night;she wants to burn this memory into her mind for an eternity. Catra wants to part her lips, taste Adora on her tongue, but she thinks that might be a bit much for a first kiss.

When they finally do part, Catra is left absolutely *breathless*. Adora stays close, holding Catra's face in her hands while she presses their foreheads together. They stay like that for a moment before Adora actually *speaks*. "Wow." She says in a low whisper, but Catra hears it all the same. Catra laughs softly and leans forward to peck her on the lips. Adora's voice is sweet, soft, she spoke quietly but it was still like music to Catra's ears.

She would like nothing more than to keep kissing Adora, but it's getting late and the blonde should probably get back home. Catra leans back and Adora reluctantly stands up straight. " *Wow* ."Adora signs this time and Catra cant help but laugh again. " *I'd like to do that again* ."

" *If you're lucky* ."Catra responds playfully , but she's pretty sure her flushed cheeks tell Adora that she enjoyed that just as much as Adora seemed to enjoy it too. Adora' s hair is a little ruffled from Catra's fingers, and her cheeks are a pretty pink, but her smile is what has Catra's heart hammering in her chest. She looks so completely happy. " *I'll see you around Adora* ."Catra signs and Adora nods.

" *Text me* ."Adora signs back.

" *I will* ."Catra promises. " *Text me when you get home* ."Catra wanted to be sure that Adora made it home safely. Adora's smile turns into a half smirk that is entirely too sexy.

" *What? Worried about me* ?"Adora asks and Catra rolls her eyes.

" *Just don't want you to get murdered and it be my fault* ."

" *Ouch* ."Catra rolls her eyes fondly and shoves Adora' s shoulder as she turns towards her door and begins to unlock it. She turns back to see Adora watching her carefully. She decides one more kiss wont

kill her. She grabs the front of Adora's hoodie and yanks her in for one more kiss before she pulls back. " *Bye Adora* ."Catra signs, grinning when she sees Adora's completely bewildered look on her face. Adora lets out a huff of laughter.

" *Bye Catra* ."Adora actually does leave after that. She turns on her foot and walks down the stairs to exit the building. Catra watches her go before she opens her apartment door and slams it shut by leaning back against it. She slowly falls to the ground, leaning against it. She was so completely whipped by Adora, *already* .

"Fuck my life."Catra murmurs to herself as she buries her nose into Adora's jacket and smells *her* . "Adora Grayskull. Where the hell have you been my whole life?"Catra asks no one in particular . Whatever they were now after that kiss, Catra was determined it wouldnt be their last. They *would* kiss again, they *would* see each other again. Adora Grayskull walked into Catra's coffee shop one day, and she completely captivated her. She planted a seed in her heart and rooted herself there.

Yup, Catra was *screwed* .

canvas sneakers in the snow

Chapter Summary

> There's a long stretch of nothing before Adora begins to sign again. "Happy birthday."Catra actually smiles at that.
>
> She moves up and leans against the corner of the balcony instead, turning towards Adora. "It's not my birthday."Catra points out. Adora already told her happy birthday on her actual birthday, and she'd even given her a gift, despite the fact that they'd only known each other for a couple of weeks and Catra would not have held it against her if she hadn't. Adora turns to face her with a playful grin.
>
> "Then Happy Not Your Birthday."She signs. "Happy Halloween." Catra rolls her eyes fondly, a smile tugging at the corners of her lips.
>
> "Happy Halloween."Catra agrees and then she drops her hands.

Chapter Notes

> Coffee Shop AU is back with another chapter !! I hope y'all enjoy this update, it's kind of chunky but full of fun gay times. Thank you all so much for the comments/kudos on the first chapter, it meant the world to me <3!
>
> Anyway, please enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

if the tide takes California

I'm so glad I got to hold ya

And if the sky falls from heaven above

Oh, Iknow Ihad the best time falling into love

We've been living on a fault line

And for a while, you were all mine

Ive spent a lifetime giving you my heart

Iswear that Ill be yours forever

'Til forever falls apart

- Till Forever Falls Apart, Ashe & FINNEAS

AutumnW inter

The music was too loud. They were probably going to get a noise complaint at this rate, but it was also Halloween, and half of this building, maybe more, were students anyway, so Catra wasnt too worried about it. She *was* worried about *something* , however. That kiss in her apartment hallway wasnt their last kiss afterall. They kissed a lot - like, a lot. Any time they were left alone, they ended up kissing. Catra wasnt really sure what they were. Friends, maybe? Friends who kiss each other? *Do just friends kiss each other?* Catra knew that she *liked* Adora, in a way she hasnt liked someone in a very long time, but she just wasnt sure what to do with it.

Catra downs the alcohol in her red cup. She could finally legally drink, twenty-one, she's an adult, but she still can't seem to find the courage to tell a girl that she likes her. They text all the time too. Whenever they can, they hang out, they share stories and Adora makes Catra *laugh* - like, *really* laugh, not the fake laugh Catra does sometimes.

Catra had invited Adora to her birthday/Halloween party, but she wasn't sure she was going to come. Who was Catra kidding? It was *Adora,* of course she would come when she said she was going to. That's why Catra was on her third drink by now. She was leaning on the island between the kitchen and the living room, watching people from her classes dancing, drinking, making out, and all she can think about is a pretty blonde girl who may or may not like her.

Sure, Adora kisses her back just as eagerly as Catra kisses her , Adora even initiates a lot of the kissing, but did that mean that Adora liked her? Not necessarily . Then again, they hadn't gone further than kissing. If Adora was only interested in less than innocent things, and no friendship, surely she would have made a move by now? Adora doesn't strike Catra as a no strings attached sex kind of person, but then why are they in this weird limbo space?

Maybe Catra was getting ahead of herself. It had only been two weeks since the bowling alley. She just doesn't know how these things are *supposed* to go. What is too fast? What's too slow? What if Adora doesn't like her at all? Sometimes Catra doesn't even like herself, why would she expect someone as… *amazing* as Adora to like her? *Okay, the self-deprecating thoughts probably aren't the most helpful right now.*

With Scorpia, things had been kind of fast, but that was different, wasn't it? Catra had tried so hard to see Scorpia as more than a friend but it had felt... wrong? Weird? Clunky. Kind of like, all the pieces were there, Catra loves Scorpia a whole lot, but she could never see herself kissing her (though she had), or going further (which she had not), all the pieces were there, but Catra just couldn't force them into the shape of a *relationship*. They were best friends. Catra had felt so guilty, she felt as though she had led Scorpia on and then... their relationship kind of entered an awkward phase after that, but that was a long time ago now. Now they were perfectly comfortable in the best friends definition, and roommates - though, given how often Scorpia spent at Perfuma's, Catra might have to look for a new roommate next year.

With Adora, things are *different*. For one, they didn't have an established friendship. They were strangers basically, though Catra liked to consider them at least as friends by now. Catra has always found it hard to make friends, so she doesn't really know when someone stops being an acquaintance and becomes a *friend,* but they've been texting everyday for the past two weeks. Catra has learnt a substantial amount about Adora, including what Adora's *tongue* tastes like, so she thinks it's safe to assume that they're at least friends by now.

Secondly, they clearly both find each other attractive. Adora will kiss Catra just as much as Catra will kiss her. There is this… *energy* between them that has been lacking in Catra's past relationships. They are attracted to each other like the opposite ends of a magnet, they go together like... things that go together; coffee and cream, peanut butter and jelly, bread and butter... Maybe Catra was hungry. The point is, they *work*. Catra feels comfortable with Adora, and she *really* enjoys kissing her.

Truthfully, Catra could see herself being with Adora - romantically that is. She just can't get a read on *Adora* . For someone so smiley and open, and clearly confident, Adora is not so forthcoming when it comes to her feelings. Sometimes Catra wonders if she even knows herself. She can't really explain it, she' s seen Adora with her friends, Catra doesn't really feel like a *friend* when she thinks of it like that but then if Adora did like her, like Catra said, wouldn't she have mentioned it by now? Then again, it wasn't like Catra had mentioned it either. She should just stop over thinking this. Catra likes to think that her mind is one of her greatest attributes, but sometimes it is her greatest hindrance. Someone walks by her with a tray of shots and Catra steals one, downing it and grimacing when the liquid burns her throat. *Shit* . Alcohol didn't even taste that nice, why do people do this? *Oh right, to get drunk.*

Before Catra can get too drunk, the woman of the hour shows up. Catra's eyes land on her immediately. She's dressed like a fucking *knight* . That outfit should not be this attractive and yet. Catra finds herself wanting to rip her fake armour off of her and drag her to the bedroom. God, she needs to get a grip. Catra slides down the cabinets, hiding away from Adora and sitting on the floor with her legs pulled up to her chest. Maybe drinking so much was a bad idea.

Catra gestures to someone in her kitchen to hand her another shot and they do so. Catra downs it and then sighs. She feels hot, but she suspects it's from the alcohol - maybe from seeing Adora too. She wonders how long it will take for Adora to find her.

Catra is sometimes a runner. She isn't really sure where she picked that up from. Don't get her wrong, she'll stand up to anyone, hold her ground on things she believes in, and she can be as stubborn as

they come, but when it comes to emotions? Catra sometimes has the urge to just run. They're scary and confusing, and sometimes Catra would rather just ignore them than face them.

Unfortunately, Adora has other plans. She finds her relatively quickly and Catra doesn't move from her sitting position on the ground as she looks up at the tall blonde. Adora crouches down in front of her. "*You okay?*" She signs and Catra takes a deep breath. She felt like she might throw up, but she didn't know if it was from nerves, or the alcohol she had drunk.

"*Fine.*" Catra signs back but Adora doesn't look convinced. Still, Adora doesn't push her. That's something else that Adora does that Catra appreciates: she doesn't push. Catra is obviously not fine - she's sitting on her kitchen floor in the middle of her *birthday* party - but Adora just nods at her and doesn't pressure her to go on. She's patient. Catra doesn't like being cornered, or forced to say things before she's ready, so she really appreciates that quality in Adora.

"*Is it too loud?*" Adora asks. "*I can feel the music.*" Catra laughs a little and Adora smiles back at her. "*I'm serious,*" She carries on signing. "*I can usually feel music, that's how I experience it, but this is making my skull rattle.*" Maybe Adora was right, maybe it was a little too much.

"*I could use some air.*" Catra admits and Adora nods.

“ *Balcony?* ”Adora asks. Catra nods and then Adora helps her to her feet. Adora holds a finger up to signal for Catra to pause, she fills up a glass of water and then she comes back to Catra so they can make their way over to the balcony’- which was actually jµst the fire escape.

When they get to the window Catra sees a bunch of people hanging out on the fire escape, smoking cigarettes and drinking beer. She hisses at them to beat it and they all do so without protest. Catra then climbs outside, helping Adora and she closes the window behind her.

Now the music was jµst a muf fled thump and Catra could finally *think* . Adora hands her the glass of water and Catra takes it gratefully, signing her thanks before she takes two big gulps of water. She feels better already. t’ s pretty chilly out, but not uncomfortably so, it’s *refreshing* and Catra feels less overwhelmed on this balcony with jµst Adora.

She sighs as she picks up an unlit cigarette on the metal railing. She can feel Adora watching her closely but she doesnt say anything, she silently watches and comforts her with her presence. Catra feels like she may be acting dramatic. Was this really a meltdown over if Adora liked her or not?T ruth be told, Catra feels *weird* . She gets like that sometimes, when she doesnt know how to explain her feelings other than weird. t’ s a feeling she cant describe other than that, but she hates feeling it.

She turns to Adora with the cigarette and offers it to her. “ *I don’t smoke* .”Adora declines, shaking her head.

“*Why*?” Catra asks, mostly out of curiosity. Adora gives her a *look* and then points to herself before she signs.

“*Sports medicine*,” She emphasises her moves on the word ‘medicine’. “*Major*.” Yeah, that makes sense. Adora studies medicine, she probably knows all the health issues related to smoking. It's not like Catra smokes anyway, she just liked to take every opportunity to learn something about Adora. Catra flicks the thing over the edge of the balcony and watches as it falls to the ground. They just stand there for a long moment, with Catra leaning against the railing and staring at the ground and Adora standing in the far left corner.

After a while, Adora comes over and leans against the balcony beside Catra. She begins to sign and Catra watches carefully. “*Want to talk about it*?” Catra sighs and then shakes her head ‘*no*’ and Adora doesn't push any further. There’s a long stretch of nothing before Adora begins to sign again. “*Happy birthday*.” Catra actually smiles at that.

She moves up and leans against the corner of the balcony instead, turning towards Adora. “*It’s not my birthday*.” Catra points out. Adora already told her happy birthday on her actual birthday, and she'd even given her a gift, despite the fact that they'd only known each other for a couple of weeks and Catra would not have held it against her if she hadn't. Adora turns to face her with a playful grin.

“ *Then Happy Not Your Birthday.* ”She signs. “ *Happy Halloween* .” Catra rolls her eyes fondly, a smile tugging at the corners of her lips.

“ *Happy Halloween* .”Catra agrees and then she drops her hands. She turns to Adora.

The knight costume suited her but it really screamed *dork* . Then again, Catra is sure Adora would look amazing in just about anything. Catra has seen her literally *covered* in mud and sweat from practice before and she still made out with her in the locker room. Still, Catra wouldnt have been opposed to seeing Adora in a fireman costume, or something else where she could see her muscles rather than bulky plastic fake armour. Adora is a dork anyway, which means her costume was *perfect* .

Adora moves from her position and comes to stand in front of Catra. Catra looks up at her curiously as Adora reaches her hand out for Catra’s fake tail. She runs her hand along it. “I like your outfit.” Adora actually *speaks* to Catra and Catra feels her heart hammer in her chest.

Adora rarely speaks, Catra knows that she doesnt like it because she cant hear what she’ s saying, or how she speaks, so Adora speaking to her means that she *trusts* Catra. t must be a weird sensation, to know you're saying something but to be unable to hear what you're saying. Catra reaches her arms up and loops them around Adora’s neck, her thumb resting where her hair met her neck, she rubs gentle circles into her skin and Adora *melts* .

When Catra speaks, she speaks slowly so that Adora can carefully read her lips. ”Thank you.” Catra says. ”It’s a pun.” On her name that is. Catra, dressed as a catgirl or whatever, she thought it was ironic. Adora smiles and then they both pause. The air around them becomes static, thick and full of *something* . It’s *electric* . And then they’re kissing again.

Catra knows her tongue must taste of alcohol but Adora doesnt seem to care. She’s pretty sure this hadnt been Adora’s plan when she’d asked her out here, but they always seem to end up making out - so it shouldnt be that much of a shock. Adora lifts her up and rests Catra on the railing of the fire escape, Catra wraps her legs around Adora’s waist to keep herself steady. She moves one of her hands to Adora's sharp jawbone and the other she leaves resting on her shoulder as she turns her head to the side to kiss Adora at a better angle. Adora’s hands stay firmly on Catra’s sides before she runs them to her back and up in a caress that has Catra shuddering.

Yep, Catra is *never* going to get tired of kissing Adora. That is either going to be a huge problem, or not, depending how Adora feels.

Catra would’ve spent all night making out with Adora in the setting sun, in the chilly autumn weather that was progressively getting colder as they got closer to winter, but they’re rudely interrupted by someone opening the window. Catra leans back and Adora seems to take that as an invitation to kiss Catra a different way but Catra shakes her head. Adora pauses, staring into Catra’s eyes. God, Catra loves the soft blues of Adora’s eyes, they’re like a comforting blanket that Catra could just wrap herself up in.

It takes her a *moment* to compose herself, and then she moves her head to peer over Adora's shoulder. Adora hadn't heard that they had company, but Catra was very aware of it. "Damn Catra, didn't know you were the type to make out with blonde jocks at your own birthday party." Catra scowls at Lonnie. Lonnie was one of her classmates, also pre-law. Catra liked Lonnie, but she surprisingly found her irritating when she decided to interrupt Catra's very *nice* make out sessions.

"Lonnie, literally fuck off." Catra hisses though she forgets her train of thought when Adora kisses her on the *neck* . Adora has never kissed her there before, and, even though it was just a brief kiss, it sends a spark right through Catra in a way she has *never* experienced - if she actually did have a tail and ears they'd both be *up* right now and her fur would be standing on end.

"Shit, get it girl." Lonnie says with a laugh. Catra flips her off behind Adora's back as she tilts her head back to allow Adora to keep kissing her on her neck - which Adora does so eagerly. "Can you take this to your bedroom? Some people actually want to smoke."

"So go out the front door ." Catra says with great irritation as her hands slide up to Adora's hair. She threads her fingers through her soft blonde locks and lets out a satisfied moan.

"Are you really about to have sex on the balcony?" Lonnie asks. Catra growls in frustration. Normally her answer would be no, but with the way Adora is kissing her? Catra can already feel her building desire - especially with the way that Catra is pressed up against Adora's hard stomach. Part of Catra wants to say *yes* to

Lonnie, and let Adora put her hands down her pants, but Lonnie is right.

Catra sighs and taps Adora on her shoulder gently. She leans back and blinks at Catra. “ *Let's go inside.* ”Catra signs and Adora nods her head. Catra hops down from the metal railing and then she grabs Adora’s hand and drags her inside. Catra glares at Lonnie as she passes by her and then she leads Adora to the kitchen to get some more alcohol.

The night continues like that. Catra gets *drunk* , Adora is tipsy but at least she doesnt sway when she stands still. Catra had seen Glimmer and Bow, Bow was dressed as some archer, she thinks maybe he was meant to match Adora, Glimmer was dressed like some action figure. Glimmer and Bow were pretty distracted with each other, as much as Catra and Adora were distracted with each other.

Things were starting to slow down, it wasnt as crowded anymore, so Catra had pulled Adora into the centre of her living room to make her dance with her.Catra laughs as Adora dances. She’s not exactly *bad* but she definitely seems tense. “ *Loosen up* .”Catra signs and Adora blushes. She shrugs before she signs.

“ *I can’t exactly hear the music* .”She points out.

“ *Need some help* ?”Catra asks with a smirk. Adora raises an eyebrow and Catra can tell that her curiosity is getting the better of

her so she nods.

Catra moves in close to Adora. Adora looks at her and she lets out a soft gasp. Now that their hands are currently *on* each other, they can't communicate that way, only through head movements and body language.

Catra moves her hands down to Adora's ass and she looks at her with wide eyes before they darken a little. Adora licks her lips but Catra just moves her hands to her hips and squeezes. She guides Adora into a rhythm and Adora starts to move in time with the music. If Catra was honest? Adora's dancing was fine, she just wanted an excuse to do *this*.

They're practically crotch to crotch, in fact, they *are*. Catra feels hot. At some point Adora had removed the clunky plastic armour of her costume and now she was in soft clothes that hugged her muscles. Catra traces her hand along those muscles and she looks up to see Adora smirking at her. *Fucker*. Catra decides to play the big guns. She turns around so her back is pressed up against Adora and she grinds her ass into Adora's crotch. Adora's hands come around to Catra's front to press her closer. *Fuck*. Catra is so insanely attracted to Adora, it should be a crime.

They do that for a while. Catra gets drunker as the evening draws on. The party dies a natural death to the point that by now there were only a few lingering bodies and the music had turned into softer, gentler music. They were slow dancing in the middle of Catra's living room. Catra had completely forgotten about her meltdown at the beginning of the night. Now she just enjoys swaying

in time with Adora to soft music. Catra is tired, and she wishes people would just leave by now so she can go to bed - maybe *with* Adora.

Catra moves back from Adora and makes her way to the Hi-Fi that was playing music. She switches it off and turns to her guests. "Alright fuckos, party's over, get out." Adora didn't hear but she is watching her and smiling. Adora's smile always makes Catra feel so *warm*, her smile could make everything feel okay.

People start exiting her apartment and Catra shuts the door after them, locking it. She turns to see Adora looking at her. "*Let's get you to bed*." Adora signs and Catra smirks. *Don't mind if I do*. Catra crosses the room and takes Adora's hand, pulling her into her bedroom.

Adora hasn't been in her room yet, and she clearly instantly gets distracted. Catra sits at the bottom of her bed and watches Adora as she looks around Catra's room. She has a few pictures here and there, some of her and Scorpia, some with Entrapta, some of her and her moms, one of her and Melog somewhere. Adora examines them carefully, absorbed in seeing the parts of Catra that she hasn't necessarily seen yet - shit, Adora doesn't even know Catra has a cat. Melog is safely back home with her moms though, a college apartment surprisingly doesn't allow pets.

Catra watches her as she does this. Whenever Adora picks a picture up she is careful to place it right back where she found it. It's the little things about Adora that Catra loves- *likes*, that she likes. It's how

she pays attention to things, how soft she is, how competitive she is, how she always seems to be able to read Catra so easily.

Adora stops her browsing and turns to Catra. She smiles and comes over to her. “ *Do you mind if I undress you?* ”Adora asks - she looks only a little nervous about that.

“ *Please do* .”Catra responds. Despite Catra’ s consent, Adora hesitates.

“ *Not like that* .”Adora signs and Catra tries so hard to not be disappointed by that. She admits, it stings a little, Catra is allergic to rejection, she shrinks up, shuts down, she just cant handle it, but Adora’s eyes are nothing but soft and gentle. “ *You’re drunk, it wouldn’t be right* .”Catra wants to protest that, but she’ s not exactly completely capable of communicating with her hands right now. Adora is right, she’s too drunk to do this - plus, she wants their first time to be more than just a drunken night. So she nods.

Adora smiles and then she comes over to Catra. She carefully removes her tight pants and her shirt and then she goes to Catra’s drawers to pull out some sleep shorts and shirt. Adora turns her back so Catra can wiggle out of her bra and then she pulls the shirt on over the top. Catra does, however, let Adora slide her sleep shorts up her legs. The room seems stuffy suddenly with their breath so close together - Adora even looks like she’s blushing. Adora reaches up and removes Catra’s fake cat ears and then she unties Catra’s hair - which she’s very thankful for because getting that hair-tie out would be a painful experience in the morning. Adora then disappears

from the bedroom for a moment and Catra decides to make herself comfortable.

She crawls into her blankets and gets settled. She suddenly feels tired, maybe alcohol makes you sleepy, but Catra sure feels like she could sleep for several days. Maybe it was the emotional roller coaster of a day that she had. Adora returns with a glass of water and a rag in her hand. She places the glass of water on the bedside table with two aspirin and then she sits down on the edge of the bed. " *Can I clean your face* ?"Adora asks. Catra will be honest, she is too drunk to actually sign, and it takes her a while longer than usual to figure out what it is that Adora is asking her, but, as soon as she does, Catra nods her head. She had drawn whiskers on her face, if she didn't remove it before she went to bed not only would her pillow pay the price for that but it would be harder to remove in the morning.

Adora presents the damp rag and then she gently moves in to wipe softly at Catra's face. The rag was black, so it wouldn't stain, and it only takes Adora a minute before she smiles and sets the rag to one side. "Good night, Catra."Adora speaks and Catra suspects that it's probably because the gentle wiping had almost sent her to sleep. Adora makes to stand up but Catra grabs her wrist before she can.

" *Stay* ."Catra signs. " *Please.* "Adora looks at her for a long moment before she nods. She removes what's left of her awkward costume and changes into just a tank top and *boxers* , showing off those biceps of hers, and her toned abs where the tank top clung to her. Catra stares before Adora climbs into the bed. She shuffles back and Catra doesn't bother with the awkward gaps and spaces. She shuffles up behind Adora and spoons her happily. Catra may be tiny

compared to Adora's bulky and tall figure, but that doesnt mean Catra cant be the big spoon.

Adora seems to melt into the snuggle after a moment and then sighs. Catra loves it. She's sure that Adora hasnt been held much in her relationships (not that this is a relationship) but Catra doesnt care. She wants to cuddle that tall, blonde, goddess. So she does. Adora clearly enjoys it. So that' s how they fall asleep, with Catra spooning Adora from behind and them sharing body heat.

Catra really was in so deep.

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Adora likes Catra so much she could sing about it. Not that she would, Adora's pretty sure she cant sing, but *Catra* . Adora is so thankful she decided to come into the campus coffee shop that one day, it was like a twist of fate. She hadnt really been intending to, only that the library on campus was full and Adora doesnt do well in crowds. She'd walked the entirety of the library trying to find some place for her to study where she wouldnt get distracted or be bothered by people. Sure, sound wasnt an issue, but Adora still had ADHD. She likes things to be a certain way, she *needs* them to be a certain way if she's to study.

So she decided to brave the wet day and go in search of somewhere else to study. She'd seen the cof fee shop by chance and figured that might be a good place to go, she had recalled Glimmer telling her

that she often studied at Starbucks, fuelled by caffeine, and Adora liked coffee so. She had been counting on the place not being too busy, what she hadn't counted on was to meet the most beautiful woman Adora had ever set eyes on in her entire life.

When she had gone up to the counter, because Adora thought it was rude *not* to buy something and just sit there studying, she had almost cried when the guy behind the counter hadn't understood her. She didn't blame him, very few people know sign language, but Adora had been on edge and when she gets overwhelmed her eyes start to water without her permission. Then Catra happened. She'd stepped up, dismissed the guy, who's name tag said 'Kyle', and then something *amazing* happened. Catra *signed* to her!

Adora rarely meets people who can actually communicate with her via sign language and she had been extremely excited to meet someone other than Glimmer and Bow (who had learnt sign language only because of Adora - though Bow had already known it) who could actually speak to her in Adora's preferred form of language. She'd been so excited she hadn't even noticed how pretty she was until Catra asked her to slow down. After that, Adora had just stared at her for like a solid minute. Adora has never doubted her sexuality before, but seeing Catra really made her feel like she reached new heights of lesbianism.

After Adora had thought Catra had gone home, she'd been kind of bummed. She didn't really date all that often, it was even rarer for her to find someone to date who could communicate with her in sign language, but she'd wanted to ask Catra out on a date. That's why when she saw Catra again at practice she could hardly believe it.

At first, she had been worried that she and Scorpia were dating, but Catra had quickly put that to bed. The bowling alley had been a cautiously optimistic *potential* date. Adora was kind of scared that Catra would say no, she's had people be really mean and rude about it before in the past, so she thought Catra might be less likely to say no if she knew it was a group thing. She was so beyond happy when Catra agreed to it.

Kissing Catra hadn't been a part of Adora's plan, it was just something she found herself really wanting to do, and it was *incredible*. They kissed all the time now, and Adora was certain that she would never get tired of it. Adora, truthfully, has limited dating experience, she doesn't even know if she *is* dating Catra? Sure they kiss, they hang out, make out, she really liked sharing a bed with Catra. But were they dating? They didn't really have a label. Would Adora be upset if she found out that Catra was seeing someone else? Absolutely. They hadn't talked about it though, they didn't have boundaries, they weren't *defined*, they were just friends who hung out and sometimes kissed.

Adora wasn't really sure how to bring up the whole question of if they were dating or not. When she'd gone home for Thanksgiving, she had brought it up to Mara. Mara had just laughed at her and called her an idiot - lovingly of course. That still didn't help Adora a whole lot. She really liked kissing Catra, and she would really like to call them exclusive, but she couldn't figure out how Catra felt about that whole thing. So she was just sticking to kissing Catra and not talking about their status as potential girlfriends. Adora could groan, why was dating so difficult? Or not dating?

Adora was currently on her way to said coffee shop. It was around closing time, but Catra had told her to come despite that. Adora had

just finished practice, so she was dirty and sweaty , but she didnt think Catra would mind. Diving for the ball tends to be a messy business, especially when the weather is less than ideal. They had finally slipped into winter, which meant it was significantly colder than previous months. Adora's sweat from practice meant that she could really feel that *chill* .

She walks into the coffee shop and closes the door. She sees Catra behind the counter and her mouth looks to be open like she was just about to say something but stopped halfway through her words. They stare at each other for a moment, before Catra smiles. Adora *loves* Catra's smile, it's soft and it's warm and it makes her heart beat *hard* in her chest. " *Hey Adora.* "Catra signs. Adora really isn't sure why she blushes at that.

She smiles at Catra and then comes towards the counter. " *Got time for one more order?* "Adora asks as she dumps her sports bag on the ground at her feet.

" *For you? Anything.* "Catra signs back. Adora' s blush only gets worse. " *What do you want, tall, blonde and handsome?* "Catra asks. Adora really tries her best to keep her gay panic under wraps, but she's not sure if she's entirely successful.

Adora considers her options. She's not exactly adventurous, normally she just likes an iced coffee, but Glimmer had told her of one that she had recommended for her to try. Usually Adora could never communicate the complexity, but with Catra that wasnt an issue. " *Half a shot of decaf, caramel frappuccino, crushed skittles,*

blended unicorn cupcake, five sugars and oreos." Catra stares at her.

" *I am not making you that* ."Adora knows that Catra is signing her words but it almost seems very deadpan despite that - it's probably the look of horror on Catra's face. " *That is a crime against coffee and I will not help you commit it.* "Adora snorts in amusement and then her eyes light up. She goes into her sports bag and pulls out a pouch of chocolate protein powder.

" *Okay, how about a mocha but with this* "?Adora presents the pouch and Catra's face becomes even more horrified.

" *That is* ***not*** *a mocha,* "She signs, shaking her head in disbelief. " *Did you come here to torture me with your criminal coffees?* "Adora grins as she tosses the pouch back into her bag.

" *No,* "Adora signs as she reaches her hands forward to grab Catra by her shirt. She pulls Catra forward, pulling her towards Adora as she crashes their lips together in a kiss. Adora doesnt need sign language to tell Catra *this* is exactly what she came here for. Catra lets out a soft sigh into the kiss.

Catra's lips are so soft, and they taste a little like coffee - Adora knows theyre allowed cof fees on their breaks, so she imagines that's why. Truthfully, Catra always somewhat tastes and smells like coffee. Not only does she work part time in a coffee shop, but she's also a pre-law student. Adora knows Catra is sometimes up until the

early hours of the morning studying. Adora doesnt mind anyway , she enjpys kissing Catra and she *loves* the way she tastes too. Catra lets out a satisfied moan into Adora's *mouth* and Adora suddenly feels hot after feeling cold before.

After a moment, they both lean back, taking in some much needed oxygen. " *I'll make you that coffee, sit down* ."Adora doesn't know if Catra is going to make her the criminal coffee, or something else, but she isnt about to qestion her .

Adora sits down at one of the tables and sighs. She was still kind of cold but Catra always made her feel warm, so she wasnt complaining too much - plus shed have a cof fee soon enough. Catra must have cleaned because the place was spotless and the chairs were up on tables for the most part. Adora hums to herself as she lets her hair out of her ponytail just so she could tie it up again into a more organised one.

Catra comes over a moment later with a disposable paper cup and sets it down in front of Adora as she sits down across from Adora with her own drink: an espresso. Adora has learnt the hard way that pure espresso shots not only taste gross to her but give her exceptional energy. t' s probably best she stays away from those. She takes a sip from her coffee to taste the sweet blend of chocolate and coffee. Catra had made her that mocha after all - minus the protein powder.

Adora drinks it happily as she and Catra make idle chatter. The catch up on their days to each other, Catra tells Adora about stupid customers, Adora tells Catra about practice and the saves she

made, Catra makes a comment about Adora wearing half of the field on her (because she was so dirty from making said saves) and Adora rolls her eyes at her. Adora is always pleasantly surprised about how much she likes Catra and how easy it is to be around her. Adora has found it difficult to make friends in the past before, not just because of the language barrier, and Adora not being able to communicate in the way that most people are, but also Adora herself.

Adora knows sometimes she can be a little *much* . When she was younger her parents died in a car crash when she was five, before Mara found her she stayed at an orphanage under the supervision of Shadow Weaver. Adora is sure she probably had a real name, but she will *always* be Shadow Weaver to her. Shadow Weaver had found Adora annoying at first, by the time she was five her hearing was almost completely gone, she hated that Adora would follow her around, she couldnt talk to *anyone* , Shadow Weaver refused to teach her sign language - because she didnt even know it - and Adora hated speaking because she couldnt hear herself. Adora couldnt make friends with the other kids because she couldnt hear them, or talk to them, and more often than not theyd make fun of her and tease her - Adora may not have heard what they said but she sure as hell still felt bad when kids would sneer at her or even physically push her around.

t sucked, Adora wont lie. So she would follow Shadow W eaver around, she was still a pretty hyperactive kid but Shadow Weaver didnt like that so she attempted to force Adora into being a 'good' behaved kid.

Shadow Weaver took that to a whole new level when Adora started to get praised by her teachers. Adora was smart, and athletically

inclined, even if she was a little skinny thanks to Shadow Weaver's 'strict diet'- also known as the woman refusing to buy enough food for all the kids in her care. She left Shadow Weaver's care when she was twelve but she had left a lasting impression - *trauma* . Since Shadow Weaver refused to teach Adora sign language, she was the only person Adora had.

Mara had had to fight Shadow Weaver to allow her to adopt Adora and the only reason she caved was because Mara threatened to report her for the operation she was running. Mara still reported her but only after the adoption had gone through and Adora was *safe* . Mara was the first person who cared about Adora for her well-being since the death of her parents. Adora had thought her only worth was in the As she got in classes and those were sometimes hard fought for too. Mara had taught her sign language, she actually gave a damn about her and not just what Adora could do for her .

Things improved once Mara adopted Adora, she'd had to take a year out of school to focus on learning sign language, and also getting counselling, which is why Adora was slightly older than her current classmates - Catra had just turned twenty-one and Adora was turning twenty-two in January . Poor Mara had had to deal with Adora's moody teenager years too but now she was here. A college student, a young adult, extremely gay and a proud Deaf woman too. Adora has never viewed her Deafness as a disability, even when she couldn't communicate like other kids, it was just something about her.

With Catra things are easy. Adora sometimes struggles making new friends, and not just because of her Deafness, but because of how she is because of all that trauma. Glimmer and Bow are pretty much Adora's first and only friends. Adora gets along with her teammates

too, they're her friends, but Catra is the only person she's ever forged this kind of feeling and relationship with. They just *click* and Adora appreciates it greatly.

They finish up their coffees and Catra cleans up before she begins closing up for the night. Adora hugs her arms around herself, trying to keep herself warm, which Catra absolutely notices. "*Are you cold?*" Catra asks, behind the counter. Adora gives Catra a sheepish smile.

"*Maybe a little*." She admits.

"*Wait here*." Catra signs. She disappears for a moment and Adora stands up from her seat. She puts it on top of the table like the other tables and chairs in the shop while she waits for Catra.

When Catra comes out from the back she's wearing a zipped up hoodie and over the top is a leather jacket. Adora really was not aware she would find leather jackets so unbelievably hot until this very moment. In Catra's hands is Adora's letterman jacket. Adora raises an eyebrow up in silent question as Catra hands the jacket over. She doesnt understand why Catra would have the jacket when she is clearly wearing her own.

Catra is blushing a little as she pointedly looks *away* from Adora as she offers the jacket to her. Adora takes the jacket, staring at Catra in a mixture of surprise and appreciation. "*How come you have my jacket?*" Adora signs as she slips the jacket on. It's warm and she's

instantly relieved to have some extra cover on her arms rather than being exposed to the nippy weather.

“ *You gave it to me* .”Catra answers but Adora knows that Catra knows that’s not what she meant. So Adora just gives her a look and Catra’s cheeks only become redder. “ *I knew you were going to be coming from practice and I thought you might be cold because of the weather and how sweaty you are.* ”That is both weirdly gross but also cute.

Adora looks at Catra in pure amazement, feeling her heart grow at least three sizes in her chest. She’ s never had someone think about her like that, not even Bow or Glimmer would probably consider that. Yet here Catra was. Adora knows that Catra sometimes gives off a tough guy vibe but she is just all soft and gooey under that pretence - she’s a giant softie.

Adora *beams* and Catra looks at her once she has her blushing under control. “ *What?* ”Catra signs, trying to give of f the impression that she was annoyed but not really succeeding. Adora doesnt know why Catra feels as though her nice and kind gesture is embarrassing, if anything, it made Adora like Catra even more than she already did - which was already substantial.

“ *Nothing* .”Adora signs back with a smile. Catra shoves her chest a little.

“ *Shut up* .”She signs and Adora actually laughs. She decides to let Catra off of the hook and goes to pick up her sports bag. She reaches inside of the thing and pulls out her rainbow beanie she had shoved in there at some point. She slings the bag over her chest and then walks over to Catra, pulling the beanie down onto her head.

“ *Wouldn’t want you to get cold either.* ”Adora signs. Catra looks at her in disbelief.

“ *As if kissing you wasn’t enough to tell people we’re gay.* ”Catra sings and, yes, Catra is signing but Adora can practically *feel* the sarcasm radiating from her. Catra rolls her eyes but grabs Adora’s hand and begins to pull her out of the coffee shop.

Catra locks up the shop and then she takes Adora’s hand again. They start to walk back to Catra’s apartment. Adora likes walking Catra home, especially when she works the late shift. Maybe she likes it because she likes to be *here* , to make sure Catra is okay. Sometimes Adora would facetime Catra to keep her company on her walk. They don't live too far apart, all things considered, so Adora really doesn't mind walking Catra. Plus, sometimes she would stay at Catra’s, hang out or Adora would literally stay the night and just cuddle Catra - it was nice.

It really was getting colder , Adora could feel it even through her jacket but she was thankful for its protection - though her legs were cold. Adora squeezes Catra’s hand. She liked that they could hold hands like this. Maybe Mara was right and Adora was an idiot… *Were they already dating? They couldn’t be dating without talking*

about it, right? Adora really doesn't know and, at this rate, she's kind of afraid to ask.

They make their way into the familiar apartment building of Catra's. They walk up the stairs together and stop outside of Catra's apartment. "*You want to come in?*" Catra offers. Adora smiles. She's reminded of their first kiss that happened right here. They've become close since then. Adora could see herself dating Catra if she's honest, could see herself being in a relationship with her, as girlfriends, she just didn't know how to bring it up.

"*Definitely*." Adora answers. "*Do you mind mud in your apartment?*"

"*You forget that Scorpia is also on your team*." Catra says, rolling her eyes playfully. She opens the door and drags Adora inside. Adora *would* bring up their status as potential girlfriends some other time but, for now, she was just going to enjoy being with Catra in whatever capacity she let her be.

They spend the night hanging out, Scorpia comes home at some point and greets Adora happily and they all order takeaway before Adora leaves for the night. Adora knew that she had feelings for Catra, and she would do anything for her.

She was in deep.

***

t was a snow day at BMU. Some professors had tried to set up last minute lectures online but none very successfully, others had sent emails telling people to stay safe and to not bother coming to class. Catra was currently bundled up. She was in sweats, a jumper , Adora's jacket and she'd even thrown a blanket over herself too so she was walking around her apartment in a blanket burrito. When she looked over at the window all she could see was white.

Snow days were fun in theory but Catra still felt like she should probably be studying. Instead, she was currently texting Adora. She drifts into the living room and frowns when it feels noticeably colder than her bedroom. She drifts over to the radiator and places her hand on it. Great, her radiator was busted - *and during a snowstorm too!* Catra sighs as she carries on texting Adora, planning on lamenting this news to the blonde.

CatRa 💝

My radiator is broken in the living room

Dork 0

Your radiator is broken, how?

CatRa 💝

Im not sure what more you want me to say other than my radiator is broken, Adora. Idon't know how .

Drk 0

Okay, Ill be on my way with a toolbox in five

CatRa 💝

What?

No.

Adora.

No.

There is a literal snowstorm, how would you even get here?

Drk 0

Idon't know if you've heard of this new invention, but people call it walking

CatRa 💝

Walking in a snowstorm? Are you crazy?

Drk 0

Ill be fine, see you in five.

CatRa 💝

Adora

Adora. Im serious.

Do NOTwalk here, it's too dangerous

You better have stopped responding because you're eating or something

f you come here Im going to murder you

Ihear someone at the door , Iswear if that's you

Im going to kill you."Catra speaks her words and doesn't sign them but Adora grins so wide at her, totally understanding what Catra had just said to her . Catra can kind of forgive her anyway, because she looks absolutely adorable right now. Adora was wrapped up thoroughly, she had a rainbow bobble hat on, a scarf wrapped around her neck and her big parka jacket was zipped all the way up. Her cheeks are rosy from going from a cold to warm environment and her gloved hands hold a tool box and a plastic convenience store bag in the other. She has specs of snow all over her, including in her eyelashes, and she just looks incredibly attractive.

Catra steps out of the way of the door to let Adora inside. The blonde enters and Catra watches her closely as she treks snow in off of her... Catra can't believe it. When Adora sets her things down on the ground, Catra begins speaking and signing at her. " *Are you*

seriously wearing canvas sneakers in the snow? "Catra asks, raising an amused eyebrow at Adora. Adora shrugs and Catra rolls her eyes. " *I can't believe you're going to die because you wear canvas sneakers in the snow.* "

" *What's wrong with that?* "Adora asks with great amusement as she goes about removing the scarf from around her neck.

" *You need some boots. You're too gay for your own good.* "

" *Says the lesbian with the combat boots.* "Adora signs with a sly grin. Catra shoves her shoulder and pulls her *rainbow* hat off of her head (which she has to stand on her tiptoes to reach thanks to Adora's six foot height).

“ *I’m convinced you own all the rainbow merch in the world,* ”Catra signs as she tosses Adora’s rainbow hat down onto her couch. “ *I bet you even have a rainbow strap* .”Catra grins playfully . She fully intended for that to be a joke, but Adora looks at her with a blush and stays uncharacteristically quiet. Catra’s mouth falls open. “ *You’re joking, right?* ”She asks. Adora turns redder .

“ *It was a gift from Glimmer, first year* .”Adora wont meet Catra’s eyes and this is way too fucking funny right now. “ *She got me it when she found out I was gay* .”

“ *So as soon as she met you* ?Catra asks with a shit-eating grin. This was entirely too amusing and she was absolutely keeping this information in mind. Adora rolls her eyes fondly.

After finding out about the strap, Catra moves on and demands Adora take off her canvas sneakers and the blonde rolls her eyes with a smile but does it anyway. Her socks are wet, and Catra isn't even slightly surprised by that fact. Adora points at the bag. " *I brought you supplies, in case you needed them.* "Catra glances at the bag curiously. She picks it up off of the ground as Adora shrugs off her jacket. It was cold in the apartment, but only the living room radiator was broken, all the others were working perfectly fine, which meant it wasn't *freezing* .

Catra peers into the bag. Catra isn't really sure what Adora thinks supplies are, but all she sees inside is hot chocolate, chocolate bars and other junk food. She looks at Adora, who had taken off her white BMU hoodie and was currently opening her toolbox. Catra forgets about the bag.

Adora was looking at the radiator so intently, she was wearing a red shirt tucked into her usual tight blue jeans and Catra's eyes almost pop out of her head when she *crouches* . Part of Catra wants to go over to Adora right now, plonk herself down in her lap and make out with her. It really shouldn't be so attractive that Adora is just squatting in her living room, right? Maybe it's not the squat so much as it's how those tight jeans are really showing off her *ass* . Or maybe it's the tools, the look of concentration on Adora's face as she looks at the radiator maybe?

She flips open the lid of her toolbox and Catra decides to come stand beside her. " *Do you even know what you're doing* ?"Catra asks, raising an eyebrow in doubt. She knows Adora is a sports medicine major , she isn't exactly an engineer or a mechanic. *What does the blonde really know about fixing radiators?*

" *Don't you know a lesbian with a toolbox can do anything?* "Adora asks. Catra snorts at her and crouches down beside her.

" *Dork* ."Adora doesn't say anything back, she just looks in her toolbox, but Catra can practically feel her amusement rolling off of her anyway.

Catra knows Christmas is coming up soon and she's curious what Adora's plans are but she doesn't want to just ask her outright. She still hasn't told her much about the whole foster situation. She knows Adora went home for Thanksgiving, but beyond that... nothing. They had texted that entire week but Adora is... she's quiet in a way that Catra doesn't fully understand. She thinks maybe it's the fact that communicating about this stuff verbally is a challenge, never mind having to literally spell out your trauma for someone else to see, but it's also more than that.

Catra doesn't think it's reluctance on Adora's part, she just doesn't know how to talk about certain things. It's kind of endearing actually , she doesn't know how to bring it up, or how to express herself in certain ways, and Catra is fine waiting until she's ready. " *Guess I'll put your* ,"Catra makes air quotes before she signs her next word. " *Supplies' to use.* " Adora smiles at her and nods as she sets about

taking Catra's radiator *apart* . God, Catra so hopes she knows what she's doing.

She stands from her crouched position and heads to the kitchen, picking the bag Adora had dropped in her living room up and bringing it into the kitchen. Scorpia had texted her that she was stuck at Perfuma's because of the snow, which meant it was only her and Adora tonight. Catra was determined to... crack Adora open a little - not force her but at least wade into the waters a little. She still isn't sure what they are, only that they kiss a whole lot and every time it sets fire to Catra's insides, burns her out and leaves her craving *more* .

She likes kissing Adora. Like, *really* liked it. t's not that she thought she wouldn't like it, but she hadn't been expecting to like it qite as much as she did. After the first kiss, Catra had spent hours jst lying face up on her bed sighing lovingly before she had wiggled out of her clothes and finally gone to bed. She can't explain it, there really is jst *something* about Adora that Catra jst can't get over . t draws her in, leaves her wanting more, and she's helpless to it. t's like Adora is a drug and she's hooked.

Catra gets an idea what to make. She pours all of Adora's supplies' out on the kitchen counter. She puts the hot chocolate to one side. Adora had gotten a bunch of chocolate, probably because she wanted to get Catra's favourite - cant go wrong if you have all the types of chocolate.

Catra takes the dark chocolate and begins cutting it into sqares with her trusty kitchen knife. She grabs a saucepan from one of her

cupboards and places it onto the stove. She travels to her fridge and pulls out the milk. She carefully measures it to her desired amount and then she adds cornstarch. She whisks it until it dissolves and then adds some sugar just to sweeten it a little. She whisks again until it's dissolved, then she turns the heat up until it boils, making sure to stir it.

Just before Catra adds the chocolate Adora comes back covered in grease? Catra doesn't know , but she has it *everywhere* . " *You are not sitting on my couch like that* ." Catra signs and Adora pouts. " *Go shower, you can borrow some of my clothes* ." Adora hesitates before she nods in agreement. She disappears after cleaning up and Catra hears the water turn on the next second. Catra switches the heat down just so the milk would stay warm but now she had a little more time before she had to finish.

Catra drifts out into the living room and to the radiator. She places her hand on it and her eyes widen. Maybe Adora was right, a lesbian with a toolbox *can* do anything. It was still cold but clearly getting warmer. Catra wonders what the hell Adora did to fix it but she isn't going to question it. Adora had tidied up too, she'd put her tools away and placed her box neatly to one side. Handy *and* clean, maybe Catra had found some wife material in Adora.

Catra goes to her bedroom and pulls out some clothes she thinks *may* fit Adora and she lays them down on the bed. Catra exits her bedroom just as she hears the water shut off in her bathroom. She hurries back to the kitchen because the last thing she needed to see was Adora in a towel - she was already gay enough as it was. She turns the heat back up on the stove and brings the milk back to the boil. She whisks it again and ignores the sound of footsteps as Adora crosses the living room to Catra's bedroom. She tries to not

think about the fact that she has a *naked* Adora in her bedroom right now.

Catra adds the chocolate to her little creation and begins stirring, watching, with great satisfaction, as the chocolate melted in the milk. She stirs it as it melts and then she hears the door to her bedroom open. Catra turns just as Adora enters the kitchen. Catra has to cover her mouth to stop herself from laughing at what she sees.

Catra had definitely misjudged just how much bigger Adora was to her. The sweats were more like ¾ length, exposing Adora's thick calf muscles, the top was too short too, and it was exposing a strip of Adora's *abs,* and her shoulders were far wider than Catra's, she looked like she was going to burst out of the thing. Adora looks unamused but something that does take Catra's breath away is that Adora has her hair *down* . Catra has never seen that before. " *I am not wearing this* ."Adora signs. Catra's eyes shine with amusement - she fails keeping that laugh in.

" *I think you look great* ."Catra replies as she walks up to Adora. Adora rolls her eyes and then she takes Catra's shirt *off* . Adora was wearing her sports bra underneath but Catra was fully not prepared for a shirtless Adora in her kitchen. She debates the pros and cons of Adora lifting her up onto the counter and making out with her. Unconsciously, her hand reaches out and she runs her fingers over her hard, toned, stomach. *Holy shit* . Catra has never been this horny for someone before. She wants Adora to throw her over her shoulder and take her to her bed *right now* .

Catra does that for a long moment before she realises that Adora is staring at her. Catra clears her throat and shakes her head a little to clear her thoughts. “ *I’ll text Scorpia, you can borrow some of her clothes* .”Catra changes the subject, trying to ignore the thumping of her heart and the way her body practically ached to be touched by Adora. Adora nods and Catra returns back to her creation as she sends a text to Scorpia.

Catra is very aware of Adora’s presence behind her as she waits for Scorpia’s text. Adora drifts closer and then her hands come to rest on Catra’s stomach. Her mouth hovers over Catra’s neck. Catra lets out a sigh as she melts into Adora, letting her eyes flutter shut as she leans back into her. Adora always makes her feel like this. In a way that Catra has never experienced before. Unfortunately, before things can get too good, Catra’s phone chimes and she jumps which causes Adora to step back.

Catra grabs her phone and then turns to Adora. “ *Scorpia said it’s okay, just grab some clothes from her drawers. If you see anything in there, don’t tell me about it* .”Adora blushes a little before she nods in understanding and leaves the kitchen.

Catra sighs. She needs to know how Adora feels, at this rate Catra is ready to be *everything* with her: girlfriend, lover, fuck buddy, anything really. She just *wants* Adora, more than she has ever wanted anyone ever before. Catra finishes off her hot chocolate by adding some cayenne pepper and mixing it in. She serves it up in some mugs.

Adora returns in more fitting clothes. Although Adora was big and muscular, she wasnt quite as big as Scorpia, so the clothes hung of f

of her a little, but she probably preferred that to the too small fitting of Catra's clothes. Catra hands her a mug of hot chocolate and Adora smiles as she takes it. Catra grabs the candy that Adora had bought and then they retreat to the living room.

Catra throws on some movie that she didn't really pay attention to and then she settles down on the couch next to Adora. It was already considerably warmer in the living room and Catra had shredded her blanket to sit in Adora's jacket. Adora was happily sipping her hot chocolate and then she begins to sign enthusiastically to Catra. " *This is really good* !"Catra can feel her enthusiasm from the way she signs and the way she was smiling. " *I've never had hot chocolate this good before* ."

" *You're welcome* ."Catra signs back with a sly grin. She continues to sip her own hot chocolate, dipping various items of food in it. They just enjoy each other's company as they drink their hot chocolate and pay little attention to the movie that is currently playing in the background. Catra likes this about Adora, that they can simply just *exist* around one another and it not be weird.

They make idle conversation, at some point they both mutually decide that Adora will be staying (probably the duration of the snowstorm). Catra has never had a girlfriend stay that long before, or anyone stay that long - except Scorpia but they were *roommates* - but she finds she doesn't mind the thought of getting to spend a prolonged period of time with Adora even if they weren't dating. Somewhere along the way, they set their empty mugs aside and start making out on the couch.

So much for cracking Adora open a little .

Adora tastes like chocolate and her hair smells of *Catra's* shampoo and soap. Catra *loves* that the blonde smells like her, and the thought makes her kiss Adora deeply and hotly, pinning her down on the couch and kissing her with pleasure. Adora doesn't seem to mind, she kisses Catra back just as passionately , her hands gripping Catra's hips and keeping her in place atop her. Catra always seems to end up making out with Adora - not that she's complaining. Part of Catra has just accepted that they'll kiss like this but they'll never address the elephant in the room.

Adora flips their positions so Catra is pinned below her as the blonde kisses her hotly. They part every now and again only to pant, hot breath brushing against puffy lips, before they dive right back into kissing each other again. Neither of them are paying attention to the movie that is playing on the TV , forgotten instead in favour of making out. Adora's lips are hot against Catra's skin, kissing along her jaw and down to her neck. Catra moans softly as she feels Adora's lips open and her *teeth* graze her *neck* . Her hands tighten in Adora's hair. God, she needs Adora to stop doing that if her intentions are to go no further.

"Adora." Catra says, dumbly , and then she moans again as Adora's hands slide up her *shirt* . Catra taps her on the shoulder. " *Adora* ." She signs this time, tapping her for her attention. Adora stops immediately, looking at Catra with dark blue eyes. Her pupils are blown and she looks *wonderfully* destroyed. " *Are you sure* ?" Catra asks. Adora looks confused for a moment before her eyes light up in realisation. She pulls her hands out from Catra's shirt and begins signing.

" *You want to have sex ?* "Adora asks and she looks so cute when asking - and *surprised* - Catra can't help but laugh. She nods quickly in answer and then Adora's desire is quickly replaced by what is quite clearly panic.

" *We don't have to.* "Catra quickly signs. " *Just* ..."Catra pauses her movements and bites her lip, trying to keep her blush under control but failing miserably. " *If not, I need you to stop. You're... turning me on.* "Adora quickly moves back so Catra can sit up.

Catra suddenly feels vulnerable. She's never been great at taking rejection and while she' s completely fine with Adora not wanting to have sex, she still feels as though she's reading them all wrong. She looks at Adora who is obviously flustered, probably overthinking. Catra may not know *everything* about Adora (yet) but she does know she has a tendency to overthink - she also has anxiety. " *Do you* "… Catra pauses her movements. " *Do you not want to have sex with me ?* "Adora shakes her head quickly .

" *No!* "Adora' s exaggerated hand movements and the way her eyes widen give the impression of her yelling. *Ouch* . That stings a little, Catra won't lie. " *No,* "Adora repeats again, calmer . " *I mean yes, but no* ." *Okay, so now Catra is just confused.* Catra raises an eyebrow at her in question. " *I do, I* ***really*** *do, but not right now. I don't think we're there yet. And, we'd have to talk about it before, properly and thoroughly. I can't* ***bear*** *you, Catra. So if we were to have sex, I'd need precautions in place. We couldn't use a safeword, that kind of stuff* ."Adora explains and Catra admits she feels a little better after Adora explains herself more fully.

“ *Are you saying the only reason we haven’t had sex yet is because we haven’t talked about it?* ”Catra asks. t’ s meant to be playful but Adora is obviously flustered by this line of qestioning if her blush, which is noticeable even in the dim lighting of the apartment, is anything to go by. She nods slowly and then brings her hands up to sign further.

“ *And because…”* She pauses momentarily. “ *I just don’t know if our relationship is there yet* .”Catra wasnt even aware they had a *relationship* . She’s confused, but Adora gets weird whenever she talks about things that fluster her, so Catra doesnt want to pressure Adora to speak about this further.

Catra would really like to know when they developed a *relationship* . She thought they were friends, friends who kissed and maked out and *maybe* had sex if Adora was up to it, friends with benefits maybe, but no friends with benefits *wait* to have sex. *Did Catra have a girlfriend and not know it* ?

Catra notices Adora looking at her anxiously and she smiles. “ *Okay* .”Catra signs back before she grabs Adora’ s hand and pulls her to sit next to her again. She wraps Adora’s arm around her shoulder and leans into her side. She decides to shelve the conversation of what they are (and sex) for a later date. Right now, she just wants to cuddle Adora and leech off her warmth. This conversation could wait for another time.

Adora relaxes after a little while and they go right back to how they had been acting. Catra supposes that she can live with being unlabelled for now, but eventually she was going to need to know where the hell Adora actually stood. She understands anxiety relating to sex, especially given Adora's anxiety relating to communication during said sex, but it's nothing they can't figure out together if they just talk about it.

Whatever, it could wait.

They finish watching their movie and then retreat back to Catra's room. They kiss more, obviously, and Catra still feels like it would be the perfect time to take their so-called 'relationship' to the next level, but Adora said no and Catra respects that. They end up spooning again, this time Adora has Catra trapped against her in her big strong arms. Adora is *incredibly* warm and she makes Catra feel safe. It doesn't take her long to drift off to sleep with Adora spooning her from behind.

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It takes about a week for the snow to finally start melting and the snowstorm to be 'over'. Adora had stayed the entire time at Catra's, borrowing Scorpia's clothes (which she was totally going to thank her for), drinking hot chocolate and making out with Catra. It was about her favourite week in existence. They had still been studying, Catra in particular, Adora had been using Catra's computer, since she left her stuff back in her own apartment, and Catra refused to let her go back - even when the snowstorm wasn't even that bad. Adora thought it was cute that Catra was so worried about her.

Now that people were emerging from their homes, someone had organised a gigantic snowball fight on campus and Catra had grinned and told Adora they should go. So that's how they were currently standing on one of the many fields on campus with a mass amount of students also present. Bow and Glimmer had come, as well as Perfuma and Scorpia. " *Adora is on our team* ."Glimmer signs and speaks before she grabs Adora by her elbow and drags her to her side.

" *You can have her* ,"Catra signs back with an amused smile. " *She's wearing canvas sneakers in the snow again, she's dead weight.* "Adora laughs and shakes her head. She had actually wanted to be on Catra's team, but after that insult? Catra was going *down* .

They split up after that. Adora makes sure her rainbow beanie is on correctly and her gloves are on. Adora doesnt know who throws the first snowball but the field erupts into absolute chaos after. Adora only has one target in mind however: Catra. Adora peeks out from cover and then she's hit on her back by something. She stops and turns. Standing there with a smug smile, eyebrows raised and another snowball in her hand already, is Catra. " *Too slow, Princess* ."Catra signs. Adora isnt sure where the Princess name came from but she doesnt care. Catra has declared *war* .

Turns out, Adora really is too slow. Catra is extremely fast and her reflexes are impressive, Adora only manages to land a couple shots compared to nearly all of Catra's hitting her - even hitting her in the *face* . Eventually Adora manages to catch Catra off guard and she tackles her to the ground and into the snow. They're both laughing

hysterically and Adora pins Catra's hands above her head. "Ha!" Adora speaks. "I win." She smirks triumphantly down at Catra who was gazing up at her .

It is exactly then that Adora realises that she has *not* won. Catra grinds her hips *up* , against Adora, and Adora's brain completely short circuits. Screw snowball fights, Adora wants to lean more into *that* . Catra smirks and her hands manage to slip free when Adora's grip loosens. She places her hands to Adora's hips and grinds *more* . Adora lets out a soft sound of pleasure and surprise. Adora should not be turned on by this.

Catra clearly knows what she's doing because she smirks and wiggles her eyebrows playfully. Neither of them are signing, yet Adora feels as though they *are* communicating, in some kind of way. The atmosphere between them feels thick and almost suffocating, *heavy* . Adora wants to kiss Catra, and maybe do other stuff, so she does, because she can.

Adora starts to lean in to kiss Catra. Catra gets a gleam in her eye that makes Adora pause long enough for Catra to bring up her hand, full of *snow* , and smash it into Adora's face. She gasps at the cold but then she just laughs. Adora can feel Catra coming undone under her in a fit of laughter as snow melts off of her face. " *I think I won* ." Catra signs smugly. Adora rolls her eyes and then she leans down to rub her wet cheek against Catra.

Catra squirms under her and then they start to tussle. Adora absolutely gets her own back but so does Catra, both of them smashing snow into each other's faces and laughing. They roll

around in the snow, play fighting that descends into both of them making snow angels. Adora has never felt this happy and carefree in her life. Catra is *good* for her, good for her soul, she makes her feel a certain way she has never felt before: *happy* . Dont get Adora wrong, she has been happy before, but it's just dif ferent with Catra, it feels more complete.

Once someone calls for a ceasefire, and basically the entire student body is cold and wet from the snow, Catra and Adora stand up, Adora helping Catra. They reunite with Glimmer , Bow, Perfuma and Scorpia and then Catra signs as she speaks. " *How about we go back to our apartment? I can make hot chocolate* ."Scorpia starts to speak and Catra translates with her hands so Adora can understand.

"Catra makes the best hot chocolate!"Scorpia exclaims. Adora has to agree with Scropia there so she nods her head enthusiastically.

" *Plus, I don't want Adora to die from hypothermia because she doesn't wear appropriate snow clothes* ."Catra signs with a grin. Adora cant believe Catra is still teasing her just because she wore canvas sneakers in the snow. Adora knocks her shoulder against Catra's. Bow says something enthusiastically that Adora doesnt catch but Glimmer signs the word *tea'* and Adora pretty much gets that.

So that's how they end up agreeing to go back to Catra and Scorpia's apartment. They dry of f and warm up, Bow makes tea, Catra makes hot chocolate, and Adora kisses Catra more. At some point, Catra drags Adora into her bedroom just to kiss her passionately and then exit back to the living room again.

Adora really could not be happier.

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Adora was studying with Catra. They'd decided to go to the library because that was an environment that Adora could focus in the best. Well, usually, but all the times Adora has come here in the past, Catra wasnt here. Catra is *very* distracting, especially when she's studying. She's so focused and she looks so *beautiful* . Catra's jawline is sharp, her curly hair is tied up and in a bun, the wild curls that dont fit in her bun are held back by her headband, Catra is lean but she's muscular so Adora's letterman jacket, that she is currently wearing, is big on her (since Adora is much taller and bulkier generally). t hangs of f of her, but Adora *loves* to see her wear it. Catra has two different coloured eyes, one blue, one a sort of hazel-gold, and Adora wants to kiss her so badly. So badly that she is barely paying attention to her textbook on amino acids right now.

Catra's hand raises after a moment. " *I can feel you watching me* ." Catra signs and then her eyes glance up from whatever it was that she was reading. " *Wasn't it your idea to come here and study so we wouldn't end up making out on my couch?* "Catra asks. Catra can be cheeky sometimes, and it is *all* in the smirk. She smirks now, showing off her unusually sharp canines as she winks at Adora playfully and turns back to her books.

t was true that this had been Adora' s suggestion. The reason the library was the best environment for her to study in was not just

because it was quiet (which isn't really an issue for Adora anyway) but it was that people also *behaved* much more quietly. There were no people waving their hands around, doing actions that would distract Adora, nothing, most people had their heads buried in books - except for the few that were making out on the sofas in the back, in the secluded area behind the bookshelves where the librarians couldn't see them. It was a calm environment, which was excellent for Adora's anxiety. Though, she kind of wished she was at Catra's right now so she could make out with her as Catra had said.

"*I wonder if the book I've been looking for has been returned yet*." Adora signs absentmindedly. Catra glances at her to pick up her signs. "*But I'm enjoying my view*."Adora says as she smirks and leans her chin in her hand. Catra rolls her eyes and shoves her shoulder.

"*I'm trying to study, some of us have more finals than others*." Catra signs but Adora knows she's joking from the playful smile on her face. "*Go track down that textbook, dork*."

"*I really want to make out with you right now*."Adora admits. Catra's cheeks turn a wonderful warm red. She rolls her eyes again and then points at the bookshelves. Adora gets her message loud and clear: stop being a dork and go get your stupid textbook.

Adora stands up from her seat and heads over to the section of books she knew the much wanted textbook belonged to. She could still see Catra from here. Sometimes Adora wonders why Catra likes to kiss *her*. Catra is so. She is… *incredible*. Gorgeous. Beautiful.

Smart. The entire package. Adora never thought Catra would want to kiss her face.

Adora focuses on finding that textbook. They've already been here for a couple of hours and it's starting to get late. Adora has seen Catra study, she's like a machine, her brain is amazing, Adora on the other hand. She gets anxious about tests and things, but she also has a limit on how much she can study and she's reaching that limit - or at least her limit to be here in the library. She'd rather be at Catra's, or in her own room. Maybe kissing Catra… *Okay! Focus Adora!*

Adora had been looking for this textbook since forever. It was like the essential sports medicine book, but every time Adora looked or checked online, it was *always* booked out. So Adora didn't have high hopes. Sure, she could buy it, but paying money for books? That sounds like capitalism, libraries are free.

Adora's eyes land on the book. She could hardly believe it. She felt *excited* . So maybe she *was* a dork, and maybe Catra was right. *Whatever* . Adora grabs the book like it's precious cargo and then heads towards where Catra was sitting. "Catra, Catra, Catra." Adora speaks to get Catra's attention. The brunette turns around in her seat with wide eyes. Adora winces a little, she doesn't know how loud she just was but they are in a library so she sure hopes it wasn't too loud. " *Look* ." Adora signs as she presents the book that she just found. Catra smiles a little and takes Adora's hand, dragging her into the seat beside her. " *Was I too loud?* " Adora asks as she places her book down on the desk.

“ *No* ,”Catra shakes her head. “ *I was just surprised to hear you say my name* .” *Oh.* That made sense. Adora doesn't think she’ s verbally said Catra’s name ever before.

“ *Did I say it wrong* ?”Adora asks, a little self conscious of her pronunciation. Catra shakes her head.

“ *I love it* .”She signs back. Adora feels a smile tug at the corner of her lips in a half, lopsided, smile.

“Catra,”Adora speaks verbally again. Catra smiles and then leans forward to kiss Adora on her lips. Adora decides that if it gets Catra to kiss her, she'll say her name a lot more often. Catra sits back in her seat and then turns back to her open text book. Catra has a lot of books, not that Adora doesn't either , but Catra’s are thick and they contain a lot of confusing language - some of it is even *Latin*. Adora is blown away by just how smart Catra is.

They've done some good studying but Adora is growing restless. She has trouble concentrating, sometimes it’s like pulling a tooth, sometimes she has bursts of productivity and other times she struggles. Right now, she’s made notes, read her chapters and she feels like she’s done sufficient studying the past week to sit her last final successfully tomorrow. Catra has a few more finals left, and she’s been studying like crazy . Adora doesn't like to disturb her , since she knows how crazy stressful finals can be. Studying consumes so much of their time, they've still been hanging out, but usually they both have their noses buried in books and silently study without really *talking* . Adora feels ready (right now anyway) but she doesn't know how Catra is feeling.

“ *I wanted to ask you something.* ”Catra begins and she seems slightly nervous. Adora looks at Catra with her full attention. “ *I was wondering … I don’t know if you have plans for the holidays, probably, I just wondered if you’d like to… meet my moms and hang out a few days before?* ”Catra asks. She’ s really cute when she’s nervous. Adora smiles happily and nods.

“ *I’d like that, then I can give you your gift* .”Adora signs happily . Catra’s surprise and relief is obvious as Adora sees her let out a soft sigh of relief.

“ *Wait, you got me a gift?* ”Catra asks with wide eyes. Adora nods eagerly. She’d thought about this gift a lot, it wasn’t big or expensive but she was pretty happy with it and she was excited to share it with Catra. Catra looks like she’s contemplating something when Adora realises what it is.

“ *You don’t have to get me anything* .”Adora reassures.

“ *Shut up, I’m getting you something* .”Catra signs, rolling her eyes playfully. Adora lets out a soft laugh before she stands up from her seat.

“ *I’ll check this book out and then we can go back to yours and eat pizza?* ”Adora asks. Catra smiles and then nods her head as she begins to gather up all of her supplies again. Adora was excited to go to Catra’s for at least some of the holidays, it would be nice to

meet the people who raised Catra, not to mention how she'd get to spend time with Catra too. Maybe Adora would even get to bring up their relationship status.

She had been thinking about that night for a couple of weeks now, how Catra had thought they were maybe going to have sex. It's not that Adora didn't want to, it's just that it was unexpected. She isn't entirely used to people actually wanting to do things with her, let alone have *sex* with her. At least she knew Catra found her attractive, or, if not attractive, someone to have sex with. Adora hadn't been sure they were there yet either, not that they were in a relationship, but sex is a big deal, right? Adora *so* wanted to have sex with Catra, but she didn't know if she was *ready* to have sex with her. It's all very complicated.

Adora checks out her book and when she comes back over to the table Catra is all packed up. Adora packs up her stuff and puts her backpack on before she scoops up the books that Catra couldn't fit in her bag and carries them for her. Catra smiles softly and kisses Adora on her cheek. Yeah, Adora definitely had feelings for Catra, and she was terrified that she was alone in that. They begin their walk back to Catra's apartment after that.

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Adora was having the best Christmas break she had ever had in her entire life. She had agreed with Catra to come with her back to her home for a couple of days. They had technically left campus a few days before the term was finished, but once Catra had sat her last final they didn't see the point in sticking around. Adora had given

Bow and Glimmer their gifts, which were sitting under the tree in their shared apartment, and she had packed and gotten ready for her winter break.

The plan was for Adora to come down to Catra's home for a few days, spend time with her, stay in her *home,* which meant that Adora met Catra's *moms* . They were nice, all things considered, but Adora couldn't figure out if Cyra liked her or not. They had spent the last couple of days exploring Catra's home town, going to the Christmas market, drinking mulled wine and star gazing. It was *incredible* . But this was Adora's last night before she'd have to leave for home tomorrow to make it back to Mara's for Christmas.

They enter Catra's house, giggling about something that Adora can't fully remember. Catra laughs and her joy is infectious to Adora - whenever Catra laughs, so does Adora. They run into Catra's moms as they enter the front door. They looked as though they were retiring for the night. They begin to speak, and Adora has no idea whatever it is that they're saying until Catra starts signing and speaking. " *Can you please sign your words so Adora can be included* ."Catra signs - she looks a little annoyed, which Adora finds somewhat cute.

" *Sorry* ."Luna signs to Adora and Adora smiles, nodding her okay . " *We're going to bed for the night. … is in the kitchen and- it's probably best if I just show you what I'm talking about* ."Adora misses a few of those signs but Catra nods and then looks at Adora.

" *Will you be okay* ?"Catra asks hesitantly .

“ *I’ll be fine, I’ll wait here for you.* ”Adora signs back. Catra hesitates for a moment before she nods and follows her mom into the kitchen.

That just leaves Adora alone with Cyra. If Adora is honest, she doesnt know if Cyra likes her or not and she’ s kind of intimidating. She looks a lot like Catra, but she’s slightly taller and Adora never knows if she’s being serious or playful when she signs/says things - she’s even intimidating to Adora’s six foot tall jock physique. “ *We should talk* .”Cyra signs. Adora immediately goes into *uh oh* mode but she nods anyway. “ *What are your intentions with my daughter* ”? She asks. Adora’s eyes widen a little.

She stumbles over her signs for a moment before she manages to organise her thoughts enough to form a coherent response. “ *We’re friends, ma’am.* ”Adora settles on - that doesn't seem to amuse Cyra who just stares at her .

“ *Look, I'm only going to say this once* ,”She signs slowly and Adora straightens up in alarm. “ *If you hurt my daughter, I will hurt you back, understand? I don't care if you seem… nice… Catra is my baby girl and if anyone, including you, harms her, they have me to answer to.* ”Adora gulps a little and nods in understanding before Cyra seems to sigh. “ *Also, figure out how you feel before you hurt both of yourselves* .”

Adora is about to ask what that means when Catra and Luna enter the living room again. Catra is holding a beautiful Russian blue cat in her arms that has a cute little bow on its collar. They are absolutely

precious and Adora wants to pet them. " *Okay, ready for bed, Love* ?" Luna says and signs to her wife. Cyra nods and as they turn to the stairs together she throws Adora a narrowed eyed look and a clear *warning* .

Once Catra's moms say goodnight, that just leaves Adora and Catra to themselves. Adora reaches her hand out to the cat and lets them sniff it before she begins to pet them. They are *adorable* and they seem to warm up to her very quickly . Adora cant hear it, but she feels when the cat begins to purr.

After a moment, they jump out of Catra' s hands and then curl up on the sofa. Catra smiles as she turns to Adora. " *They like you* ." Catra signs. " *Usually it takes them a while to warm up to strangers. They're called MELO-G, don't ask.* " Well, Adora totally wants to know about how they came to be known as Melog now. " *I've had them for a while now, but the apartment complex doesn't allow pets so they stay at home with my moms while I'm at college.* "

" *Melog?* " Adora finger spells in question. Catra sighs and rubs her forehead.

" *I was like twelve, okay? Melog is golem spelt backwards* ." Catra explains which really doesnt help Adora whatsoever .

" *Wow… you're a nerd* ." Adora teases. Catra rolls her eyes and shoves her shoulder playfully.

“ *Come on, let's go to my room* .”Catra signs as she grabs Adora’ s hand and begins to drag her up the stairs.

They were in Catra’ s room. The entire house was quiet, Adora knew that Catra’s moms had gone to bed and now they were sitting under a blanket together, using a flashlight so they could see each other, and talking away. Catra’s childhood room was nice, it had posters from her teenage years, LED lights hung around it, casting the room in a gentle white light, she had pictures and trophies and her bed was quite big. Somehow they had gotten onto serious topics and Adora was telling Catra more about her Deafness.

“ *I love the way I experience the world* ,”Adora begins slowly , her eyes sparkle a little as she tells Catra. She has rarely told people this, but she finds herself wanting Catra to know. “ *This probably sounds strange to you, but I like being Deaf* .”Adora pauses as she looks at Catra to gauge her reaction. Catra just sits there, watching with great attention on Adora’s hands as she explains. Gosh, she *really* likes Catra. Ever since she has met Catra, Adora has felt this energy between them that she just cant explain. She wants to kiss her all the time, hold her hand, take her on dates..other *stuff* . She has liked her since she signed to her at the campus coffee shop.

“ *It’s just… something about me. When I was younger, Mama was offered the chance for me to get cochlear implants* .”Adora takes a deep breath as she feels the familiar guilt crush her. “ *As a teenager, I used to resent her for not going through with it, for robbing me of hearing I guess, but… she was right. She wanted to wait until I could make that decision for myself.* ”Catra nods just so Adora knows that she’s following her. “ *I know now that those kinds of things take a lot of consideration. It’s a major surgery that can have nasty side effects* .”Adora winces a little as she remembers what some of her friends

had told her it was like. “ *But… it was more than that. When the time came where I could get them I… didn’t want them. I don’t think I have anything wrong with me, I don’t need to be* ,”Adora pauses just to throw air quotes around her next sign. “ *fixed.”* Catra nods in response.

“ *I don’t need sound to experience life, I don’t need it to kiss you, I don’t need it to be a doctor, I don’t need it to play soccer, my Deafness is a part of me, it doesn’t need to be ‘cured’.”* Adora smiles a little as Catra leans forward to kiss her on the cheek before she sits back again. “ *I don’t listen to music, I feel it. There are challenges, sure, but, right now, I don’t want to change how I experience life, you know?* ”Of course there are times when Adora thinks hearing would be nice, but those moments are fleeting. She is attached to her Deafness, and she doesnt think that will change any time soon.

Catra looks nothing but engaged and she nods in understanding. Adora decides to go further with her emotional dump on Catra. “ *I told you I was adopted* ,”Adora begins and Catra nods. Adora knows that Catra has been waiting for more information on this and it’s not that Adora doesnt trust Catra with it, she’ s just never wanted to bum her out. “ *My parents died in a car crash when I was five,* ”Adora sees Catra get a *look,* the look that most people give her when they find out that she’s an orphan, but Catra already knew that. “ *I was in an orphanage for a while, it wasn’t easy but I survived. Mira found me and she took me in. I am so thankful for all that Mira has done for me* .”Adora pauses for a moment.

“ *I don’t think it was just that I was neglected, and that Weaver obviously wanted to keep me to herself by refusing to teach me sign language.* ”Adora signs carefully . Catra is watching so intently, her

eyes following Adora's hand movements with great focus. It's nice to communicate with someone who gives her their utmost attention rather than just dismissing her or saying 'It's nothing'. It annoys Adora whenever someone does that. If she could hear , Adora would never need someone to explain something to her, or to translate, when people say 'It's nothing' it feels like a dismissal - it was why she was so emotional when Catra started translating Scropia's speech without prompting.

" *It was grief*."Adora states. " *Mara lost her wife not long after she found me. They had been looking to adopt before she passed and Mara decided to go through with it. I never really got to grieve for my parents* ."Adora's eyes water a little but she blinks quickly to dispel them. " *I couldn't talk about them to anyone. Mara saw that grief in me, and she knew that we could grieve together.* "Adora smiles a little. " *I love Mara. She is kind, gentle, patient, and incredibly smart. She's a mom to me. She took care of me, taught me that I was worthy of love. I owe her everything, but nothing at the same time, because that's what real moms do. They give you love* ***unconditionally*** *, and that's something Weaver* ***never*** *did.* "

" *You've been through so much* ."Catra signs slowly . " *But… You're still a good person* ."Adora smiles a little at Catra calling her a good person. " *I don't think anyone would have blamed you if you had been angry and closed off but… you're not. You're kind,* ***good*** *."* Catra shuffles forward a little and Adora looks down at her curiously. Adora lifts her hands to respond.

" *I* ***was*** *angry, I had an angsty teen phase* ."Adora grins before her smile falls a little. " *It was Mara. I'm terrified of what kind of person I would have been if she had never adopted me* ."

“*No*,”Catra signs and then she lifts her hand and places it to Adora’ s chest, right where her heart was, before she pulls it back in order to sign. “*You have a good heart. Not even that evil woman would have been able to snuff out the light inside of you*.”Adora’ s eyes sparkle a little and then she leans forward to kiss Catra.

t was getting hot under the blanket they were currently under , but Adora didnt want to stop kissing Catra. She moves her hands up to cup her jaw either side, holding her face in her hands as she kisses Catra softly. She will never get tired of kissing Catra. Catra pulls the blanket off of their heads and turns the flashlight off. Now they were kissing on Catra’s bed in her childhood room, illuminated in the soft white glow of the surrounding fairy lights. t’ s almost like a dream.

Catra leans back and turns the lamp on her bedside table on as Adora watches her closely. The atmosphere has shifted, Catra pulls the blanket entirely off of them and then she looks at Adora. She seems to be asking for permission for something and, while Adora isnt totally sure what it is, she is more than willing to find out. Adora nods and then Catra takes Adora’s hand and then guides it up to her breast. Adora’s eyes widen, and she immediately feels her cheeks flush, but she’s here now and she absolutely wants to stay here.

Catra shifts and then begins to lay back on the bed. Adora follows, hovering above Catra as she gently cups her breast over her clothes. “ *Okay if I take it off?* ”Catra signs quickly and Adora nods eagerly. She still doesnt know if theyre at the sex level yet, but she wouldnt mind touching Catra in some way - plus, Adora really likes boobs.

Catra doesnt take her shirt off, instead, she brings Adora's hands down her sides and then guides them to the hem of her shirt. Catra nods and Adora hesitates only for a moment before she slowly begins to peel Catra's tank top off of her. Adora's heart is racing in her chest, she can feel it thumping away as every new inch of skin is revealed to her. Adora is possibly too gay for this, she might just die. Everything about this feels charged, it's technically colder now that they dont have a blanket over them, but Adora feels like she' s burning up from the inside out.

Once Catra's shirt is gone - Adora only struggles a little getting it over her head - Catra is completely bare. Adora can see *everything* . Her skin is soft and smooth and *warm* , as Adora places her hands to her hips and squeezes. She moves her hands up Catra' s sides, briefly touching her toned abdomen before she comes back to where Catra had placed her hands before.

Adora swallows.

Catra's boobs are on the smaller side, but they're perky and they fit perfectly in Adora's large hands. Adora wants to touch Catra *forever* . She leans down and kisses Catra hotly as she touches her boobs. Adora cant believe this. How did she end up here? Adora cant hear Catra but she sure as hell *feels* her. Adora feels so much, from the way Catra shudders under her touch, the way she arches into her palms, her sharp nails digging into Adora's shoulder blades whenever Adora *pinches* . Adora knows she's turning Catra on from the way she's breathing, practically panting, so heavily and the way that Adora feels Catra's hot breath every time she exhales. *Holy shit*

. This might just be Adora' s favourite activity (and place) in the entire world.

Adora cant sign with her hands full, and she cant hear herself, but she *wants* to speak to Catra. Often she refrains, she knows her speech isnt perfect, but she can't touch Catra' s beautiful body like this and *not* praise her. "You're perfect." Adora says between kisses. Catra's nails dig *deeper* so Adora is semi-confident that what she's saying is registering. "Beautiful. I could touch you forever." … Catra doesnt say anything but she doesnt have to anyway . Her body says it all: the way she tilts her head back, inviting Adora to suck there, or bite, Adora takes the invitation without hesitation.

She flicks her slightly calloused thumb over one of Catra's erect nipples as she *bites* Catra's neck with her *teeth* . She's pretty sure thatll leave a mark and, so long as she' s given Catra one, she figures she may as well keep going. Catra is coming undone under her hands, her leg comes up to wrap around Adora's waist at some point and pull her closer, attempting to *grind* . Adora doesnt mind, if this is turning Adora on, it must be turning Catra on to be touched like this - Adora is glad Catra took her shirt off.

Catra taps her on the shoulder and then signs a single word. " *Use* ." She stops and then speaks her next words but Adora reads her lips carefully. "Mouth." Adora looks at Catra for confirmation and she nods desperately. "Please, Adora." Adora so wishes she could hear how Catra says her name, but she can feel it as she kisses Catra on her lips again and Catra utters Adora's name against them.

Adora moves her lips from Catra's mouth to the corner of her lips, to her jaw , where she peppers kisses along it, then down to her neck, leaving *more* marks - Adora was so glad that she was going home tomorrow and wouldn't have to confront Cyra about what activities her and Catra got up to in her bedroom, under her roof. Adora moves down to Catra's chest and then Adora does her favourite thing in the world to do: she sucks on boobs.

She bites and she sucks, marking Catra's chest just as she did her neck. Whichever one she is not paying attention to with her mouth, she makes sure to massage with her hand. She sucks and she *swirls* , and Catra is *squirming* under her the entire time. Catra demolishes her ponytail at some point in the midst of her pleasure and Adora feels *proud* - and wet, she definitely feels wet. She wants to do so much more, but she knows they should probably wait, so she pulls back after a long moment.

Catra looks *destroyed* . She is panting and covered in love-bites from Adora, her eyes flutter open after a moment and then she smiles in a dopey satisfied way. Once Catra has calmed down she lifts her hand to sign. " *Wow* ."Adora can't help but laugh and grin. " *You're good at that* ."Catra signs, suf ficiently boosting Adora's ego. She sits up and grabs her tank top where she discarded it. " *Bathroom* ."Catra signs before she stands. She wobbles a little on her legs as she makes her way to the bathroom. Adora watches her go and then she lies down on the bed with a soft sigh.

Adora realises that they are way more than just friends who kiss. They're even more than friends with benefits. Friends with benefits would have had sex by now, right? They don't wait to have sex, they don't kiss or cuddle, or do whatever it is that they just did, right? Maybe sometimes they do, but Adora knows there is an *intimacy* to

their actions. They're not *just* friends but they're not friends with benefits either. Adora likes Catra, she knows, she could see herself *loving* Catra. Adora wanted her as her girlfriend, and there seemed to be an obvious shift in their relationship.

When Catra comes back she's no longer shirtless - which Adora is only slightly disappointed by - she has bruises on her neck and down her chest that disappear under the tank top she had on. She was still in her sleep shorts and she looked comfortable - Adora wonders briefly what it was that she did in the bathroom.

Catra climbs into the bed again and settles beside Adora, she kisses her on the cheek before she lies back in the sheets. " *Thank you* ." Adora signs to Catra. Catra tilts her head to one side in question.

" *What for* ?" Catra questions, quirking a brow . Adora smiles as she wraps her hands around Catra's waist and pulls her closer. She brings her hands back up so she can sign again.

"*For letting me get to Second base?*" Adora signs, a little unsure. " *I don't know, I'm a soccer lesbian*." Adora doesnt *hear* Catra laugh but she feels it. From the way Catra shakes a little with her chuckle, the brush of hot air with Catra's release of breath, and the way Adora can see her grinning too. Adora may not hear it, but she already knows it is her favourite sound in the entire world.

" *Dork* ." Adora is pretty sure Catra loves to call her that now . Catra rolls over and turns the lamp back off and then she curls up in

Adora's arms, both of them holding each other, face to face. Adora kisses Catra until she falls asleep and then she feels herself being dragged into unconsciousness. She knows, without a doubt, that she is falling for Catra, *hard* , and she is more than willing to do it.

She surrenders herself to Catra.

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They're sitting outside on the porch of Catra' s house, drinking hot chocolate and eating fried sugary sweets that Adora dips into her hot chocolate - it was seriously the best hot chocolate that she had ever had;Catra' s moms made it exactly as she had back in her apartment. It' s cold, and when Adora breathes she can see her frozen breath. She was wrapped up in a flannel jacket with a hoodie underneath, her rainbow hat on her head and her scarf wrapped around her neck. Catra was wearing several layers but when they had woken up she had grabbed a turtle neck Christmas jumper to hide the darkening marks that Adora had left on her skin. In the light, they were way more noticeable and Adora wasn't aware she had been quite so aggressive.

Adora was leaning against the railing of the porch, watching the snow falling in front of them. Maybe she's getting ahead of herself, but she could see this in her future;her and Catra, side by side, sipping hot chocolate on the porch of their own home. Adora places her mug down on the railing and then reaches into her pocket. She pulls out her neatly wrapped gift and then presents it to Catra. Catra raises an eyebrow and places her own mug down as she accepts the gift from Adora. "*Merry Christmas* ."Adora signs happily .

“ *It’s not Christmas yet* .”Catra signs back with a bemused expression. Adora rolls her eyes fondly. *What is it with Catra pointing out the fact that it isn't a certain holiday to her?*

“ *Merry Not Christmas then* .”Adora signs with only a hint of sarcasm. Catra laughs and smiles.

“ *Merry Not Christmas* .”Catra signs back in agreement. Adora gestures to the gift, wanting Catra to open it before Adora had to leave in order to make it back to Mara’s for the holidays. Catra raises an eyebrow, she looks like she wants to say something else but she begins tearing into the paper.

t was just a small box, so it doesnt take her long to tear into the paper to reveal the small black box. She looks so concentrated on the box, Adora thinks it’s *adorable* , but she doesnt want to disturb Catra by pointing that out. Catra lifts the lid of the box to reveal a necklace. She pulls the chain out of the box and holds it out. t was a silver necklace with the initial ‘A’on it. Adora grins and then pulls her shirt down to pull her own identical necklace out that had the initial C’on it. Catra smiles so genuinely it makes Adora’ s heart *ache* . “ *I thought it was cute* .”Adora explains. “ *I thought… we could have matching ones.* ”

“ *I love it* .”Catra signs as she presents the necklace to Adora. “ *Do you mind?* ”She asks as she turns around and lifts her hair out of the way. Adora steps towards her and then brings the necklace around Catra’s front before she fastens it in place at the back of

Catra's neck. She kisses Catra on her neck before Catra turns around and grabs Adora by her shirt, kissing her lips fully and properly. Adora doesn't know how she's come to feel this way about Catra in such a short period of time, but she had. She could *really* see herself loving Catra.

After the kiss they rest their foreheads against each other and just enjoy the moment. Catra plays with the necklace around Adora's neck with a smile before she steps back. "*Okay, stay here, I have your gift inside*."Adora nods as Catra hurries inside. Adora finishes off her hot chocolate and she faces the front door, waiting for Catra to come back.

It doesn't take her too long and she returns with quite a large box. Adora's eyebrows shoot up when Catra deposits the thing in her hands. "Heavy."Adora speaks. Like *really* heavy. Catra just grins and nods. Adora was already kind of feeling bad, she got Catra just some necklace and here Catra was giving her some big heavy (and probably expensive) gift.

"*Open it*."Catra encourages. Adora hesitates only for a moment before she takes the lid off of the box. When she sees what's inside, she has to do a double take.

It's a bowling ball, but not just any bowling ball, it's *the* bowling ball. "*You remember*?"Catra questions hesitantly. Adora nods at her in answer. When Adora had lifted Catra, the first time she had been tempted to kiss her, it was the bowling ball that they had *won* with. Adora looks at Catra in a mixture of awe and confusion. She places the box to one side.

“ *Did you steal this ?*” Adora asks with a laugh. She doesn't understand how Catra has this. Catra looks at her with great amusement.

“ *It's okay, I know a great lawyer* .” Catra responds. Adora rolls her eyes in amusement - Catra was talking about herself. Adora wasn't going to argue Catra's point about her being an amazing lawyer , but she still doesn't understand how , or when, Catra got this bowling ball. “ *I didn't steal it. I paid one of the people who works there to take a ball, they didn't even question it. Sure did take me a while to track down the right ball though* .” Adora stares at her and Catra gets a nervous expression on her face. “ *Do you not… Do you not like it?* ” Adora *beams* .

“ *I love it* .” Adora signs back, emphasising the love' by doing the sign twice. Catra smiles softly and steps towards Adora. They kiss on the porch in the cold after exchanging gifts and everything feels *perfect* . Mara was right, Adora *was* an idiot. She knows now that she absolutely wants Catra as her girlfriend, she wants to date her, and kiss her, and *be* with her, she just has to *tell* Catra that - and that's the scary part. Adora decides that confession can wait until they return back to school, for now, Adora just enjoys her final moments with Catra.

Once they've drunk their fill of hot chocolate, and eaten their fill of food, Adora lugs her baggage from Catra's bedroom and loads it into her car - bowling ball included. Once Adora is packed and ready to go, she turns to Catra. She doesn't want to leave, but not spending the holidays with Mara is out of the question. Adora smiles at Catra. “ *Thank you for letting me touch your boobs* .” Adora signs playfully

and Catra shoves her shoulder with a laugh. Adora lets out a heavy sigh after she’s finished laughing.

“ *Don’t forget about me* .”Catra signs to Adora.

“ *I could never* .”Adora responds. And then they kiss, again. Adora can't believe she ever thought they might *not* be a thing. They kiss for as long as they possibly can before Adora *has* to leave.

She climbs into her car and fastens her seat belt. She stares at Catra’s reflection in her mirror, feeling her heart *long* just to be kissing her again. *Yep, Adora was in so deep* . She had been a fool to think that she wasn't. She just hopes that her confession can wait until they're back at college and the holidays are behind them.

Adora starts up her car and pulls away. She watches Catra in her mirror until she disappears and Catra watches her just as long. Adora, for the first time, considers if it’s possible to fall in love with someone you've only known for a few months.

Chapter End Notes

Thank y'all for reading :)! These lesbian disasters, I love them <3 Adora got to touch boobs, which is great, and they are just completely smitten with one another but won't admit it to each other. See y'all next update!

sign my name

Chapter Summary

> I wasn't interested." Catra says. "She's not my type."
>
> "What is your type?" Adora asks curiously with a smirk.
>
> "Definitely not tall, blonde, soccer players, that's for sure."

Chapter Notes

> Coffee Shop AU Returns !! I hope y'all enjoy this chapter! Thank you all for the continued kudos and comments <3 I will try to respond to all the comments!! Anyway, please enjoy!
>
> Warning, Slight NSFW this chapter, implied/referenced child abuse, slight violence (nothing graphic though)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

And here it is, our final night alive

And as the earth runs to the ground

Oh girl, it's you that I lie with

As the atom bomb locks in

Oh, it's you I watch W with

As the world, as the world caves in

- As the World Caves In, Matt Maltese

Winter

Adora isn't jealous. She *isn't* . She is absolutely, 100% *not* jealous. The girl talking to Catra at the bar laughs *way* too hard at something Catra just said and brushes her hand against Catra's shoulder .

Okay, so maybe Adora was jealous.

This wasn't even her plan, and now her Not Girlfriend' is being flirted with by a stranger in some random club. When Glimmer had suggested a *club* for Adora's birthday, Adora had been sceptical but agreed nevertheless. Adora downs her vodka coke and then drops her glass down to her table. It must be loud even over the pounding music because Glimmer looks at her. Adora looks back at her. She doesn't know what she looks like, but she honestly feels like she looks like she just lost a million dollars. Glimmer turns around to look at where Adora had been staring - more like *glaring* - before she turns back.

" *You need to tell her that you like her* ."Glimmer signs while rolling her eyes. Adora huffs and slumps over her empty glass. She knows that she should tell Catra about her feelings, but it just never seems like the right time.

Adora had decided to wait until they came back from winter break, and then she felt like she couldn't just *say* it. *It should be romantic, right?* But they'd been going through a sort of... dry spell. Catra

hadn't kissed her since they came back from winter break which, Adora knows, really wasn't that long ago, but she had sort of been expecting they'd go back to their old dynamic. Adora was worried that Catra regretted the whole boob thing, or if she had maybe gone too far.

t's not like Catra had been avoiding her , she hadn't, but Adora felt awkward around her - and she's pretty sure Catra noticed her weird behaviour. t wasnt even that Adora was awkward *with* Catra, she just felt like she was keeping something from her - and Adora is a *bad* liar, which resulted in her being weird. She was reluctant to confess her desire to be Catra's girlfriend from the fear of rejection, and she'd found every excuse in the book to avoid doing it, and the more she put it off the more she felt a sense of urgency and discomfort. She did this a lot, the putting off of a task from anxiety, and she had a tendency to believe the worst outcome would happen, which resulted in her avoiding it even more, and now she had waited too long and Catra was being *flirted* with.

Adora couldnt see Catra' s face, her back was to her, but she didnt seem to be shying away from the other girl's touch. Adora pushes back off the table. *She could go over, right?* Maybe Catra needed rescuing from the other woman, maybe she was trying to find a polite exit, Adora could give that. Or, *maybe* , Adora's brain whispers cruelly to her, *Catra doesn't want you like that and she's enjoying this other person's attention more than she enjoys yours* . t' s a dumb thought, Adora knows, but usually she has time to calm herself down from these thoughts in the calm environment of her room. That wasnt possible right now .

Glimmer watches her go and Adora suddenly finds herself standing behind Catra. The other girl notices her first, and Adora rests her

hand possessively on the small of Catra's back which results in Catra jumping a little. Her mismatched eyes look sideways and she seems to relax when she realises that it is Adora that was standing there. Catra seems to breathe out a soft 'oh' but Adora cant say for sure. The girl looks quizzically at them both. "*This is my…"* Catra pauses her signing for a moment before she carries on, "*friend, Adora* ." That stings a little, but it is true. Adora gives a small wave in greeting.

The girl, Adora doesnt know her name, regards her cautiously . She cant really read her expression, but Adora doesnt like it, she feels as though she's being judged by her for some type of reason - it makes Adora feel self conscious. Catra nods at something she says and then the woman seems to say something else that Adora cant possibly lip read without the context of the conversation, and that's when Adora realises, with a sickening drop in her stomach, that Catra *isn't* translating. Catra does seem to tense, however, at whatever the girl says. She seems slightly annoyed now, and Adora has no idea why. She wishes she could know if she should punch this girl for offending Catra in some way or not.

Instead, Adora draws her attention to Catra. She looks *incredible* . Catra always looked incredible, but tonight she looked so hot it should be a crime. She wore a red shirt, that was half-way unbuttoned, exposing her chest that was concealed by a black tight top below, she had the shirt tucked into some skinny, tight, black trousers that had gold stripes up the sides that were held up by a belt and she wore her hair in a ponytail. But, to top it all off, as if Catra had been trying to make Adora gay panic with her fashion choices, she was wearing a *leather jacket* . Adora had seen her wear it before, of course, but something about it being worn with this outfit had Adora on the verge of a nosebleed. She was still wearing her combat boots though.

Adora was wearing a blue button down tucked into white trousers. She knew white was somewhat of a risky and bold colour, but it looked good on Adora. Catra had given her a long look over at the start of the night that made her confident with her choice in clothes.

Catra says something else and Adora was concerned about whatever it was that was happening but she also feels anxiety at the fact that Catra isnt translating the conversation for her . Ttat is a huge concern for her, Adora feels almost sick, her heart is beating so fast it's rattling her rib cage. Tte girl rolls her eyes before she turns to leave and then Catra turns to face Adora fully. She pauses when she sees her and Adora smiles weakly. " *Are you okay? You look pale* ."Catra signs. Catra' s eyebrows pinch together in concern and she actually looks incredibly cute but Adora cant focus on that right now.

" *What did she say* "?Adora asks, her fingers shaking just a little *too* noticeably. Catra looks at her with concern before she shakes her head a little.

" *Nothing* ."Catra responds. Ttat' s about the *worst* thing Catra could say to Adora. Adora stares at her before she backs away slowly.

" *I need… I need… air* ."Adora signs quickly before she turns and walks away. f Catra calls for her , or follows her, Adora doesnt know , but she really could use that air - she feels suffocated currently.

When Adora manages to shoulder check her way out of the club, she takes a long gulp of fresh air. She finds a wall down the side of the club and leans against it, while bending over to place her head between her knees and takes deep breaths to calm herself down. She does that for a long moment before she starts to feel better and she slowly pushes herself upright again. When she does, she sees Catra standing just a ways of f from her. " *Are you okay ?*" Catra asks hesitantly. Adora sighs and then nods.

" *I'm okay* ."Adora confirms. That entire situation was just *a lot* and Adora managed to work herself up into a panic.

" *Do you want to talk about it ?*" Catra asks tentatively . Adora smiles a little at the invitation - and it is an *invitation* . t reminds her of Catra's birthday, which is ironic, given it is now Adora's birthday, when they had stood on the balcony, Catra getting air. Adora appreciated this about them, they didnt pressure each other into voicing their concerns, they were both patient. Adora blows out a breath. She might as well tell Catra.

" *I asked you what she said* ."Adora signs. Catra blinks at her .

" *I didn't think it was important* ."Catra explains and Adora looks at the ground for a moment. Her aim isnt to make Catra feel bad here, but she does wish to explain to her why what she said and did bothered her so much.

“ *That’s for me to decide, isn’t it ?*” Adora asks. Catra turns her head to the side. “ *If I wasn’t Deaf, I would have heard what she said, important or not, but I can’t hear, and you telling me it’s nothing, it just doesn’t feel… great.* ”Adora explains. Catra’ s eyes seem to light up in realisation and then she immediately looks guilty. “ *You didn’t translate for me either, which you usually do. I guess it was a lot all at once, I’m sorry* .”

“ *Why are you sorry ?*” Catra questions, stepping closer . She steps into Adora’s space and takes her hands. Catra’s hands are warm and they feel vivid as they hold Adora’ s cold ones. She squeezes them softly and then kisses her knuckles and Adora cant help but smile. She spots her ‘A ’necklace around her neck and the sight of it soothes her as Catra’s presence also soothes her. Slowly, Catra takes her hands away so she can sign to Adora again. “ ***Im*** *sorry, do you still want to know what she said?* ”Catra asks. Adora considers it. Part of her thinks it probably doesnt matter , but she also *really* wants to know, so she nods.

Catra seems to hesitate for a moment, before she sighs and begins to sign. “ *When you came over she asked if you were deaf and I said yes. She then said you didn’t look deaf and then I got pissed* .”Catra explains. She goes from hesitant to angry, Adora *sees* it. Adora is exceptionally good at reading people’s body language - sometimes that’s all she has to go off - and the way Catra’s eyebrows turn down a little and she frowns, her eyes darkening a little, she is clearly angered from what the woman had said to her. Adora, honestly, isnt that bothered. She is well accustomed to ignorant people, people have accused her of lying about being Deaf, it comes with the territory, but Adora suddenly realises something: Catra wasnt attempting to exclude her from the conversation, she was trying to *protect* Adora. That makes Adora soften considerably , but Catra is too worked up to notice. “ *I asked her what a deaf person looked like.*

Who even says something like that? It's messed up-" Catra's rapid and jerky hand movements are cut of f when Adora *kisses* her.

Catra is clearly surprised because Adora sees Catra's eyes widen before they both close their eyes. Adora has *missed* kissing Catra, and she cant believe she' s waited this long. Somehow, Adora ends up pinning Catra to the wall as she kisses her hungrily. t quickly goes from innocent to heated in seconds, like all their pent up frustration, and lack of kissing recently, is *finally* relieved. Catra is more aggressive than usual, and her tongue finds its way into Adora's mouth - not that she's complaining. Adora goes from leading, to following pretty quickly .

Catra bites Adora's bottom lip and she doesnt hear it, but she *knows* she moans at the sensation it gives her. t sends a spark of electricity right up her spine, and somewhere else too, as Catra eagerly switches their positions, pinning Adora against the hard wall instead. Adora places her hands on Catra's hips, pulling her impossibly close while Catra's hands slide into Adora's hair, destroying her ponytail. Adora must have sunk down against the wall, because Catra isnt on her tiptoes to kiss her like usual, and Adora *definitely* feels like she may have melted from the way that Catra is kissing her.

Adora moves her hands to the belt loops of Catra's pants and she tugs on them. That' s when Catra pulls back. When they part, they stay close, Catra leans her forehead against Adora's and she brushes her soft lips against Adora's as their hot breath mingles in the space between them as they both pant. t' s cold out, and their hot breath makes small clouds in the cold temperature between them, but Adora feels endlessly warm from that kiss.

It takes them a long moment, but eventually Catra takes a step back and Adora gives her a dazed, lopsided smile before she begins to sign to her again. “ *Was she flirting with you before I got there?* ” Adora sees Catra let out a bark of laughter and her dilated lustful pupils light up with amusement instead. She nods in answer.

“ *I wasn’t interested* .”Catra says. “ *She’s not my type* .”

“ *What is your type* ?”Adora asks curiously with a smirk.

“ *Definitely not tall, blonde, soccer players, that’s for sure* .”Catra signs back but she has a playful smile on her face. Adora knows for a *fact* that that’s not the least bit true.

“ *I guess my type isn’t short and incredibly intelligent brunettes* .” Adora jabs back. Catra rolls her eyes at her playfully before she shoves Adora’s shoulder, then extends her hand, nodding her head in the direction of the club.

Adora stands upright and begins to follow after Catra. “ *Were you jealous, Grayskull* ?”Catra asks teasingly as they make their way back. Adora huffs and rolls her eyes. She hesitates before she nods slowly.

“ *Maybe.* ”Adora signs. Catra looks surprised by her admission but it’s the truth. Adora knows now that she will absolutely ask Catra to

be her girlfriend soon, but later, when Adora wasnt so spun out. Catra smiles.

“ *Come on, birthday girl* ,”She signs. “ *I think Glimmer wanted you to do shots* .”Adora groans at the thought. “ *Hey, you can put your hand on my ass for the rest of the night so people know I’m yours* .” Adora’s breath catches a little. *Me* . Ħat Catra was hers? Adora hadnt been sure that Catra wanted that, but with the confirmation… She still couldnt believe that Catra jµst said that she was Adora’ s.

Adora jµst needed to make it of ficial.

***

Slap. Slap. Slap.

Catra grips her pen in her fist, trying to tune out the sound. She feels bad that it's annoying her, but it is. She's trying to study. Adora had come to visit her before her game tonight. Catra had the late shift at work, she had to close up, which meant she'd have to make her way to the game jµst before it started, *meaning* she couldn't be with Adora beforehand, but she also had a big paper coming up, and she had to get this work done, which meant her time spent with Adora was her studying and Adora sitting on her couch. Except, Adora was dressed in her soccer uniform, which was pretty distracting as it was, but she also had a ball and Adora finds it difficult to sit still.

She probably doesn't mean for it to be annoying, she probably doesn't even know that it *is* annoying, because she can't exactly hear the noise she's making. Adora keeps tossing the thing up and catching it, which makes sense given the position she plays on field but it's less than ideal for Catra's studying habits. Catra knows she probably finds the repetitive motion comforting. Adora does that sometimes, shell find a rhythm she likes and keep doing it, Catra has seen it in the library when her leg bobs up and down under the desk, or shell click her pen a whole bunch of times that people will glare at her (Adora never notices and Catra *always* glares back at them to shut up), sometimes it's her tapping on the desk, just *something* . Currently, it was her and her ball.

Catra sighs and places her laptop down on her coffee table, grabbing the attention of Adora who, unfortunately, was in the middle of tossing her ball *up* that it lands on her *face* . Catra has to cover her mouth to stop herself from laughing out loud. She closes her eyes briefly and when she opens them again, Adora is glaring playfully at her and rubbing her head. " *I'm sorry* ,"Catra signs as she moves to sit on the couch beside Adora. " *That was just too funny not to laugh at.* "Adora rolls her eyes and sets the ball down on the other side of her as she scoots closer to Catra.

" *Was I annoying you?* "Adora asks worriedly . Catra smiles softly at her.

" *Don't worry about it, I can study at work too, I think it'll be a slow day* ."Catra kisses Adora on her jaw gently and pats her thigh.

“ *I should probably get going anyway, to warm up and stuff* .”Adora explains. Catra resists the urge to groan. She kind of jµst wants to cuddle Adora and kiss her, she doesnt want her to go. Catra decides to take matters into her own hands.

She climbs into Adora’s lap, straddling her hips and keeping her trapped against the couch. Adora’s eyebrows go up and the pupils of her eyes dilate somewhat. “ *This okay ?*”Catra asks and Adora nods her head. “ *Do you mind if I kiss you ?*”Catra asks, wanting confirmation that Adora would be okay with it. She nods so eagerly that it draws a laugh out of Catra.

Adora is hard to resist for several reasons and Catra cant believe she missed out on getting to know Adora sooner. f she had only gone to one of Scorpia’s games - in her defence, Catra *hates* sports, but she was going for *Adora* . Especially motivated by seeing Adora in her goalie uniform. t clung to her , showing off her muscles, even if it was long sleeved. t had threads of gold laced through it and Catra had learnt that she was known on the field as *She-Ra* , for her height, stature and her ability to save the most impossible of goals - it was also printed on her back. Adora’s hands come to Catra’s hips and Catra doesnt know why , but the fact that Adora is wearing her goalkeeper gloves is so *hot* . Her gloves are gold and white too.

Catra moves in to kiss Adora. Catra has to say, she loves how easily Adora gives in to her. Sure, sometimes Adora can be handsy, and lead kisses, but when Catra takes control, Adora follows her. t’ s kind of sweet actually. Catra has a pretty good idea of which way Adora leans in the bedroom - though she really did take charge that night in Catra’s childhood bedroom. Catra sometimes thinks about it when she’s alone and.tending to her needs. Even now , she can feel the

invisible touch of Adora's hands on her chest. The thought makes Catra roll her hips a little.

Adora lets out a soft moan and Catra manages to slip her tongue into her mouth. Adora melts under her, and her hands at Catra's hips squeeze softly as she pulls Catra closer. This kiss is quickly turning heated and Catra can feel her body responding to Adora in ways it never really has with anyone else before.

Eventually, Catra pulls back. Adora chases after her lips before she lets out a long dreamy sigh and collapses back into her seat, her eyes closed. Catra is happy to see that Adora is affected by her as much as Catra is affected by Adora. Part of Catra wonders why they haven't gone further than what they have, but she understands Adora's nerves surrounding it. Still, the sooner they talked about it, the sooner they could relieve some of *that* tension. Catra just didn't want to pressure Adora, that was all.

Slowly, Adora blinks her eyes open and then she gets a big goofy smile on her face. Catra lets out a soft laugh at the sight of it. Adora is hot, sure, but she is also remarkably *cute* too. Catra lifts her hands to cup Adora's face as she gently rubs circles into her jaw. *She's so beautiful*. Adora speaks first - or signs first. "*Wow*," She says and Catra snorts. "*That was amazing. I was wondering, would you mind if I gave you a sign name?*" Adora asks. Catra turns her head to the side a little. "*It's something Deaf people do, it's quicker than for me to spell your name out every time*." She explains. Catra knows exactly what a sign name is, she just wasn't expecting it.

“ *Go ahead* .”Catra signs back, dropping her hands from Adora’ s face in order to reply. Adora pauses now and Catra can feel her heart beating faster. She isnt sure if it’ s from the kiss or if it’s maybe from Adora adding a new level to their relationship - it’s probably both.

Adora begins her signing, she starts with the sign for baby, as in, an *actual* baby and not the sign for the pet name baby. Catra raises her eyebrows as Adora grins and then lifts her hand up to her cheek, making the sign for cat. Catra blinks a little. "Baby ... Cat?" Catra asks (and signs) with a little confusion. *Wait a second... Did Adora mean* ***Kitten*** *?* There was no of cial sign for kitten, but baby cat pretty much did it. Catra laughs in a mixture of disbelief and amusement. " *You want my sign name to be baby cat?* "Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. Adora looks at her with shiny eyes of amusement. Catra knows sign names are significant and important in Deaf culture, so she's honoured that Adora feels close enough to give her one.

Catra pulls out her phone and shows Adora a picture of a kitten and Adora nods her head enthusiastically. Catra can't help but smile. " *If you get to call me baby cat-* "Adora interrupts to point at the phone. Catra rolls her eyes, replacing baby cat’with Kitten’in her head. " *Kitten* ,"She points at the phone. " *Can I give you one?* "Adora nods happily and Catra smirks. She makes her sign with her fingers, moving them from one shoulder to the other before she moves it down to her hip. Adora blinks at her.

" *Princess* "? Adora raises a brow . “ *Why am I Princess* "?

“ *Why am I Kitten, other than my name?* ”Catra fires back and Adora lets out a wonderful sound of amusement and laughter. “ *Plus, you are a Princess, my Princess* .”Adora actually *blushes* at that.

Adora grows quiet, staring at the ground, avoiding Catra’ s eyes. Catra just waits, knowing Adora had more to say . Eventually, she lifts her head again, meeting Catra’s eyes. She looks nervous, Catra notes, which she confirms when she sees the nervous tremor in Adora’s fingers as she begins to sign again. “ *There’s something else I want to call you* .”Adora signs carefully . Catra frowns a little in concern. Adora seems *really* nervous. Catra turns her head to the side, nodding to encourage Adora to continue. “ *I want…”* Adora pauses. “ *I want to call you my… girlfriend* .”

Catra feels like the world stops. She keeps replaying the girlfriend sign over and over again in her head. Adora wanted to be her *girlfriend* ? She wanted to date Catra? The question had caught her completely off guard. It’ s not that Catra didnt want that, but she kind of thought Adora didnt want to be her girlfriend, that she liked their current question mark relationship status, Catra was clearly *wrong* . “What?” Catra says dumbly but Adora seems to catch it anyway .

“ *I just mean, we have been kissing a lot, and I don’t really want to date anyone else other than you, I haven’t since we met. And when you told that girl that I was your friend, and not girlfriend, it kind of hurt I guess? I don’t know-* ”Adora’ s hands start to move quickly to the point that Catra doesnt fully understand her signs. It’ s like when someone rambles nervously, Adora sometimes does it with her hands, it’s very endearing actually.

Catra's eyes move from Adora's worried and anxious face to her hands and Catra reaches her hands out to take them, stopping Adora's anxious signing. Catra brings her gloved hands up to her lips and kisses them. They smell of rubber , and Catra wishes she could kiss Adora's actual hands, but it gets Adora to take a breath. Catra slowly looks back up with her, beaming with happiness as she releases Adora's hands. " *I would love nothing more than to be your girlfriend.* "Adora looks shocked at that and Catra laughs, shaking her head. " *Did you think I'd say no* "? Catra asks, poking Adora on her forehead.

" *I thought you might* ."Adora admits before she fully relaxes. Catra hadn't realised how tense she had become underneath her until then. " *Your answer is yes? We're girlfriends* "?

" *We're girlfriends* ."Catra confirms and then it hits her (as it also seemingly hits Adora) Adora is her *girlfriend* . They're *exclusive* . Catra hasn't had the best track record when it comes to relationships, but with Adora it just all seems to slide so easily into place. Catra is confident that she wants nothing more than to be Adora's girlfriend, officially, and she is! Adora is *her* girlfriend. The thought makes Catra feel giddy, like a teenage girl getting asked to prom.

" *I really should go though* ,"Adora signs. *Oh. Right.* Catra was still pinning Adora to her couch.

Catra sighs and rolls off of the blonde, landing on the cushion beside her. Adora kisses her on her cheek and then stands up. Catra watches her as she begins to fix her soccer uniform, tucking her shirt

into her shorts and rolling her knee high socks up her legs. Should Catra be concerned that she finds this so incredibly sexy? Or is that completely normal? When it comes to Adora, Catra thinks it might be normal.

Once Adora has fixed herself up, she grabs her sports bag and slings the thing across her chest. " *So you're coming to the game* "? Adora asks. Catra nods.

" *As soon as I close up, I'll be on my way.* "Catra smiles.

" *Will you be wearing my jersey* "? Adora asks with a grin. Catra rolls her eyes fondly.

" *Obviously I will be wearing my girlfriend's jersey* ."Catra signs back. Adora blushes a little and rubs the back of her neck before she signs again.

" *I still can't believe you said yes* ."Adora signs and Catra raises an eyebrow. She stands to her feet and comes face-to-face with Adora. She leans up on her tiptoes and then presses a kiss to Adora's lips.

" *Dork, of course I said yes* ."Catra had been caught of f guard, sure, but she had been thinking about this ever since they spent the holidays together. Catra *so* wanted to be Adora's girlfriend, and she was just glad that Adora wanted the same. Sometimes she had

thought that her feelings were one sided, but Adora had proved that wasnt true.

“ *You really turned me on before, when you started rolling your hips* .”Adora says suddenly . Catra wasnt expecting *that* . She flushes a little with the new information. t’ s not like it was *new* new, Catra had put two and two together when Adora had *moaned* , but she wasnt expecting Adora to say it or admit it like that. When Catra manages to settle her racing gay heart, she sees that Adora is smirking at her.

“ *Go to your game, Princess* .”Catra says, shoving her towards the door while blushing furiously. When they reach the door, Adora stops and turns to Catra.

“ *Good luck kiss from my girlfriend* ”? Adora asks. Catra rolls her eyes and ignores the way her stomach fills with butterflies at the fact that Adora keeps calling her *girlfriend* . Something about seeing it signed makes it feel even more significant. Catra gives in and kisses Adora one last time before she turns her around and pats her on her butt to send her on her way. Adora looks over her shoulder one last time, blushing, before she walks off.

Catra closes her door and leans against it, sighing lovingly. Catra feels so incredibly happy, happier than she’s ever felt before. t reminds her of when Adora first kissed her. She can honestly say that she has never felt this way about someone before. Catra’s moms used to tell her that you got one greatest love in your life. Adora is that love. Catra cant explain it, she feels inexplicably connected to Adora on a level that is almost scary. Catra thanks

every higher being that exists for whatever power it was that brought Adora into her coffee shop that one autumn day.

Catra sighs again and then stands upright. Speaking of said coffee shop, Catra had some studying to do before her shift started. She goes back to her study station (her arm chair) and tries to stop the giddy feeling bubbling in her chest from distracting her too much.

What is Adora doing to her?

***

"Catra?" Catra looks to her left to see Kyle standing there, looking at her.

"What?" She asks, standing up straight.

"I said, should I start sweeping up?" He asks nervously . Catra knows she makes Kyle kind of nervous, probably because Catra doesn't exactly treat men with the most kindness. Catra glances at the clock, they had about ten minutes till closing. Catra had been sure to clean as they went to make less work for them before closing, they could be out of here by half past the hour if they were quick.

"Yeah," Catra says, handing him the brush. "I have a soccer game to get to."

"Oh!" Kyle says suddenly. "Me too! My boyfriend's girlfriend is playing."

"You boyfriend's girlfriend?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. "Who's that?"

"Lonnie, you might know her, she's-"

"*Lonnie?!*" Catra exclaims, her eyes widening. *No way*. She was *totally* going to use this new piece of information against Lonnie. "So she's not your girlfriend?" Catra asks and Kyle shakes his head. "But she's your boyfriend's girlfriend?" Kyle nods. Catra wasn't expecting that, but she has nothing against it. "Good for Lonnie." Still, Catra was absolutely going to bring this up to her.

They don't get any customers in the remaining ten minutes and Catra helps Kyle clean up before she goes to the back and changes her shirt to Adora's jersey. She brings it up to her nose and sniffs it. It smells like Adora. Adora had given her it one day, and Catra had been confused as to why, but now it made sense: Adora wanted her to wear it to her games. It was February, but the weather still hadn't really warmed up enough to brave it in just a shirt, so Catra grabs Adora's letterman jacket. She exits, with Kyle, Catra figured since they were going the same way, they may as well walk together, she locks the shop and the shutters and then they're off.

When they get to the game, Catra can tell it's not far from beginning. Catra loses Kyle, probably so he can go track down his boyfriend. Catra makes her way to the stands, pushing past people to get to where she could see Perfuma and Glimmer standing. "Hey ," Catra greets. "Looks like I'm just on time." Catra comments as she settles on the bench, wedging herself between Glimmer and Perfuma.

"You're actually a little early ," Glimmer says, "the cheerleaders are about to-" Glimmer stops talking suddenly and Catra frowns as Glimmer stands up, climbing onto the bench. Catra cranes her head up to glance over people's heads to see *Bow* in a crop top and pants and *cheerleaders* uniform doing some *incredible* tumbling on the track below.

"Holy shit-" Catra can't believe it.

"WOO!" Glimmer yells. "THAT'S MY BOYFRIEND!" Catra laughs at Glimmer's screaming and then Bow turns and bows before he sends kisses to Glimmer. The crowd cheer for him before the cheerleaders begin their routine as the players file out onto the field.

Catra has to admit, she's never been to sports games before, but the atmosphere is almost *electric* . Everyone around them seems to be buzzing with excitement. The opposite team comes out and the crowd boos and Catra laughs and then their team comes out and Catra has to stand on her bench in order to be seen by Adora. Catra waves her hands to get Adora's attention and Catra watches her eyes scan the crowd before they land on Catra. Catra smiles so wide

her cheeks hurt and it’s made only better when Adora makes a little heart on her chest to Catra.

Some girl behind Catra gasps. “Do you think that was to me?” They ask. “Oh my gosh, did She-Ra just make a love heart to me!?” Catra snorts. She never really considered that Adora would have adoring fans but it makes sense that she does, she’s a very attractive, tall, blonde, jock, of course people have crushes on her. Too bad, she’s all *mine*. All they have to do is read the back of her jacket.

“Go Adora!” Catra yells. She knows Adora can't hear her, but that is not going to stop Catra cheering for her. Adora gives her a thumbs up before she turns to her team huddle.

“Hey, you're part of the jock significant other group now.” Glimmer comments from beside Catra. Catra laughs as she stands off of the bench, so she wouldn't fall.

“Does this mean this will become my regular?” Catra questions.

“What? Soccer games? Probably.” Glimmer replies. “But it’s nice, you get to see the person you love do something they love, you know?” Catra blushes a little at the love’ part of Glimmer’s words. Catra doesn't know about love, but she really does like Adora a whole lot.

“Scorpia is a defender ,” Perfuma says proudly . “She’ s very good at it.”

“I’m sure she is.” Catra responds. She watches Adora jog over to her goal, warming up a little by sidestepping on the line of her goal. Catra feels herself flush. Adora is so attractive it’s probably some kind of crime, Catra is sure.

The game starts and Catra watches diligently , during half time Adora comes up to the stands and Catra kisses her despite how sweaty she is. Adora really is a talented goalkeeper, she manages to make some *amazing* saves and by the second half Bright Moon is leading 1-0. Catra can tell the other team are not playing how they should be, deploying some dirty tactics against the Rebels that has resulted in a few yellow cards for them. Catra still cheers on her *girlfriend* .

Suddenly, within Bright Moon’s box, one of the opposite team’s players shoulder checks one of the Bright Moon players. Catra can see some kind of commotion between the players but she cant see precisely. She's not exactly a giant soccer fan, or any kind of team sports fan for that matter, but the Rebels seem to be arguing with their opponents after that nasty take down. Catra recognised the Rebel player as Mermista. That was definitely an illegal tackle.

Adora is in the crowd of players trying to calm things down, with her height and her golden blonde hair, Catra can make her out pretty clearly - plus her white and gold kit make her stand out from the others. Adora isn't saying anything, but she is putting herself in front of her players. What a kind hearted idiot.

Unfortunately, Adora's attention is divided as she tries to keep the peace between the two teams and she turns to the opposition at just the wrong time as one of their players swings. Catra isn't sure they intended to hit Adora, or another player, but it doesn't matter because they hit *Adora* . Adora is obviously and completely caught off guard. Catra is far away, but even she can tell the punch was *hard* and hit Adora right in the eye. Catra completely freezes as she sees Adora crumple.

Time seems to stop for a moment, the people in the stands gasp then fall silent. Catra is moving without even thinking about it. She pushes past people and to the barrier, hopping over the edge and landing in a crouch on the track below. Catra takes off in a sprint to where Adora was lying motionless on the pitch. The referee is blowing their whistle and showing a red card but Catra doesn't care. She only cares about Adora.

Catra skids to a stop and drops down to look at Adora. She hears Scorpia say her name in surprise but Catra is busy checking out Adora's face. She's awake, thankfully, but she definitely seems dazed. Her eye is watery and she keeps blinking as she tries to regain her vision. There's a tiny cut under her eye from the impact and it already seems red. She was absolutely going to have a black eye from this. "*Okay*?" Catra signs, trying to keep her words short for Adora to understand.

"Can't." Adora shakes her head after she speaks and Catra notices that she seems flustered. Catra realises that Adora doesn't want to speak in front of so many people, but she probably can't sign either due to her dazed expression - plus, god knows if she had a

concussion. Catra helps her sit up and then she turns to see the player that had punched Adora.

"Are you serious?" Catra growls. "What kind of person punches someone like that?!" Catra knows for a fact that Adora never said anything either, yet the person had still punched her.

"I wasn't aiming for her!"

"That doesn't make it better!" Catra yells. "You're lucky she's okay or I'd be kicking your ass right now!" Catra sees the Rebels' coach come over.

"Take Adora to the locker rooms," She says. "We'll have our substitute goalie take her place." Catra nods. She knows Adora isn't going to like missing out on the rest of the game, but there is no way in hell she can continue to play.

Catra helps Adora to her feet and then begins to lead her off of the field silently. Catra hears the game continue distantly as she enters the locker room. She deposits Adora down onto one of the benches and then she looks at her properly. Adora seems *very* quiet and not fully present. "*Ice*." Catra signs, telling Adora she was going to go get some ice for her eye. Adora doesn't respond at all and Catra is slightly worried about that.

Catra manages to track down that ice pack, and she grabs a bottle of water for Adora too, before she returns back to Adora. The locker room is dark, the only light is coming from one of the nearby bathrooms, bathing Adora in a soft white light. She's fiddling with her fingers and her dazed expression has changed to one that looks like she's thinking but also not present.

Catra comes over to the bench and shuffles Adora back on it slightly before she sits in front of her, straddling the bench between her legs. She lifts the ice pack to Adora's eye. Adora winces a little and pulls a face before she sighs. She takes the water bottle and takes a few sips. Adora seems far away and Catra just wants to make sure she's okay. "*Okay?*" Catra asks again. Adora looks at her but she doesnt answer right away.

"*I haven't been punched like that in years.*" Adora finally signs. "*Not since Light found me.*" Catra's breath gets stuck in her throat in realisation. Adora had told her about her life in the orphanage with her foster carer (Catra does *not* give Shadow Weaver the title of mom whatsoever) but she hadnt really pushed her beyond what she was willing to share.

Catra hesitates before she begins to sign - she has to put the ice down in order to do it. "*Shadow Weaver, did she… used to abuse you?*" Catra asks carefully. Adora shakes her head after a moment.

"*Not physically,*" Adora answers. "*But the other kids… Kids can be so mean, you know?*" Catra does know. Catra's heart aches in her chest at the thought of a young Adora being hit by the other kids she was living with. She had already told her how they used to tease her

sometimes, but she had no idea they had physically harmed her. “ *I was just the Deaf girl to them, an easy target, and Weaver didn’t care if the other kids hurt me, she said it built character.* ”Catra shakes her head as she picks up the ice pack again. She feels angry, but that was the past, she had to find a way to help Adora *now* .

“ *You’re not back there* ,”Catra reassures, signing as best she can. Adora smiles and the sight of it warms Catra endlessly. The blonde places her hand over Catra’s on the ice pack to allow Catra better range to sign. “ *You’re with me, and you’re safe, and I will never hurt you* .”Adora drops the ice pack.

“ *I will never hurt you* ,”Adora signs, her hands holding a certain weight to them, and Catra knew that Adora was being, without a doubt, completely serious - she absolutely meant every single word. “ *I promise* .”Catra’s heart squeezes in her chest. Part of Catra had been afraid that Adora would hurt her, she already knew she was in *deep* but after Adora asked her to be her girlfriend. If Adora broke her heart, Catra knew she would break as a person.

Catra takes Adora’s hands in her own, she had taken her gloves off in Catra’s absence, and Catra seizes the opportunity to lift them up to her lips and kiss them. “ *I promise* .”Catra repeats, crossing her heart before she presses her fingers to Adora’s chest. They would never hurt each other. Of course, Catra knew that there would be highs and lows, those were inevitable, that was life, but Catra would never intentionally hurt Adora in any way.

Adora stares at her for a long moment before she leans forward and wraps her arms around Catra in a tight hug. They spend so much time kissing, and making out, that Catra had almost forgotten the simple intimacy that a hug provides. Catra brings her hands up and wraps her arms around Adora's waist. She buries her nose in Adora's neck and takes a long inhale, drinking in her scent.

After a long moment of them just hugging, Adora leans back in order to sign. " *Take me home* ?" She asks.

" *Always* ."

***

Catra takes Adora back to her apartment. She was feeling better emotionally, physically? Her eye stung like a bitch and it hurt whenever she moved her face in a certain way, but she'd be fine. They get back to Adora' s apartment and Catra sets her down on Adora's couch. They so rarely hang out here, mostly because Adora lived with Glimmer and Bow, so they were often hanging around, whereas Scorpia was often absent from Catra's place, staying with Perfuma.

" *Ignore the Christmas decorations, I was meant to get around to taking them down* ."Adora signs as Catra sits down on the cof fee table across from Adora. Adora sees her laugh a little. t was dark in the apartment, except for the LED lights that were still on the Christmas tree in the corner. Catra's apartment was usually well

organised and clean, Adora's was definitely more chaotic. Adora's room was neat and tidy, she made a conscious effort, even if it was difficult, to keep that space organised, but three students living in one space and sharing a kitchen, bathroom and living room? It was obviously a little chaotic, even if Bow often cleaned.

They did have a system. Adora made sure her room and the bathroom was clean, Bow cleaned the kitchen and then Glimmer and Bow shared keeping the living room clean and Glimmer tackled their room, but their system wasn't always perfect and sometimes they were simply too busy or tired. " *Sorry for the mess* ."Adora apologises. Catra simply waves her hand.

" *Feels like home* ."Catra responds with a smile and Adora knows exactly what she means. When Adora had shared a dorm with Glimmer the first year, they had had to keep it clean for room inspections and things, but this apartment? It was *lived* in, they had made so many memories here, Adora loved it just as she loved her best friends. Still, she wasn't sure she could stay with them next year, part of her was considering asking Catra - but she didn't want to put pressure on their relationship, like what would happen if they broke up? And she also didn't want to kick Scorpia out of her place to steal Catra away from her, though Adora is sure she would love to live with her girlfriend Perfuma.

" *What's it like living with a couple* ?" Catra asks, distracting Adora from her thoughts.

" *I'm glad I can't hear whatever it is they get up to in their room* ." Adora admits and she sees Catra snort. " *And I have seen things I*

wish I could unsee ."Catra just looks highly amused by that. She shuffles closer to check out Adora's face, gently moving it and holding her chin with her thumb and finger. Catra squints a little as she examines Adora's face and Adora doesnt know why , but she blushes.

After a moment, Catra releases her face. " *I think the cut has already scabbed over but we should maybe put some disinfectant on it just to be sure and maybe ice your eye a little more."* Adora nods at all of that and then she glances at the bathroom door.

" *Can I shower first* "?She asks. Catra pauses before she nods.

" *Sure, I'll order us some food.* "Adora stands to her feet, wobbling only a little. She moves to her bedroom to grab some fresh clothes and then goes to the bathroom, closing the door and locking it.

Adora unfastens her boots first, kicking them off, she struggles to pull her socks off of her shin pads but she manages and tosses them aside before she takes her shin pads off. Next she pulls her shorts down and takes her shirt and bra off and tosses them into a pile on the floor - Adora would clean it up later. She runs the water of the shower and takes a moment to look at herself in the mirror. Her eye was already bruising, and there was a small cut there on her cheek. Adora sighs. She was an idiot for getting between the players without fully understanding what they were talking about, but she wasn't expecting to be *punched* . Adora pulls her hair out of it's ponytail, letting the long golden locks sit on her shoulders and sets the hairband on the sink.

She turns to her shower and sees the steam coming off of it. She steps into the tub, pulling the curtain to and then she stands under the stream of hot water. t immediately makes her relax. Adora starts to wash off the sweat and dirt and grime from her game, using her soap. She washes her hair qickly and then spends the rest of her shower jst enpying the hot water . Her mind begins to wander.

She doesnt mean for it to, but she starts to think of Catra in a… intimate way. Adora feels the heat building between her legs. She isnt really sure she should exactly do this, but the shower is the best place for it and she feels.wound up. t would be the perfect relief.

Adora runs her hands down her side to her stomach and then further down. She closes her eyes and imagines that it’s Catra doing this to her and not herself.

At the first touch, Adora feels a moan escape her lips. She hopes that the sound of running water and the door is enough to muffle the sounds Adora is bound to make. Tough she tries to keep qiet, she's not entirely sure how loud she's being. Adora is somewhat of an expert when it comes to touching herself and she knows she can get herself off pretty fast and pretty easily, which is perfect for Adora's current situation.

Te steam of the shower has Adora feeling slightly wooz , but the water means that her fingers practically glide as she touches herself. She braces her arm against the wall to keep herself steady as her body temperature begins to rise. She presses her fingers to her clit

and circles a few times before she moves down and carefully, slowly, enters a single digit. Adora moans again, her free hand flexes as she hooks her finger and then adds another.

Adora knows it might be kind of weird to go from being punched in the face to masturbating in the shower, but Adora is nothing if not a little strange - besides, having Catra so worried about her, and her being near was a huge turn on. Adora had been wound up since Catra had made out with her on the couch. " *Catra-!* "Adora gasps, cutting herself off with another moan. Adora removes her fingers and focuses on her clit, she is already pretty close and her hips buck as soon as her fingertips touch her clit again. She just thinks about Catra. *Catra. Catra. Catra* . It works significantly well. Adora comes with Catra's name on her tongue.

Her legs shake a little but Adora manages to keep herself upright. She rinses herself down again once she's regained enough conscious thought and then she steps out of the shower, switching it off. She hopes and prays that Catra never heard any of that. She dries herself down. She had grabbed some jogging bottoms and a t-shirt to change into after her shower just to laze around in while Adora spent time with Catra. She towels off her hair and then exits the bathroom, leaving it down. She was anxious that Catra might not be there if she had heard what Adora had been doing.

At first, Adora does panic, but then she sees a pizza box on the coffee table and Catra in the kitchen. Adora breathes a sigh of relief. Catra smiles at her. " *Pizza came. You wanna eat now* "? Adora nods eagerly and she settles herself on the couch.

She feels clean and she feels relaxed after relieving herself. She eats the pizza with Catra, leaving some slices for Glimmer and Bow and Adora ices her eye for a little longer, wiping the cut with some disinfectant that *stings* , before Adora turns to Catra. " *Hold me* "? Adora asks and Catra nods at her.

Together they retreat to Adora's room. Adora lies down first and then Catra wraps her arms around her, cuddling her from behind like a little jetpack. Adora can't help but smile at the thought. Catra has taken care of her today, and Adora has loved every second of it. She drifts off to sleep easily in her embrace, feeling safe, comfortable and cared for.

That's the first indicator to Adora that her feelings may be deeper than she first thought.

***

Adora arrives at Catra's apartment for their movie night date night. Adora was just happy that they had found some time that they could be together. Adora's eye was bruised, as Catra had suspected it would be, but it was well under way to healing. Catra had said that it made her look sexy, like some boxer or something.

When Catra opens the door, Adora's brain short circuits. Catra had had a haircut. Her hair had been quite long, usually pulled out of her face in a loose bun or held back by her red hairband, but now it was short, not shaved but definitely cut close, where it was longer the

hair was curling in the way Catra's hair usually naturally curled. She looked cute as hell and Adora is entirely too gay to be surprised with this.

" *You look* ." Adora trails of f, losing track of her thoughts to her *gay* thoughts. " *Wow…* " is all Adora manages to articulate. Catra laughs and grabs her wrist, dragging Adora towards her room. As far as Adora could tell, they were home alone - no Scorpia.

" *Usually I wait until it gets a little warmer* ," Catra signs, " *but it was really starting to get on my nerves. I missed how easy short hair was* ." Adora is definitely in support of the short hair , she wants to run her fingers through it as she kisses Catra.

Catra leads Adora into her room. Catra had set up her laptop with some movie on it, on her bed, and she had cuddled into Adora's side pretty quickly . Adora is sure that the current movie playing on their laptop is very interesting, but it's just not as interesting as *Catra* . To be fair, the new hair was like catnip to Adora, she just couldn't get enough of her. Adora runs her fingers along where her skin is exposed before she starts kissing her. Catra, to her credit, is actually paying attention to whatever is on the laptop, Adora just couldn't care less. Adora is far too invested in *Catra* to care.

She kisses up her arm until she makes it to her neck and then she really pulls her A-game out. Catra leans back against her but she's still watching the laptop. Adora nips at her tender skin, kissing down to her collar bone that she sucks on, *marking* her. Catra finally closes the laptop. " *Are you even paying attention?* " Catra signs and Adora

shakes her head. She sees Catra laugh, the breath brushes Adora's face and Adora feels a smile tug at the corner of her lips.

Suddenly they're moving, Catra is under her rather than in front of her, and they're kissing - if you can call Adora having her tongue in Catra's mouth kissing. It suddenly feels hot in Catra' s room. She straddles Catra's hips to the bed with her hands, *squeezing,* and feels Catra moan against her lips. Catra whispers something against Adora's lips, Adora doesn't know what it is, but she doesn't need to. They don't talk during these moments, they communicate almost entirely through body language, looks, gestures and occasionally signing.

Catra's hands come up to bury themselves in Adora's hair, destroying her ponytail. Adora moans into Catra's mouth. She moves her hands up to cup Catra's face, tilting her head back and kissing her fully, hotly, desperately, like they might never kiss again. Catra's hands land on Adora's stomach, slipping under her shirt, and Adora gasps. Catra bites her bottom lip gently and Adora groans. She practically *melts* .

"Shirt."Adora speaks and looks at Catra hopefully . Catra's eyes flutter open. Blue-gold meets blue in the darkness and then Adora sees Catra nod. Adora moves down, peeling Catra's shirt up slowly, exposing inch-by-inch, smooch soft skin. Adora kisses from the waistband of Catra's pants, up her stomach and she trails her tongue over her belly button. She feels Catra arch off of the bed, and Adora smirks. She stops when she reaches more fabric. Catra seems to freeze.

Adora stops immediately. She looks up at Catra, who was looking at her incredibly nervously. "Of f?" Adora asks. She gestures to her own shirt and then Catra's. Catra bites her lip before she nods. Adora helps her take the shirt off completely, that's when Adora learns that Catra sometimes binds. She recognises it only because Bow had used them before his top surgery, Adora had even considered buying one for herself, but she usually felt comfortable in her sports bras. She looks at Catra. Catra looks *nervous* , maybe even afraid, which is insane to Adora that she would be nervous to reveal she is wearing a binder. f anything, Adora completely understands that.

Adora brings her hands up to sign, she is thankful for the moonlight spilling in through the window that allows for Catra to see. " *Do you want to keep it on?* "Adora asks. Catra seems stunned for a moment.

" *You're not... weirded out?* "Catra asks and Adora smiles. She sees the moment Catra instantly relaxes.

" *Not even a little, why would I be?* "Adora asks, turning her head to the side. Catra shrugs in a ' *I don't know* ' gesture.

" *You like boobs.* "Catra signs and Adora laughs. She shuf fles closer, resting her hands on Catra's hips. Catra looks into her eyes with surprise. Adora withdraws her hands only so she can sign her words.

" *I do like boobs, true* ."Adora agrees. " *But I like touching you* ," Adora emphasises the 'you' as she gently nudges Catra's chest with her fingers, " *the most. Whatever makes you feel most comfortable* ." Adora smiles as she drops her hands.

Catra stares at her for a long moment before she suddenly drags Adora in for a heated kiss. Adora makes a sound of surprise - she's sure - from the suddenness but Catra doesn't seem to mind. Adora kisses her back happily, threading her fingers into the short hairs at the back of Catra's neck.

When they pull away, Catra is panting, like she's been running a race, and her pupils are blown wide. She has the most beautiful smile, Adora notes, as she sees her smiling so genuinely and so happily at her. "Adora Grayskull,"Catra speaks but Adora manages to read her name on Catra's lips. "I---- 'm -- ---- ---- you."Adora blinks a little. She doesn't know what Catra just said then. She looks at her with a puzzled expression. Catra pauses for a long moment that Adora thinks she might not explain. " *You're amazing.* "Catra signs. Adora is pretty sure that isn't what Catra said, but maybe it was something similar anyway. Adora smiles at her.

" *I know I am.* "Adora signs back and Catra chuckles, her body doing the little rumbling thing it does whenever she laughs.

" *And humble too.* "She jokes. Adora pecks her on the lips.

" *What does this mean?* "Adora asks. " *Do you want me to use different pronouns? Different name? What do you need?* "Catra stares at her with absolute *awe,* that it makes Adora blush a little. *This is the bare minimum, isn't it?* Catra looks at her like Adora hung the stars and the moon in the sky. She shakes her head.

" *She/They, whatever. Still Catra.* "Catra answers. " *It means that gender is really fucking weird, and sometimes I like to bind.* "She signs and Adora nods. She totally gets that. *Fuck gender.* " *You can still touch me though.* "Adora laughs a little. They fall into a motionless silence, just looking at each other before Adora speaks.

"Shirt?" She asks. Catra looks at her with great confusion before Adora gestures to the hem of her own shirt. Catra's eyes widen and she looks up at Adora's face as though to check that she was comfortable with that and totally sure. Adora only nods.

Catra reaches for the hem of Adora's shirt and begins rolling it up, exposing Adora's abdomen, and then her sports bra, the shirt gets stuck for a moment, resulting in Adora giggling and feeling Catra laughing too before the thing comes off entirely. Catra gestures to her sports bra. " *This okay too* "? She asks. Adora nods again.

Adora is a little flustered to be showing so much to Catra but she trusts her completely and feels safe and comfortable with her. "Wow" Catra breathes once she manages to slip Adora out of her sports bra. Adora doesnt hear it, but she does manage to read that word pretty well on Catra's lips. Adora blushes a little before Catra looks her in the eyes. " *Beautiful* ."She signs, which makes Adora blush so hard she feels the heat reach the tips of her ears.

They go back to kissing, but this time Adora has a new sensation as Catra gently fondles her breasts. Adora had no idea it could feel this *amazing* , but it does. Catra gently lays Adora back in the bed and Adora happily follows her lead. Catra's breath feels *hot* as she trails her lips along Adora's jaw and down her neck. She pauses there for a moment, opening her mouth to suck on Adora's skin. Adora squirms under her , hooking her leg around their waist. Catra's hips grind down against Adora and Adora's hand at the back of Catra's neck tightens in the short locks there.

The bedroom suddenly feels hot and stuffy with Adora's laboured breathing as Catra goes *lower* . First she leaves open mouthed kisses on Adora's skin, occasionally sucking and *marking* but what really has Adora throwing her head back against the pillow below her head, and arching into Catra's touch, is when Catra runs her hot tongue over her nipple. *Holy shit* . Adora has never felt that feeling before. Dont get her wrong, Adora has had sex before, though not a whole lot, she has *experience* , but things with Catra always feel far more *intense* . It's as though they have some kind of *connection,* and Catra can make Adora feel a way she has never felt before.

Catra opens her mouth and she *sucks* . Adora moans, she knows she moans, she doesnt even care how *vocal* she is being and, judging by the way that Catra doubles her efforts, Catra doesnt seem to mind either. Adora feels so wound up, she feels so close, that she could possibly even get off from this alone. Adora becomes putty under Catra and when the brunette finally pulls away, Adora is almost disappointed. Part of her wants to go further, but she still hasnt managed to bring that topic up to Catra.

hstead, they settle on the bed together , face-to-face. ħey're both bare chested and they cuddle each other, pressing their bare bodies up against each other. Something about this feels far more intimate than anything else they could do. ħey kiss, and Adora reaches her hands up to gently sweep Catra's short bangs out of her face before she sighs lovingly. ħey stare at each other , and Adora kisses Catra on their forehead before she lies back down on the bed.

ħey fall asleep jµst like that.

***

Catra wakes up before Adora, which is a rare occurrence, but Adora had been running a lot of soccer drills recently. She looked so peaceful in a way that a person can only in sleep, her face unmarred by worry and anxiety, and showing her calm, peaceful face. Adora had moved in the night and she was currently lying on her stomach, arms tucked under her pillow, with her golden blonde hair spilling around her. She's absolutely *gorgeous* . Catra kisses her bare shoulder and then she rolls over and stands.

Last night was pretty incredible. Catra hadnt expected Adora to jµst be okay with the binder thing but maybe she shouldnt have doubted her so much. She also hadnt been expecting Adora to take her own shirt off. ħings seemed to have shifted last night, but for the better . Catra grabs a t-shirt and pulls it on before she leaves her room and heads to the kitchen.

Catra sets about making her coffee in a slight daze. *"I think I'm in love with you."* Catra had *said* that to Adora. She's pretty sure that Adora didn't know what she had said but she *had* said it. Catra thought it was a little insane and maybe a lot too soon, but it had come out of her mouth all the same. She had known Adora for about five months, which was a relatively long time, but was it long enough for Catra to be *in* love with her? Catra really didn't know, she was new to the whole love thing. Catra doesn't think she's ever been in love. Of course she loved Scorpia, *loves* her even, but she wasn't, and probably was never, *in* love with her.

Catra finishes making her coffee, she adds two sugars, no milk and moves to her couch. She sits down on it, placing her feet against the edge of the coffee table as she holds her cup close to her face to smell the sweet aroma of coffee. She thinks she really might be in love with Adora. She's never felt this way about someone before, and she doesn't think she ever will feel this way about anyone else either.

Catra sighs and sips at her coffee. She was slowly waking up. She glances at the window to see it was quite sunny outside. If Catra had to guess, it was probably about eleven in the morning if not noon. Catra always slept better when Adora was with her. *What is going on with her?* Catra was acting like some love struck puppy or something.

Catra hears movement in the bedroom and she knows that Adora is awake. She hears shuffling around and then the next minute the slight creak of the door on its hinges. Catra doesn't look at her but she doesn't have to anyway. Adora appears in front of her. "*I want to have sex with you.*" Catra stops what she's doing - as in, sipping her coffee and looking into space - to stare at Adora. Only Adora would

tell Catra that she wants to have *sex* with her in this way. Only Adora would make said announcement in her boxers and tank top in the middle of Catra's living room after they spent all night last night practically making out and *almost* having sex. Adora looks so serious too, like she's been planning this for so long, her hands are on her hips and she has a look of *determination* .

" *Can I drink my coffee first?* "Catra signs back playfully . That throws Adora's whole serious thing off. She practically goes the same shade of red as her letterman jacket.

" *I didn't mean right now* ,"Catra was aware of that but she doesnt say anything as Adora sits down beside her. " *I think we should talk about it, so we're prepared, and then… It can happen when it happens, you know* "So Adora *wants* to have sex with her, and she was putting in the ground work now so they were prepared? That was *so* Adora. But, if it made her feel more relaxed and comfortable, then Catra was willing to listen. " *Safe word* ."Adora signs. " *I can speak if you do something I don't like* ,"Adora explains. "Red."She speaks and Catra smiles a little. Adora is so damn cute.

Adora has a slight accent when she speaks, which makes perfect sense when you think about it. Catra happens to love the way that Adora says her name, and she's sure shell love it even more when Adora says it when Catra has her head between her legs. " *You can hear me perfectly fine* ,"Adora signs. " *But I can't hear you* ."

" *Couldn't I just sign red?* "Catra asks.

“ *What if you don’t have your hands free ?*” Adora asks. Catra raises an eyebrow.

“ *Are you planning on tying me up?* ”Catra asks. Adora blushes and looks away. *Interesting* .

“ *I don’t know* .”Adora signs slowly . “ *Maybe we could use a drop object?* ”Adora suggests. “ *Something that lights up, or that I can see, so we don’t rely on my hearing* .”Adora starts doing that rambly thing with her signs again and Catra stops her by gently taking her hands in her own.

“ *Adora* ,”Catra signs and Adora pauses. “ *I understand why you feel we need to talk it out, but we’ll figure it out, I promise. Don’t worry so much* .”

“ *You know me* ,”Adora signs back with a smile. She takes Catra's hands again. “ *I worry* .”Catra lets out a soft laugh. Adora does worry, about *everything* , but Catra wants her to know she doesnt have to worry about *this* . They can figure it out together , in bed, out of bed, whatever, but Adora doesnt have to *worry* about it.

“ *Is there anything you don’t like ?*” Catra asks curiously . Adora shakes her head.

“ *I don’t think so, you?* ”Catra shakes her head too. At least, she’ s never found something she doesnt like before.

“*Maybe you let me lead* ?” Catra suggests. Adora pauses for a long moment before she nods once. Catra smirks a little, Adora is going to *enjoy* being under Catra. So many thoughts were running through Catra’s mind now, images, scenes, things she wanted to do to Adora, but now wasn’t the time. Adora shuffles closer to Catra and lays her arm over Catra’s shoulders, so they are snuggled together.

So they were going to have sex sometime in the near future? And Catra was in love with Adora. Adora leans over and kisses the side of Catra’s head.

Well, *shit* . Catra was fucked. Literally and figuratively.

Chapter End Notes

They're girlfriends !! Also, as a nonbinary lesbian, I just think Catra binding is neat :) I hope you all enjoyed !! Next chapter will be spicy ;) I hope to see you all again !! See y'all next time <3

first times and first loves

Chapter Summary

> Catra has never felt this way about someone before, it’s exciting and thrilling as much as it’s terrifying. She’s never really been especially good at relationships, but she wants to be with Adora; she wants her to stay, and she’s so terribly afraid of losing her. t’ s true that it’s nice having someone, but it means Catra now has something to lose. She’s never had that before, nothing she’s been sick at the thought of losing - unless you count her friendship with Scropia, Catra values that a whole lot. Losing Adora would qite literally break her heart and leave her a broken person.

Chapter Notes

> Hi all !! Welcome back to Coffee Shop AU !! Ireally hope you enɲy this chapter :)! Please refer to the tags of the fic for this chapter, Iupdated them in preparation, this chapter is why the fic is rated E tbh.
>
> Warning, NSFW ahead !!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Ijust had to let you know you're mine (mine)

Hands on your body, Idon't wanna waste no time

Feels like forever even if forever's tonight

ust lay with me, waste this night away with me

You're mine

- Mine, Baiz

Spring

t takes them some time to find the right opening within their schedules to actually have a night where they could be together fully. t was a couple of weeks before spring break when they finally found a time and place that they could enjoy being with each other in that way. Hey had agreed that Catra's place was probably the better option, and Catra had ensured that Scorpia would be gone all night.

At some point, Catra became very aware of the fact that she was going to be having sex with Adora. Adora, who was also her *girlfriend* . Catra hadn't really thought of it that way before. She'd focused more on actually getting to *have* sex with Adora, that she hadn't really considered the ramifications. Catra has had sex before, lots of times, never with Scorpia but her partner after that - which had been kind of a disaster and there was definitely no love lost there;at least they had understood Catra' s complicated feelings towards gender. She's had a few one night stands here and there but this wasnt just anyone. His was *Adora* . His was sex *with feelings* . Catra was *in love* with Adora.

After Catra had almost confessed her love to Adora, she had sat down and really thought it through and she had come to the same conclusion: she was definitely in love with Adora. Catra had thought

maybe it was just overwhelming adoration for the woman after she had been so relaxed and accepting of her binding, but it wasn't. She liked Adora so much, the thought of her breaking up with her made Catra feel *empty,* just at the idea. At some point, Catra had attached herself to Adora and Adora had hooked her in. So this wasn't just sex, this was a significant step in their relationship. There was no going back. Catra would be all in, attached to Adora in every conceivable way. It was kind of terrifying.

Catra has never felt this way about someone before, it's exciting and thrilling as much as it's terrifying. She's never really been especially good at relationships, but she wants to be with Adora;she wants her to *stay,* and she's so terribly afraid of losing her. It's true that it's nice having someone, but it means Catra now has something *to lose*. She's never had that before, nothing she's been sick at the thought of losing - unless you count her friendship with Scropia, Catra values that a whole lot. Losing Adora would quite literally break her heart and leave her a broken person.

Catra sighs as she wipes down the counter. She had sent Kyle to go clean some mugs while she covered the front counter. It was a relatively quiet day and Catra was glad for it, it meant her nerves about what she had planned tonight weren't getting more frayed by stupid customers. That is, until she sees a familiar person enter the coffee shop.

Catra meets her eyes immediately and raises an eyebrow at her. "Sparkles." Catra greets as Glimmer stops in front of her. "Can I help you?"

"I came for coffee." Glimmer says. Catra doesn't believe her but she gestures to the menu behind her.

"So order something." Catra responds. Glimmer huffs. Catra can tell that Glimmer did not come here for coffee, Adora already told her that Glimmer preferred the mainstream places like Starbucks, so she must have an ulterior motive for being here.

Glimmer is silent for a long period of time before she opens her mouth. "Adora told me what you're planning on doing." Glimmer says. Catra freezes for a moment.

"I don't see how this is any of your business." Catra deadpans. She had no idea why Glimmer had come here purposely to talk to Catra about this, but she didn't like it. "Are you going to order something or not?"

"Fine, give me an iced caramel latte with extra caramel." Glimmer responds. Catra rolls her eyes before she moves down the line to start making Glimmer's coffee. Glimmer, unfortunately, follows her to the end. "I didn't bring it up for no reason," Glimmer says. "I just... I want to be sure that you're not planning on hurting Adora." Catra scoffs.

"What did you think my plan was? Sleep with her and break up with her?" Catra questions.

"No!" Glimmer exclaims. "No, I can see that you like her a lot."

"So what's the problem, Sparkles?" Catra asks, raising her eyebrows.

"There isn't a problem," Glimmer says. "Just that Adora has been through a lot in her life and she's like family to me. Adora has Mara, but she also has Bow and I, we're her family."

"This is all very sweet," Catra says as she makes the latte for the cup, "but it doesn't explain why you came in here talking about how Adora and I are planning to have sex."

"I just want to warn you," Glimmer says. "I know your mom did to Adora-"

"What?" Catra asks, stopping her motions. "My mom… what?" This was the first that Catra was hearing about this. Sure, after Adora had left during Christmas break, after they did… *that thing* in Catra's bed, her moms had asked her if Adora and her were dating, but she had *no idea* one of them had threatened her, or *warned* her as Glimmer put it - it was probably Cyra, she always was protective.

"Your mom," Glimmer says, blinking, "look, I mean, it's fine, she was just telling Adora to figure out her feelings before it hurt you both, she was trying to protect you, and I'm trying to protect Adora. I love her, she's my best friend, she's *family*, and I want you to be sure

before you do this because it's serious, and I've never seen Adora this way with anyone before. You have the potential to break her heart, I just want to protect her from that." Catra sighs as she pours the coffee over the ice to make Glimmer's drink. She turns and places the cup down on the counter in front of Glimmer.

Catra can appreciate that Glimmer is just trying to look out for Adora, it's kind of sweet actually, Adora has the family she was deprived of when she was younger, but she has no intentions of breaking Adora's heart. "Look, Sparkles," Glimmer scowls at her again for the nickname but Catra simply carries on, "I wouldn't be sleeping with Adora unless I was sure. If you know Adora so well, as you claim, you'd know that we talked about this. I mean, it's *Adora*, of course we've talked about this thing at least ten times already. I'm sure. This isn't some fling, it's Adora *means* something to me. So rest your pretty pink head assured that I am not going to fuck and duck. Good enough for you?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. Glimmer blushes a little before she picks up her cup.

"Yes," Glimmer finally says. "Just. Please don't hurt her. I've seen Adora sad before it can get dark." Glimmer says. Catra was curious what she meant by that but prying about Adora behind her back feels wrong. Catra is the same, sometimes she has bad days, like a cloud hanging over her head, it can get dark, it's only human, of course Adora got like that too. "Sometimes she pushes herself too hard, it's probably because of that orphanage-"

"I'm gonna stop you there, Sparkles." Catra interrupts. "Adora has told me about that, but what if she hadn't? Were you really about to spill to me about Adora's deep seeded trauma?" Catra asks with an edge to her tone. "I am glad that you seem to care at least. I'm sure you and Arrow Boy take care of Adora when she neglects to, which

Im thankful for , but you dont have to worry about me using her or hurting her. Ihave no intentions to."Glimmer seems a little flustered by Catra's words.

"She' s bad at asking for help, she hates to feel like a burden." Glimmer says.

"She' s not a burden to me, she never has been."Catra says simply . Im excited to have sex with my *girlfriend* , probably like you were with Bow, no?"Glimmer 's cheeks turn red at that.

"Are you really bringing my boyfriend into this?"Glimmer asks.

"Hey , you brought my girlfriend into this."Catra fires back. They stare at each other for a tense moment before Glimmer laughs and Catra smirks a little.

"That' s fair,"Glimmer hums. "Y ou know, youre not so bad, when youre not being a brat anyway ."

"Im always a brat, Sparkles."Catra says, grinning. She knows what Glimmer means though, if they were friends, their chaotic energy combined, and the levels of sarcasm between them, would probably make the world implode and it would probably seem like they seriously disliked each other. When they had first met they had clashed and Catra had annoyed Glimmer a lot, but that's just how they were, Catra was sure. They seemed like they didnt like each

other, because of the sarcasm and the snark, but Catra actually did like Glimmer and she's pretty sure Glimmer likes her too - Catra just likes to annoy Glimmer, it's funny.

"Fine," Glimmer says, taking a sip of her coffee - Catra sees her eyes light up and knows she likes it but also knows Glimmer would drop dead before she ever complimented her. "Have fun having outrageous sex with your girlfriend." Glimmer says. Catra feels herself blush right to the tips of her ears.

"So long as you enjoy having outrageous sex with your boyfriend!" Catra squeaks back. Glimmer laughs which makes Catra laugh. Catra starts wiping the counter, shaking her head. "Alright. You got me there." Catra admits. "But payback will be a bitch."

"At least I know you're intending to stick around then." Glimmer says with a wink. Catra rolls her eyes.

"Whatever Sparkles, get out of here." Catra says dismissively. "Adora is picking me up tonight."

"Like from here or in the bedroom?"

"Oh my-" Catra throws her rag at Glimmer's head and she just manages to duck out of the way while she cackles. "Laugh all you want, but I'm going to kill you!"

That’s terrible customer service.” Glimmer comments with a cheeky grin before she turns and leaves the coffee shop. Luckily for them, there weren't a lot of customers and those that were present, mostly had their heads buried in books with headphones on.

Catra sighs, speaking of books, she goes back to her place at the top of the counter where her current law book lay open. She was studying on shift because spring break was fast approaching which meant that finals would be here soon. Still, Catra had ensured her work was all up to date to give her this night, at least, study free - at least study as in books, she'd be happy to study Adora in a sexy way.

Catra works her shift. It doesn't get particularly busy and when it’s around closing time, Adora walks in the doors. She’s in her soccer uniform of course, she had practice, her eye was fully healed by now, no longer bruised. It had worried Catra how quiet Adora had gotten after being punched, but now she was back to regular old Adora. Well, kind of. At some point she'd had her undercut re-shaved, which should not be as sexy as it is, her hair was still pulled up into her ponytail, with her bangs pulled back into Adora’s signature hair poof, but damn if she didn't look *incredible*. Adora really is a walking stereotype, the undercut, playing *soccer* of all sports, but it works for her - like, *really* works.

Adora smiles at her and Catra feels her heart jump a little in her chest. Adora is taller than her, by a lot actually, she was about six foot, putting Catra at about ten inches shorter than her. Adora was also built solid, her biceps were impressive, and yet Catra was *so*

looking forward to having her under her. She was going to climb Adora like a tree.

“ *Hey you* .”Catra greets with a smirk. “ *Fancy seeing you here* .” Adora rolls her eyes playfully as she walks towards the counter. She’s even taller than usual because she’s wearing her soccer cleats. Catra thinks she maybe won the lesbian lottery.

“ *I’m here for coffee* .”Adora signs cheekily . Catra kind of loves Adora’s cheeky playful side. She has anxiety, which Catra understands well, sometimes it makes her a worrier, and Catra had discovered she had a reputation for being a planner to an almost extreme extent, but Adora *is* capable of relaxing - at least, that’s Catra’s experience. She admits that Adora is often doing *something* , even if it’s just fidgeting, but, with Catra, she often relaxes and finds comfort in just snuggling her .

“ *Sorry* ,”Catra signs. “ *We’re closed, Princess* .”

“ *What a shame, I’ve been told this is the best coffee shop on campus with the most handsome barista* .”Catra blushes a little from Adora’s signs and then she clears her throat, rolling her eyes at Adora, trying to play her flustered state off. “ *I have a surprise for you* ,”Adora signs, “ *but it’ll have to wait until we’re in your apartment* .” Catra raises an eyebrow.

“ *Why? Is it kinky* ?”Catra teases as she finishes wiping down the counter. She glances up to see that Adora was standing still, shifting

her weight from foot to foot while blushing. *Holy shit. It was!* Catra hops over the counter to stand in front of Adora. “ *You have my attention* .”Adora clears her throat.

“ *Later* .”She signs. “ *Do you need help?* ”Adora of fers, because of course she does. Adora has a slight obsession with helping people. Not necessarily a bad thing, though it can be when she puts others in front of herself. Catra kisses her tall blonde on her cheek and then heads over to grab the broom and pan.

“ *Here, you can sweep while I wipe down the tables* .”

“ *Yes ma’am* .”Adora signs before she salutes Catra. Catra laughs a little in amusement as Adora takes the supplies that she needed from Catra and begins sweeping the floor. She had set her sports bag down on the counter in the meantime while Catra began wiping down the tables, lifting the chairs as she completed each one.

t doesnt take them long together for Catra to complete her closing tasks. She goes to the back, taking off her apron and hanging it up for her next shift before she grabs Adora’s letterman jacket and pins her back out the front. Adora has her bag slung over herself and she smiles when she sees Catra. They exit the cof fee shop together, Catra locks the doors and then she puts the shutters down, locking them. Her boss trusted her with the opening and closing of the shop, a responsibility Catra didnt take lightly , so she double checks before they leave.

As they start walking towards Catra's apartment, Catra takes Adora's hand, snuggling up beside the blonde. Catra sees Adora smile as she wraps her arm around her shoulders instead, pulling Catra into her side. The weather was starting to get warmer , finally, as spring came into full swing. Flowers were starting to bloom and leaves were starting to return back to trees. Catra has always found spring and autumn the prettiest seasons of the year, it's a reminder that while things may go, they can always come back beautiful, new and fresh; a new beginning, after an end.

When they get to Catra's apartment building, the atmosphere noticeably shifts. As soon as they enter Catra's apartment complex and climb the stairs to Catra's apartment, they start kissing, hot and heavy. Adora catches Catra off guard as she presses her up against the door, kissing her *hard* . Catra is reminded of their first kiss all those months ago when they'd come back from the bowling alley - that all seemed so long ago now. Catra places her hand on the door knob of her apartment door and twists, opening the door and stumbling backwards as Adora chases her with her lips. They've had this sexual tension for months now, and Catra was looking forward to relieving it.

When they're inside the apartment, Catra closes the door by pushing Adora backwards and against the door. *Holy shit* . *They were really doing this* . Their lips fit together so perfectly , Catra has never felt so right when kissing someone. Catra gestures behind her towards her bedroom and Adora nods. Their lips dont break apart for even a second. Catra almost trips a few times, but they make it to the bedroom without incident - mostly.

When they make it to Catra's bedroom, Catra manages to close her door with her foot. She knows their make out session has been hot,

but she needs to check in with Adora in a way that actually communicates what the hell they're about to do. So Catra calls time of death on this make out session so she can sign to Adora. Adora looks adorable and confused as they both pant. Adora looks so beautiful whenever she's ruffled by *Catra* . " *Time out* ."Catra signs and Adora rolls her eyes fondly, smiling wide.

" *You used the sports gesture* ."She signs and Catra blinks at her . Now that Catra thought about it, Adora was right, that was a sports thing.

" *Was that wrong* ?"Catra asks.

" *Not technically,* "Adora answers. " *It works, don't worry* ."Catra snorts and stands on her tiptoes to kiss Adora on her lips. When Catra sets back down on the flats of her feet, she sees Adora staring at her with such a soft expression it makes Catra blush and have to look away. After a moment, she looks back to Adora.

" *I want to check in* ,"Catra signs, " *and make sure you're clear on what we're about to do and that you're still okay with it* ?"Catra looks at Adora, watching her expression closely. Her eyebrows knit together before she reaches her hands out to take Catra's hands in her own. She lifts them up to her mouth and presses her lips to Catra's fingers, kissing them. The gesture makes Catra blush again. After a moment, she lets them go so she can sign back.

“ *I’m clear* .”She answers. “ *I want this. I want you* .”Catra’ s heart sets on *fire* . Or, at least, it feels that way. Catra had almost forgotten how it felt to be *desired* . Catra surges up, grabbing Adora by her jaw to pull her down into a kiss. They already couldnt keep their hands off of each other.

t’ s then that Catra understands what Glimmer meant. Catra had to be sure because this would change their relationship permanently. Not how they are with each other, but what they are to each other. Catra has had sex before, but sex with feelings is so much more *signficiant* . Glimmer was right, Catra would have the ability to break Adora’s heart, just as Adora would have the ability to break her own. They would almost be inseparable, *bonded* in a way they currently arent. They’d be *attached* . t’ s terrifying, it makes Catra vulnerable to being hurt, but she trusts Adora so completely that she doesnt mind being vulnerable with her.

“ *I trust you* .”Adora signs and Catra’ s heart swells. Something about that is more significant to Catra than a confession of love.

“ *I trust you too* .”Catra signs back. “ *Okay, so, if I do something you don’t like, you say red to me out loud* ,”Catra recaps their agreement from before, “ *or if you want me to stop for any reason. With me, I’ll double tap you anywhere if I want you to stop, we’ll check in with each other but, other than that, I think we should just go with the flow* .”Adora nods but Catra can see slight nervousness reflected in those beautiful blue eyes.

Catra takes her hands again and Adora looks her in the eye. When she speaks, she makes sure to emphasize her words so Adora can

read her lips. "I got you." Catra promises. "You can let go." Adora still looks slightly worried before it completely melts away. She stares at Catra's lips for a moment before she nods.

Adora grabs the strap of her sports back and drops it on the floor, near the door. She leans over and unzips it and Catra watches curiously. When Adora turns around, she's holding the famous and fabled rainbow strap in her hand and blushing bright red. Catra actually laughs out loud at that as she steps forward. "*You took that to practice?*" Catra asks in disbelief. Adora slowly nods, still blushing.

"*I almost pulled it out when I got changed, I would have died.*" Adora signs and Catra laughs. The mental image of Adora pulling out her strap when pulling out her soccer uniform and scrambling to put it back in, is kind of hilarious.

"*Do you want to use it?*" Catra asks. Adora seems to become flustered again and Catra raises an eyebrow curiously. She had kind of thought Adora wanted Catra to take the lead.

"*I…*" Adora pauses her movements for a moment. "*I was kind of hoping you'd use it on… me?*" Catra's eyes widen and then she nods enthusiastically. She would be very happy to use the strap on Adora. Catra formulates a plan as she places the strap down on top of Adora's sports bag. She had the perfect plan of what she wanted to do.

“ *Let's start with getting you undressed* .”Catra signs. Adora nods and bends over to unfasten the laces on her cleats, kicking them off to one side before she pulls her long socks off and then her shin pads. Catra has to say, it can be hard to make that look sexy, but everything Adora does is sexy, so she’s not really that surprised that it is. Adora stands up straight at the same time Catra follows suit with her shoes and then Catra reaches her hands to the hem of Adora’s t-shirt.

She slides her hands under the shiny sports material of Adora’s jersey . Adora lets out a shuddering breath when Catra touches her and Catra runs her hands carefully over Adora’s abs and up. “Of f.” Adora says. Catra smiles a little as she curls her fingers into the fabric and reaches up, slowly rolling Adora’s shirt up and off. Catra kisses Adora’s exposed skin as she goes, before Adora is left in only her shorts and her sports bra. Catra pauses for a moment.

“ *Are you sure* ?”Catra asks again.

“ *Yes* .”Adora signs and Catra grins and then things start picking up. Catra kisses Adora, pressing her back until her knees hit the back of the bed and she falls backwards onto it. Catra lowers herself down atop her and then she carefully pulls Adora’s sports bra up and off of her head, Adora lifting her arms up to assist her.

Once Adora’s breasts are free, she seems to be unsatisfied with the fact Catra is still dressed and she starts undoing Catra's belt. Catra had her shirt tucked into her pants so once her belt is undone, Adora is able to pull her shirt off of her. Catra was wearing her binder again,

which was a pain in the ass to take off, but they manage it with soft laughs and sweet kisses along the way.

Once they're both shirtless, Catra goes about pampering Adora, kissing down from her jaw, to her neck, she pays special attention to her breasts that has Adora squirming a little before she kisses down her abs and firm stomach down to the hem of her shorts. Catra looks up and Adora nods. Her pupils are blown wide and she already looks ruffled, her hair coming loose from its tight ponytail.

Catra grabs both her shorts and her underwear in one, pulling them down and off and then tosses them to the ground. She then proceeds to kiss the inside of Adora's thighs. Catra can practically smell Adora's arousal, she's that close, she can also already see it. She's tempted to dive in with her tongue, but remembers her plan. She moves back up Adora's body, kissing her way up before she stops, moving her hands to sign. "*My fingers, are you okay if I use them?*" Catra asks. Adora nods profusely and eagerly and Catra grins. There was a reason Catra kept two of her nails trimmed.

With Adora's permission, Catra starts to snake her fingers down Adora's body, allowing the golden haired blonde to wrap her arms around her neck as she does so. Catra has her forehead rested against Adora's, their lips are so close Catra can feel every breath Adora takes against them. "It's okay, Adora," Catra says gently, and it doesn't matter that Adora can't hear her, because Adora knows she's speaking and that seems to get something out of her anyway. "I got you."

F"Adora trails of f and her hesitance makes Catra's heart ache a little. Catra kisses her on her lips and then her nose to encourage her to say whatever it was that she wanted to say. After a moment, she does. "Fuck me, Catra."Adora begs and the rush of arousal Catra feels is similar to a rush of adrenaline. Every nerve she has, sets on fire with her desire. She may still have her pants on, but she doesn't care, she's going to give her Princess whatever she wants.

Catra knows she can't go straight in, build up is important, so she first goes for Adora's clit. The pads of her fingertips meet the sensitive bud of nerves easily and Catra may not know what Adora likes specifically but she sure as hell is going to figure it out. Catra circles first, mapping Adora's folds out with her fingers, she gathers some wetness that Adora was already producing, to make her fingers glide easily over her clit. The cries of pleasure Adora makes send sparks shooting through Catra's core. Eventually, Catra figures out what it is that Adora likes: she likes it rough and she likes it especially when Catra rolls her clit between her two fingers. "Catra!" Adora yells out Catra's name and Catra can't help the smug grin that makes its way onto her face. *What can she say? It's nice to be appreciated.*

Catra works her over well, alternating her pattern that has Adora absolutely panting and almost strangling Catra from how hard she has her arms wrapped around her neck. Catra works her right to the edge and then she stops her focus on her clit. Adora whimpers at the sudden loss of stimulation but she doesn't have to wait long. Catra carefully inserts one finger and Adora's immediate response is a loud moan and the decision to get Catra in, what is essentially, a headlock. Catra has to double tap her arm and Adora immediately stops, releasing Catra. Catra smiles at her and Adora blushes furiously. Catra plants a kiss to her cheek to tell her it was okay before she continues what she was doing. Adora's eyes practically roll back in her head.

Catra is proud of a lot of things in her life, but the sounds she manages to draw out of Adora with her fingers is definitely up there. Catra adds a second finger, curling and scratching the front of Adora's walls, searching for that spot inside of her that was *just* out of reach. Catra knew whenever she hit it because Adora became inaudible, just a series of moans as she gripped hold of Catra - the feeling was that intense. No matter, Catra would hit it with the strap. This was perfect prep for it anyway , and one of the reasons she had decided to go with her fingers over her tongue.

With two fingers pumping in and out of her, Adora becomes a *mess* . Catra can hear how wet she is - nevermind *feel* it coating her fingers and her hand. It's a struggle, but Catra manages to use her free hand to sign something important to Adora that she hopes she can understand even when her other hand is buried inside of her. " *Good girl.* "Adora's reaction is worth it. She lifts her hands up, releasing Catra and she covers her mouth to muffle what was practically a *scream* . Catra admits, she loves having Adora under her, at her mercy, she had figured out what way Adora leaned before, but now she got to *enjoy* it.

Catra grabs her hands and takes them gently from her mouth as she keeps up her movements with her fingers. "Let me hear you, Princess."Catra almost growls. Catra knows Adora can't hear her , but, the way Adora's eyes widen and then darken, Catra knows Adora understood exactly what she was saying. So Adora does, and she's *loud* . The sounds she makes is driving Catra absolutely *wild* , she knows she's soaked herself, some part of her revels in hearing Adora completely let loose as Catra fucks her into the mattress. She can't wait to do it with the strap in a little moment.

Adora comes loudly and Catra feels it spill into her palm. She uses that to press her calloused palm right against Adora’s clit and she comes again almost instantly. Catra grins triumphantly and keeps up her thrusts until Adora makes a sound of discomfort and mumbles 'red'.

When Catra pulls her hand away, it's covered in slick. t feels like a waste to wipe it away so she doesn't, but she does wait for Adora to unscrew her eyes shut and look at her. Once her breathing becomes more human, she does just that. With her clean hand, Catra reaches out, gently grabbing Adora by her chin and kisses her softly on her lips then she stands and gestures to her pants in an order for Adora to take them off.

Adora sits up, she seems a little sluggish, her orgasm clouding her brain, but she takes Catra’s pants and underwear off without protest before she lies back down on her back. Catra can see a sheen of sweat coating her body. Catra goes over to the strap and with her coated hand, she runs Adora’s juices all over the strap, coating that instead. When her hand is mostly clean, she puts the strap on.

t's ridiculous. Catra knows this. t was a gag (pun intended) gift from Glimmer about Adora being a huge flaming homosexual, a rainbow strap is absolutely ridiculous, yet she weirdly gets a power rush from it. Something about wearing a dick just really gets Catra's blood pumping.

The juices aren't enough however , and Catra has to hunt down her lube she uses for personal things, to give that extra glide and ease. When Catra tracks it down, she applies until the thing is

practically dripping. Something Catra has learnt: you can never have too much lube (well, mostly). When she comes back to Adora she realises Adora has been watching her the whole time.

" *Have you used this before?* "Catra asks, signing her words. Adora nods.

" *Yeah, I know the rainbow is stupid but… Free sex toy.* "Catra laughs and she sees Adora grin. She seems like she's recovered from their last session and Catra carefully climbs on top of her. Good thing about Adora: her muscles make her sturdy. Catra never feels like she's going to hurt her by sitting on her incorrectly.

" *Ready* "? Catra asks carefully . Slowly, Adora nods. " *I think we need to build it up again, don't you?* "Catra asks with a mischievous grin. Adora narrows her eyes at the same time Catra starts to rock her strap through her folds. Adora lets out a high pitched sqeak of both surprise and pleasure.

"C-Catra"! She stutters over her words but Catra doesn't care. She glides through Adora's folds perfectly, rubbing her length through her that has Adora bucking her hips up off of the ground to achieve a harder feeling. Catra does that for a while before she pulls back, lining the tip of her strap up with Adora's entrance. She looks at Adora who nods very qickly . "Y es! Yes, please!"She begs and Catra grins.

Catra knows she has enough lube on this thing, and that Adora is more than ready to take her strap, but she still eases herself in, stretching Adora around her strap so easily. When Catra's hips meet Adora's, she stays there for a moment, letting Adora adjust. As she does, Catra bites her neck, giving her a few marks to remember this night by, before she winds her hips back and then *slams* into Adora full force.

Adora practically screams in pleasure as Catra moves her hips fast and hard. She had figured that's how Adora liked to be fucked, considering it's what she liked with her fingers, and she was so right. Adora was gone, she was lost to pleasure the second Catra slammed into her. Catra's own wetness and swollen clit meant that the strap was also rubbing her perfectly with every thrust.

Thank god for whoever invented strap-ons.

Catra manages to hit that spot deep in Adora easily and perfectly that the blonde is incoherent as her back arches up off of the bed. Catra could feel her own pleasure increasing tenfold and when Adora lets out a loud cry of pleasure and her walls tighten around the strap, offering that much needed resistance, it's not long before Catra follows Adora right over that edge.

She collapses on top of her and, at some point, Adora wraps her arms around her, holding her in place. Catra can't move yet so she keeps her strap buried inside of Adora as she kisses the blonde lazily on her jaw. They stay like that for a while before Catra slowly pulls out. The strap is *dripping*, even more than what it had been

when Catra put lube on it. She stands and drops the thing on the floor.

When she's strap free, Catra pins Adora back in bed, kissing her softly as she settles. This was shaping up to be the best night of Catra's life.

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Adora can't deny that that is perhaps the best night of her entire life. She's never felt this way when being with someone else before Catra. Catra makes her feel almost insane. She'd seen the stars more than once tonight and thought her brain might explode too. Now she was being doted on by Catra who was kissing her everywhere, wherever Adora had exposed skin - which, she wasn't exactly wearing clothes, so it really was everywhere.

Adora had been anxious about going all the way with Catra only because she knew that she would probably get attached to her in a way that would hurt her significantly if Catra decided she no longer wanted anything to do with her. She didnt think Catra would do that, but she was still nervous. Adora has never really had anyone this serious. She's had girlfriends before, sure, but nothing has ever felt so *profound* as what she has with Catra does. Plus, those exes always kind of got bored of Adora, or became frustrated with her. Catra was nothing like those girls, but it still nagged Adora sometimes. She's an anxious person, she cant help but think about the worst possible outcomes and it can be hard to convince her otherwise.

Adora pushes those thoughts to one side and instead focuses on the present, the here and now, with Catra rather than some maybe that was probably never going to happen anyway. Adora pulls back so that she can sign to Catra. “ *My turn* ?”She asks. Catra looks at her with surprise.

“ *You don’t have to, Princess* .”Catra signs back and Adora rolls her eyes.

“ *I want to* .”And she really does. Adora wants nothing more than to repay Catra.

“ *Sex isn’t a transaction, I just want you to know that* .”Catra signs. Adora smiles and takes Catra’s hands, kissing her knuckles gently before she drops them again.

“ *I know* ,”Adora signs. “ *I know I don’t have to, but I really want to go down on you, if you wouldn’t mind* .”Catra blinks at her , her cheeks warm a little with a blush and Adora is impressed that she manages to fluster Catra as much as Catra manages to fluster her.

“ *Then… yeah, I’d like that* .”Catra signs and Adora smiles.

“ *Double tap, don’t forget* .”Adora reminds her and Catra nods.

Once they're both ready and sure Adora starts to kiss Catra. She rolls on top of her, her ponytail had come loose at some point, so she pulls it back again, tying it out of the way. Adora kisses Catra on her lips, deeply. Adora loves getting to be naked and intimate with Catra, but she particularly enjoys the fact that she just gets to *feel* Catra with no barriers between them, skin on skin, a shared heat, they are *one* .

Adora moves down Catra's jaw , peppering her with steamy kisses, when she gets to her neck she pays extra attention, sucking and biting Catra with at least one of them being hard enough to leave a mark. *Good* . *Now people will know she's* ***mine*** . Adora never really thought she was the possessive type, but some part of her really likes the idea that Catra will have marks to remember this by - and potentially for others to see.

Adora kisses down Catra's chest, nibbling on her collarbone before planting kisses to her toned stomach. For someone who wasn't really into sports like Adora, Catra was *fit* . If Adora had to describe it, she'd have to say it was similar to a gymnast' s body, strong, muscular, toned, firm and lean. Adora's muscles were more bulky, Catra's strength had a certain grace to it. Catra was *perfect* to Adora.

Adora kisses down Catra's stomach and presses a kiss to each of their hips before she moves down and back, settling between Catra's legs. Adora takes this opportunity to tease. She pulls Catra towards her a little by her ankles. Adora looks up to see Catra staring at her with wide eyes and blown pupils. If she made a sound, Adora didn't hear it, but her expression really says it all: Catra found that

extremely attractive. Adora moves Catra's legs either side of her head and then leans down to press kisses to the inside of their thighs, moving down and back up each, she hovers, for a moment, over Catra's heat - Adora is so tempted to just dive in, but she refrains.

Eventually, Catra must get frustrated with Adora's teasing and she wiggles her feet in Adora's grip, forcing Adora to look at her as she moves her hips up. Her eyes are considerably dark with lust and Adora smirks smugly when she realises she managed to work Catra up this much just with kisses - though, Adora is pretty sure everything that they had done tonight was also contributing to Catra's arousal. Adora decides to put her out of her misery.

Adora lays Catra down on the bed first and then she settles on the bed between her thighs. Adora hesitates only for a second before she dives in, head first. She explores with her tongue. Adora has only done this a few times before and she's never done it with *Catra* before, everyone is different and Adora has to find what works for the brunette. So she explores. She licks through Catra's folds expertly, she can taste the slick from their previous activities and Adora is secretly smug that she had managed to make Catra so wet.

Adora decides to do what Catra did for her, but with her tongue, and focuses on her clit. Adora flattens her tongue to Catra's clit and *sucks* . Adora's eyes widen a little when she feels a sudden pressure on either side of her head and she realises that Catra just tightened her legs around her head. Something about that makes Adora a little giddy. *She's doing good!* Adora looks up to see Catra had her head thrown back, her mouth hanging open and her back arched up off of

the bed. It's by far the best sight Adora has ever seen in her entire life.

Adora keeps that up for a while, alternating her strokes and pattern in a way that she's pretty sure - by the way Catra's body practically *vibrates* with pleasure under Adora - that Catra's very much enjoying this. Catra also tasted *amazing* . She couldn't really describe the taste if she was honest, only that it was *good* and she never wanted to stop and could lie here and lap at Catra for *hours* . Turns out, Adora didn't really need sound to know that Catra was having a good time. At the same time, it was becoming increasingly obvious to Adora that Catra needed something *more* and Adora had plans as to what she could give her for that something more.

Adora lifts Catra *up* . It takes some manoeuvring, Adora moves onto her knees, she has to pull away briefly, and Adora catches sight of Catra's expression that tells her they more than likely let out a sound of protest when she does that, but Catra's expression turns to obvious arousal when Adora drags her up and places her legs over her shoulders. With the new angle, Adora could thrust her tongue *into* Catra. And Adora does just that.

Adora goes as hard as she can, her jaw even aches a little with the pace she moves it at. She can see Catra likes it by the way her head falls back. Her usual curly hair is curled even more from her sweat and Adora thanks whatever higher being there is in the universe for whatever it was that she did to earn the honour of getting to witness Catra like this. She rubs Catra's clit at the same time and it's then that Adora *feels* Catra's orgasm. She tenses up and Adora feels her slick spill *into* her mouth. The taste is intoxicating and Adora lowers Catra down to the bed so she can rest while Adora happily continues her strokes, licking all the liquid up.

Adora stops when Catra tugs on her hair and gently taps her shoulder twice. Her face is wet, to say the least, and she licks her lips before she wipes the rest with the back of her hand. When she crawls back up to Catra, Catra pulls her straight into a kiss, pressing her tongue insistently into Adora's mouth and tasting herself on Adora's tongue. Everything that just happened was *incredible* . Adora wants to do that so many more times, but, right now, she feels as though she could sleep for days.

Catra pulls back and she smiles, all dopey. Adora collapses on the bed beside her, on her stomach and Catra turns, pressing her front up against Adora's side. Adora isn't sure she could form coherent sentences with her hands so she just doesn't bother - she thinks her expression probably says it all if she's honest. Catra kisses Adora on the side of her head and Adora sighs happily. Adora can hardly believe she got to do this with Catra. It was *amazing* . Adora wasn't going to forget it anytime soon. In fact, if she was honest, she felt *complete.* Something about Catra made her feel *whole* . Adora hadn't really given the whole soulmate thing a thought, she figured it was just something people said, but with Catra. Adora sometimes thinks that she was wrong; Catra is bonded to her soul, Adora feels so deeply about her.

"You taste amazing." Adora says out loud. Catra pauses her kissing when Adora says that. Adora pulls her hair out of its ponytail. After a moment, Catra taps her on the shoulder so she can sign to her.

" *I can't wait to taste you* , *Princess* ." Adora blushes at that. *Right* . This was now a thing that they did together: sex. Adora could hardly believe it.

Adora plays it off by shoving Catra's shoulder and dropping her chin against the pillow. She lets out a huff as she blows some of the loose strands of her blonde hair out of her face. Adora was starting to think she may harbour strong feelings for Catra, feelings that started with a capital L', but she couldn't say for certain - Adora has always been kind of slow when it comes to emotions, she finds them somewhat confusing - but she knew that Catra was significant to her in every single way and aspect of her life. She never wanted to be without her. She plays with the letter 'C' on her necklace before she looks over to see Catra watching her with a sleepy expression.

Adora smiles and leans over to kiss her softly on her lips. "Goodnight, Catra." Adora says and Catra lifts her hands up.

"*Night*." is the only sign Catra seems to manage. It was nice for Adora to know, and see, that Catra really was satisfied. One of her fears had been not knowing if she had managed to get Catra off, but she needn't have worried. Adora had been with people in the past, of course, but, she admits, that was the first time she ever used her tongue like *that* on someone - except for once or twice and never until the other person had literally spilled in her mouth. Catra's body told her everything she needed to know.

Adora settles down, feeling her breaths start to even out as her body becomes heavy with exhaustion. She liked Catra so much, *so* so much, that part of her couldn't imagine being without her. Adora falls soundly asleep beside the person she was quickly starting to develop something very deep for.

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Catra wakes up first, which she was not expecting. Due to their sleepovers, Catra had come to know that Adora was a pretty early riser. There were exceptions to that rule, of course, but generally Adora woke first and early. Adora's classes were typically in the morning, which meant her body had pretty much become wired to rising early. Catra had more afternoon classes, though her shift work sometimes messed with her sleeping schedule, still, typically, Adora woke first. Not today though.

Adora was fast asleep, she was sleeping on her stomach, which, whenever they weren't wrapped up in each other, Catra had come to know was Adora's favourite sleeping position. Her hands are tucked under her pillow, at some point in the night she must have kicked the blanket down because it only covered the lower part of her body now, exposing her back. Catra thinks maybe Adora was a goddess in another life, or something, because she does not think it is physically possible to be *this* breathtaking while doing something so mundane as sleeping. Adora's toned back was exposed in all of its glory, her golden blonde hair spilled down her back and onto her pillow, around her in a golden halo, her face was smooth and peaceful with sleep and her breaths were even and steady.

Catra shuffles closer to her and kisses her shoulder blade. She kisses everywhere she can, along Adora's shoulders, down her back before coming back up to gently move her hair from her face and kiss her on her temple. "I love you, Adora." Catra says quietly. "I wish I could tell you." Catra had considered it but she was *scared*. She didn't know how Adora felt, not really, and she didn't want to scare her away. *What if it was too soon for her?* Catra thinks she'd

rather stub her toe a thousand times than lose Adora - she'd rather step on *Lego* barefooted than lose Adora.

Catra keeps kissing Adora, she just can't help herself. She moves her hand up her body, along her back. She has to admit, waking up next to a naked Adora might be her favourite new thing. When Catra looks back at Adora's face, she sees her slowly blinking her eyes open. Those beautiful baby blue eyes sparkling in the golden sun that was filing through the slits in the blinds of Catra's room. Adora's hair seems even more golden when coupled with the sun, and her momentary confusion on her face as she slowly wakes up from her deep sleep is the cutest thing Catra has ever seen.

Eventually, Adora seems to realise where she is and that she is awake. She lets out a groan and then drops her face back into her pillow. Catra laughs at her. "Good morning, sunshine." Catra says. Adora isn't looking at her , so Catra can't sign to her , but she says her words as she presses her lips to Adora's shoulder, knowing she would *feel* them instead. Adora peers back at her and Catra smiles. Next thing Catra knows, she's being tackled into the sheets by Adora.

Maybe tackled is a strong word, but she wraps her arms around her and pushes her down so her back hits the mattress and Adora rolls on top of her. They tussle for a moment, naked and warm, but Adora is just too strong, and heavy , for Catra to get the upper hand and she ends up pinned to the bed by Adora sitting on top of her and with the blonde pinning Catra's hands above her head.

They're both breathing heavily from the brief play-fight and Adora's triumphant smirk slowly slips from her face as she stares at Catra. Their eyes connect in a heated gaze and, the next thing Catra knows, Adora's hands release her wrists in order to cup her face instead, bending over to lock their lips in an intense kiss. Adora wastes no time, her tongue makes its way into Catra's mouth and Catra moves her hands to Adora's hips so she can feel her.

Catra has a sense where this is heading, but she needs to know if it's what Adora has in mind too. Catra lifts her hands and taps Adora to get her attention. " *Sex* "? Catra asks. Adora looks. She looks incredible. She's breathing hard and her lips are swollen from their bruising kiss. She looks *gorgeous* . Adora nods but Catra shakes her head. " *Yes or no* "? Catra makes the sign. She wants Adora's explicit consent, not just a nod. Adora rolls her eyes but her smile tells Catra that she finds the gesture endearing.

" *Yes* ." Adora's sign is so decisive and clear that Catra can't help the grin that spreads across her face. Catra reaches up, wrapping her hands around Adora's hand before she kisses her hand. This is starting to become a thing, them kissing each other's hands. It feels intimate, since it's the main way that they communicate.

With Adora on top of her, Catra decides she doesn't want to move her and instead guides her down into a different position. Catra positions her thigh between Adora's legs as Adora lowers herself down her head resting just above her shoulder so her hot breaths brush Catra's ear. She hears Adora gasp as her centre presses up against Catra's thigh.

Adora is already wet, Catra feels it instantly the second she settles on her thigh, but the wetness only helps Adora glide over Catra's thigh as she starts to move her hips against her. Adora's breaths are already laboured despite the little movement they've done and she lets out soft whimpers. "Yes," She whispers. "Catra. Thank you… yes." Catra moves her head to the side to kiss Adora on her jaw.

Catra is aware that Adora can't hear her, but that's not going to stop her from whispering words of encouragement against her jaw. "Good girl, Adora," Catra coos. "Keep going." As though Adora can hear her, she doubles her efforts. Catra isn't so sure she's fucking Adora as much as Adora is fucking her and using her thigh to get herself off - not that she really cares. Adora is clearly enjoying herself, and that's all that really matters to Catra.

Adora's body tenses in pleasure and Catra smirks softly as the blonde tightens her hands in the sheets beside Catra's head. Adora finds her rhythm, and a way she likes to be rubbed, and settles into it like a glove. Catra barely has to do anything but lie there and let Adora have her way. Usually, Catra would offer her fingers, but Adora seems to be enjoying whatever it is they're currently doing and Catra would be more than happy to get Adora off with her thigh.

Catra runs her hand along Adora's back, curling her sharp nails into Adora's back that makes the blonde shudder. Catra had learned pretty quickly that Adora was into that, but, currently, she was just teasing the blonde as she whimpered quietly into her ear. Catra knows they've done much more intimate actions than this last night but something about this feels even more intimate. The way Adora's laboured, heavy and hot breaths keep brushing against Catra's ear and skin, the way Adora's skin felt under Catra's nails and against

her own skin. Catra can feel her own desire burning between her legs, but her main goal is Adora's pleasure, not her own.

Catra's suspicions that Adora is close are confirmed correct when Adora lets out an almost strangled moan as her hips freeze for a moment. Catra only encourages her by resting her hand on the small of Adora's back, pressing her down harder against her thigh. Adora grinds against her, letting out more moans and Catra runs her nails down Adora's back. " *Catra*- !"Adora almost gasps as her movements speed up, she's gripping the sheets with so much strength Catra is almost worried she might rip them.

And then she feels it. Adora calls her name one last time as she tenses up, her back arches up and then .She collapses on top of Catra like dead weight. Catra laughs a little as Adora slowly comes down from her high. Adora is *heavy* , probably thanks to all her muscles, but Catra doesnt really mind - she rather likes being crushed by Adora's giant frame. Her thigh is wet and sticky but Catra is enjoying this. She soothes her by running her hand up and down her spine.

Once Adora's breathing has calmed down she rolls off of Catra and lands on her back on the bed, bouncing a couple of times. Catra turns on her side after she wipes her thigh on the sheets - they'd need cleaning anyway - and grins at the blonde with great smugness. Catra has made Adora say her name as she came multiple times by now - and each time it felt like music to her ears. She loves it.

Adora looks at her. She is absolutely breathtaking, her skin is sun kissed from playing soccer in the spring sunshine, her golden hair is ruffled, curling from her sweat she'd cooked up from their recent activities, her bangs in her face before she brushes them back. Seeing Adora like this is everything Catra could want and more.

Her heart swells with so much affection that Catra just can't stop herself from moving forward to kiss Adora on her jaw , down her neck before she kisses her again on her mouth. Catra's heart has never felt this full in her entire life. She contemplated if it were too soon, if perhaps she was making a mistake, but she knows for certain now: she is undoubtedly and unquestionably in love with Adora Grayskull.

When Catra pulls back she sees Adora beam at her with a wide smile and Catra feels her heart jump start in her chest. " *I meant to ask you something* ."Adora signs. Catra turns her head to the side a little in question, gesturing for Adora to go on. " *Spring break is coming up and I was wondering if…* "Adora's movements stop for a moment and her cheeks flush slightly. Catra smiled a little at the expression. Flustered Adora is so incredibly cute. " *If you would like to come with me back to Fernia, to meet Mara and… spend time with me* "?Now Catra hadn't been expecting that. She knows she invited Adora to her home during winter break, but she didnt really think Adora would return the gesture - maybe that should tell Catra just how serious they are, or not, but she doesnt want to read too much into it.

" *I'd love to* ."Catra answers and Adora smiles so brightly that Catra cant help but feel like that alone made it worth it. t' s not like Catra had much planned for spring break anyway - she never really did - she would be more than happy to spend it with Adora doing whatever. Catra was slightly nervous to meet Mara. From what

Adora had told her about her, the woman was a saint and she was basically Adora’s mom. t was important to Catra that she made a good impression.

“ *I’m starving* .”Adora suddenly signs and Catra laughs.

“ *Yeah? Was I that good?* ”Catra asks with a smirk. Adora shoves her and Catra only laughs more as she lands on the bed. She hears Adora shifting and she sits back up on her side to watch her.

Adora stretches her arms above her head, the blanket that had been somewhat tangled around her after she had fallen off top of Catra, pools around her waist. Catra watches the muscles in Adora’s toned back and she wonders, not for the first time since she started seeing Adora, if other people find backs as sexy as Catra finds Adora’s. She sees the muscles of her broad shoulders contract as theyŕe stretched with Adora’s hands above her head. She moves her hands, running her blunt nails through those golden locks a few times before she manages to gather the long strands into a ponytail, probably sweeping her bangs back so they werent in her face.

Adora stands and walks over to her sports bag she dropped in there the night before. Catra must say, she doesn't mind a naked Adora walking around her room one bit. Adora pulls out a white t-shirt and a pair of red booty shots, she doesnt bother with any underwear and Catra isnt really complaining - she has the intention to make the most of their free day to really familiarise herself with Adora’s body, so the underwear wouldnt be on for very long.

Adora turns to Catra when she's finished dressing. " *What would you like to eat* "She asks. Catra sits up, she knows her short curls must be ruffled from her sleep and activities, but she doesn't care much.

" *Do you even know how to cook* "Catra asks. " *Things other than protein shakes* "Adora snorts and rolls her eyes before she seems to consider.

" *I make some mean protein pancakes* ."She responds and Catra shakes her head fondly.

" *Take the protein out and you have a deal* ."Catra replies and Adora nods. She stops for a moment, staring at Catra as she stretches a little on the bed. Catra smirks when she catches the blonde staring, Adora huffs before she averts her eyes. Catra gestures for her to look at her again. " *You like what you see, Princess* "Catra asks.

" *You know I do.* "Adora signs back.

" *You're allowed to look at me, Adora* ."Catra says as she pushes herself up onto her knees. " *I'm your girlfriend, remember?* "

" *How could I forget?* "Adora signs back and something about it makes Catra feel *warm* . Adora comes over to the bed and Catra wraps her arms around Adora's neck while Adora wraps her arms

around Catra's waist. Catra kisses Adora softly on her nose and then Adora kisses her on the lips before she moves away again.

Catra shakes her head, smiling before she stands to grab a shirt from her drawer. " *Hey* ,"Catra waves her hand for Adora' s attention and Adora seems to register it because she stops just in the doorway, turning around to look at Catra curiously. " *I like the way you say my name, Princess* ."Catra signs. Adora blushes a little at that.

"Catra."She speaks, sticking her tongue out before she ducks out of the bedroom and into the living room, probably to go to the kitchen. Catra smiles and shakes her head. She thinks she will always love the way that Adora says her name. She never really thought anyone said it wrong before, but Adora says it so completely *right* whenever she speaks it that Catra thinks maybe everyone else has been saying it wrong.

Catra knows for certain that she is in love. *Profoundly* . She never really thought she'd be a recites love poetry , swoons at a mere glance, absolutely smitten with their significant other, kind of person, but with Adora she is. And now Catra was going to meet the woman that practically raised Adora, and who Adora considers her mom, like Catra wasnt madly in love with Adora? Mara would see through her like glass.

"Catra!"Adora calls from the kitchen and Catra snaps out of her thoughts. She grabs some of her boxers and slips them on. Her worries could wait. For now, she was going to enjoy spending time with Adora.

Still, Catra couldn't help but feel like she was screwed. There was no way she could hide this from Adora for much longer and she was *terrified* that Adora didn't feel the same. After all, it's never easy to tell someone you're in love with them.

Chapter End Notes

"Catra thinks she maybe won the lesbian lottery . "One of my favourite lines this chapter xD I hope you all enjoyed and I'll attempt to reply to all comments again! This is the main NSFW chapter, there may be some in the future but maybe not as detailed though I don't know for sure !! The plans I have for next chapter hint at it being a long-ish one, so I hope to see you all again next time! Thank you for comments/kudos and simply reading !! I love these lesbians.

You can find me on twitter (with M) @colordadora and on my tumblr @erasswordstrap

head over boots

Chapter Summary

> “You were a cute kid,” Catra signs. “What happened?” She teases. Adora shoves her playfully before she hooks her fingers in the waistband of Catra’s pants, pulls back and lets the fabric go, slapping Catra with it.
>
> “Hey!” Catra yells, jumping a little but feeling herself grin wide. “You play dirty, Princess.” Adora just winks at her .
>
> Catradora go country, yeehaw

Chapter Notes

> Thank you all who have patiently waited for the updates for this fic !! Here we are, the penultimate chapter of Coffee Shop AU. Thank you to everyone's support on this fic, the comments, kudos, everything. It has all meant the world to me that people have loved reading this fic as much as I have loved writing it. I hope this chapter is just as satisfactory as the others for y'all :) See you at the end !!
>
> Oh, also, NSFW ahead !!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

And up until now I had sworn to myself

That I'm content with loneliness

Because none of it was ever worth the risk

But you are the only exception

You are the only exception

You are the only exception

You are the only exception

- The Only Exception, Paramore

Spring Break)

Catra is exhausted. She had sat her final of the term and she was *more* than ready for a break from schoolwork - not that pre-law really ever had a break, but she was planning on making the most of her Spring Break with Adora. Her last final had been an early one, and it had been *three hours long.* She was about ready to pass out, but was currently making her way to Adora's apartment. Adora had told Catra that Glimmer and Bow had already left, so they'd have the place all to themselves. The plan was for them to spend the day here and then leave tomorrow on a road trip to Adora's hometown Eternia - which was some small town in the countryside that Catra had never heard of.

Catra walks up the steps of Adora's apartment complex. She had texted Adora that she was on the way, just so the blonde was prepared for her arrival. Adora had finished up her finals, as most other students also had, which meant that the building was pretty quiet, as was the campus too. It was weird seeing the grounds so void of people, but it was also nice, Most of the students still here were the unlucky bastards, such as Catra, with finals up to the last day of term, and the handful of students who werent doing anything for Spring Break, or going home to see family.

Catra stops at the apartment door, her boots thudding. She looks at the neatly written note on the door that was taped up there. It was written by Glimmer, because Adora claimed her writing was often illegible to people - Catra admits that it sometimes takes her a minute to understand Adora's writing, and it was also why the blonde typed up her notes after each lecture. The note was just asking people to press the doorbell if they happened to knock on the apartment door. The doorbell made a sound for Glimmer and Bow but it also illuminated a light inside so that if they weren't home, Adora would know if someone had knocked. Catra just texts Adora instead.

Adora texts her back to enter and Catra does just that. She pushes the door of Adora's apartment open and drops her backpack by the door. She walks into the apartment. "Adora?" Catra calls before she rolls her eyes at herself. Catra knows Adora is deaf, and yet she still called out her name like she might hear her. It is a habit that is hard to break. Speaking verbally has been Catra's main form of communication for years - since she was a toddler - even when she signs, Catra often speaks her words too. So sometimes she does silly things like call out Adora's name - she did it during sex too, but Adora could *feel* Catra saying her name then.

Catra finds Adora in the kitchen, her back to her. When Adora turns around, she's holding a little cupcake in her hands, it has blue frosting on the top with pink sprinkles and a little candle in the middle. Catra instantly smiles at the sight. She had been feeling a little grumpy from the early morning and the exam, but seeing *this* , seeing *Adora* , it doesn't get much better than that for Catra.

Adora is smiling softly. Catra has always known Adora is pretty, but sometimes it still manages to smack her right in the face (and heart). Her baby blue eyes are gentle and full of tenderness, her lips are turned up slightly at the corners in a small yet contagious smile, and she has strands of golden blonde hair falling out of her messy ponytail. Adora has had a *lazy day* , which is rare for the blonde. f Catra had to guess, she probably spent the morning packing and going to the bakery apparently - because Catra doubts Adora can bake. Adora's dressed in some grey joggers, she only has socks on her feet and she's wearing a white t-shirt that's tucked into the waistband of her joggers. Catra thinks it' s a little unfair that Adora can look so good so effortlessly.

" *What's this* ?Catra signs, raising an eyebrow but being unable to stop herself from smiling.

f For your final final."Adora answers verbally . *Dork* . Adora is quite possibly one of the sweetest people Catra has ever met - and *definitely* the dorkiest. f Make a wish."She adds. Catra snorts in amusement. She was about to tell Adora that she's pretty sure that's a birthday exclusive thing, but she doesnt bother , Adora is looking at her way too cutely for her to do that.

Catra takes a step closer, she closes her eyes and then blows the candle out. She doesnt need to wish for anything, she has everything she could ever want right here, but she could wish for it to never end. So that was her wish. For this to never end.

When Catra opens her eyes again, Adora is *beaming* at her. She takes the candle out of the cupcake and then presents it to Catra.

Catra laughs and takes the thing. She peels it out of the paper and then splits it in half, giving half to Adora who smiles as she takes it. They enjoy that cupcake to its fullest.

After Catra has finished, she *finally* gets to wrap her arms around Adora and *kiss* her. She's missed Adora, even though they spend every moment that they can together, even though they text every moment they're *not* together. Catra wants to be with Adora forever and always. It is so obvious to Catra that she has never felt this way about anyone ever before. Adora makes her feel *warm,* top to bottom, safe and cared for. Catra has never been a love story, or sappy, type of person, but with Adora. She finally understands why people search for this, why people die for this, this is *everything* . *Adora* is everything.

Catra pulls back from the kiss and smirks softly at the sound of protest Adora makes. Adora slowly blinks her eyes open and Catra is satisfied to see they're a shade darker than usual and half-lidded with desire. " *Dance with me* ?" Catra asks. Adora cocks an eyebrow.

" *You want to dance now* ?" Adora asks, her expression communicates her confusion. Honestly, Catra doesn't want to dance as much as she just wants an excuse to put her hands on Adora and for Adora to put her hands on her - not that they really need excuses as girlfriends, but there is something so… *Intimate* about sharing a dance. Catra nods and takes Adora's hands when the blonde finally nods her agreement.

She leads Adora into the living space and she plays some music softly in the background. When they're face to face, Catra takes Adora's hands and places them on her waist. Adora seems to understand almost instantly what Catra's intentions had really been. This wasn't an invitation to dance, this was an invitation to *touch* Catra.

The music playing is some slow , sexy song that Catra isn't really paying any mind to. It is background noise to her now , the mood has been set and it's not the music's doing. Adora's hands slide up Catra's back and then she slips her hands below Catra's hoodie. It was actually Adora's hoodie, Catra had stolen it one night, it was a little big on her but it was comfortable and it smelt of Adora. Sure, on the back, Adora's name and jersey number were printed there, and on the front was something about BMU athletics, but Catra didn't care, she was determined to steal all of Adora's comfy clothes - especially her hoodies.

They're so close together . Catra is slightly taller than usual because her boots are giving her just that little extra height against Adora' s socked feet. Catra can *feel* Adora's heat radiating off of her and then Adora runs her hands up Catra's sides. Carefully, she manages to pull the hoodie up and over Catra's head. She looks at it for a moment. " *This is mine* ."She signs with an amused grin. Catra *knows* Adora enjoys seeing Catra in her clothes.

Catra takes the article of clothing and then tosses it onto the nearby chair. " ***I'm*** *yours* ."Catra signs back. Adora seems to short circuit at that. It' s kind of cute actually, that Adora is so easily affected by something so simple as those words.

It takes her a moment, but Adora finally recovers. She smiles and wraps her arms around Catra. "Mine." She whispers quietly. Catra's heart squeezes in her chest. There isn't anything possessive about Adora's words, it is a simple fact, an acknowledgement. They *are* each other's. Catra can't imagine ever being with anyone else ever again. Adora is Catra's one true love, the one love that results in ballads and epic tales, she is Catra's biggest love, even if she hasn't told her that yet.

Catra moves her hands to Adora's back, she digs her nails into the fabric of Adora's shirt, feeling her hard toned back underneath the fabric. She scratches her fingers there as Adora moves her hands to the edge of Catra's shirt. Catra nods when Adora pauses, already knowing what question was on Adora's mind but both of them are far too absorbed in each other to take their hands away to sign.

Adora slowly rolls Catra's shirt up, it's almost *sensual*. Catra is left in her sports bra and pants, she'd opted for the sports bra simply because didn't feel like sitting in her binder for hours in an exam. She kicks her boots off and then wraps her arms around Adora, making her next intention clear. Adora helps her, picking her up effortlessly from the ground, Catra wraps her legs around Adora's waist and uses her grip, and Adora's strength, to hoist herself up to kiss Adora on her lips.

They're not dancing anymore, not that they were really dancing to begin with, Catra can already see the direction this is heading in. If she's honest, she's almost told Adora that she loves her several times already, Catra isn't going to make it this whole trip without telling her, but she at least doesn't have to do it *now*. Now she can just make out with her girlfriend and then take her to bed.

Adora moves them towards the couch, she drops Catra down onto it and then settles on top of her. Catra loses herself to kissing Adora, she often does if she's honest. Adora is an *amazing* kisser. It's not often Catra surrenders herself to someone so easily, but Catra feels *safe* with Adora. Things are getting progressively more hot and heavy and Catra feels almost overwhelmed by her intense emotions for the blonde.

Adora moves *down* . She kisses down Catra's chest, and down the plain of her stomach. Catra *melts* . She is merely putty under Adora's hands, bending to her every will.

Catra buries her face in her hands. She could feel her cheeks burning and she was sure that they were bright red. Catra cant believe this, she is so in love with Adora that she cant even kiss her anymore without feeling like her heart is going to burst out of her chest.

After a moment, Adora seems to realise that Catra is hiding and she feels large gentle hands wrap themselves around her wrists and carefully pull Catra's hands away from her face. Catra is greeted with a slightly flushed Adora, but also sparkling blue eyes of concern. "*Okay* ?" Adora signs simply . Catra is *not* okay, but it's for reasons she cant express to Adora yet, so she simply sits up a little and pecks the blonde on her cheek.

" *Why don't we take advantage of the fact your roommates are gone* ?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow . Adora's concern seems to waver

for a moment. She seems suspicious but she must find something that satisfies her because she nods and then smiles.

“ *You read my mind* .”Adora responds and then she practically picks Catra up off of the couch. This was exactly what Catra needed actually. She was going to enjoy her day with Adora, and then tomorrow Catra would go to Eternia and meet Mara.

She just hoped everything would be okay .

***

The next day they stop by Catra’ s apartment to pick up her things. She'd already packed the day before yesterday , despite having her exam in the morning. That meant they were on the road bright and early. Eternia was quite far away from BMU and they were going to be on the road for most of the day. On the bright side, Catra had complete control over the aux cord, Adora was driving, which meant Catra could just sit back and relax. They made the occasional stop at stations for snacks and bathroom breaks, as well as fuel, before carrying on.

Catra was enjoying the quiet. They couldnt exactly converse, Adora couldnt sign while driving and Catra couldnt speak to her , but it didnt matter . Something Catra had discovered she liked the most about Adora was that they could simply just *exist* around each other. They didnt necessarily have to be talking all the time, Catra felt happy simply from just having Adora near her . She recalls the nights

where they'd snuggle up next to each other and watch a movie in silence, or when Adora would come over and they'd study in silence. Catra enjoys simply existing with Adora and she thinks that' s sometimes a rarity among people. She's heard before that that's when you truly know you love someone: when you can shut up, sit and enjoy the universe together .

By the time they roll into the small town of Eternia, the sun has already far been set. Catra knew the place was a small town, and that it was some off the grid town she'd never heard of before, but the place was practically surrounded by dusty streets with the odd grassy pasture. It was clearly *country* , Catra had never been this far into the country. She grew up in the suburbs, not too far from the city Half-Moon, in fact, that's where she said she lived - considering she was only a twenty minute drive from the city centre. Adora is a country girl, she'd made a joke when they'd first met about Catra not knowing even with her accent, but Catra hadnt really expected it to be *this* country.

They drive through the town centre, which had more buildings than what Catra had seen for a while now - and a bar with a huge *cowboy hat* on top of it. As they drive on through they start coming into what Catra can only assume is farmland or ranch land - Catra doesnt really know the difference if she's being honest. Some fields have cows, others sheep, some have horses grazing in the fields and some are just crops. Catra wonders how many farmers live in this town, and who owns all of that stuff.

They start driving up a dirt road, at some point Adora has to get out of the car in order to open a white wooden fence. They pull up to a house which has a light on in one of the front rooms, Catra can make out some kind of barn to the left and something else she isn't familiar

with and that is too dark for her to discern currently. t seems nice, if a little qaint. Like she said, Catra's never been this far into the country before.

Adora shuts off the engine of her car and Catra hears her release a little sigh. t' s been a long drive, and Adora must be exhausted, yet the first thing she does when she looks at Catra is smile. t' s a tired smile, sure, but it still makes Catra's heart beat wildly in her chest. Catra leans over the console to kiss her favourite blonde on her lips. Ihe kiss itself started out innocently enough, but it' s not long until it qickly develops into a much more heated one, stoked by their low burning desires.

Catra feels Adora's hands move to her hips and then suddenly she's being helped over the console and into Adora's lap. Catra is more than happy to do this with Adora, she jst wasnt necessarily expecting it. f she' s honest, ever since they had sex, they've been far more casual with one another. Ieir touching is casual, their intimacy is casual. Iere isnt really a big deal when they do it, is what Catra really means. Adora will always touch her gently wherever and whenever, in fact, Catra has noticed she likes to do that more often than not. She will cuddle Catra from behind, wrap an arm around her shoulder, place a hand on her hip, it's not possessiveness - although, Adora can definitely be jealous and a little possessive sometimes, not that Catra minds that - it's *comfort* . Adora is *comfortable* with Catra, completely, and she expresses it through touch. Catra's pretty confident that touch is one of Adora's biggest love languages.

Catra has her hand on either side of Adora's jaw and Adora has her hands on Catra's hips. t' s a little cramped, because of the steering wheel, but, otherwise, Catra has Adora's hips straddled between her

thighs and against the seat. The kiss is already heating up and Catra feels the unmistakable peeking of Adora's tongue against her lips. Catra laughs softly before she opens her mouth, the kiss deepening almost instantly. She lets Adora lead, if only because she basically started the kiss.

Adora moves her hands and squeezes Catra's thighs and Catra lets out an almost embarrassingly loud moan that fills the quickly steaming air of the car. Catra is vaguely aware that the windows are beginning to fog up from their hot breaths, and hot desire, but she doesn't really care. Some part of her wants Adora to fuck her, just unfasten her jeans and put her fingers to use, and maybe Adora is picking up on those signals because her hand drifts suspiciously close to the button on Catra's jeans. Adora does not, however, do anything of the sort - she wouldn't without the explicit permission from Catra anyway.

Unfortunately, they are interrupted when Catra leans back just a touch too far and accidentally leans on the horn. She jumps at the sudden loud noise, causing Adora to accidentally bite down on her lip - which Catra would usually find *hot* under different circumstances. Catra's eyes widen and she freezes, her horny fog clearing enough for her to realise they were currently making out in Adora's car when they could be making out in her *room*. Adora blinks at her, clearly confused by Catra's reaction. Catra finds herself laughing. "*Horn*." She signs and Adora's eyes light up in realisation. How ironic that their horny is interrupted by a *horn*. Catra laughs again and leans back.

That's when Catra notices something, or, rather, *someone*. There is a *person* standing on the porch of the house and Catra only just noticed because she was too busy hungrily making out with her

girlfriend. Catra squeaks a little in surprise and Adora seems to perceive Catra's strange outburst and looks over to her right. Catra sees Adora immediately flush when she finally sees what Catra just saw. They seem to make a mutual agreement to put their makeout session on a hold.

Adora opens the door and they both tumble out of it, almost falling on their faces before they quickly stand up. Adora shuts her door and then Catra takes her hand. She's *nervous* , and not only because she just caught making out with Adora in her car like they were teenagers or something, but because Mara is important to Adora and Catra wants her to like her because of that. What would she do if Mara didn't like her? The thought is enough to make her palms a little sweaty.

As though Adora can sense Catra's climbing apprehension, she squeezes her hand and brings it up to her lips to press a soft reassuring kiss to their interlocked hands. When they get closer, Catra can see that the woman is taller, possibly just slightly shorter than Adora, though not by much. Sitting on her head is a *cowboy hat* , she wears a flannel shirt tucked into jeans with a belt that has some big golden buckle on it. Catra starts to wonder if perhaps Eternia exists in the old cowboy days, if everyone really dresses like this. Still, the look works for the woman somehow. Catra can't make out Mara completely, due to the poor lighting on the porch, but she's already pretty confident that she's just as beautiful as Adora.

Mara smiles as soon as they get close enough and *picks* Adora *up* off of the ground like it was absolutely nothing. Catra has had Adora's dead weight on top of her, she knows that the girl is *heavy* - thanks to all that hard earned muscle - which means that Mara must be impressively *strong* . "Mara!" Adora complains but Catra can hear

the fondness dripping from her voice, and see the smile plastered on her face.

"And you must be Catra, the person I've been hearing so much about." Mara signs her words as she speaks. Catra instantly blushes from her words. She wonders what Adora has been telling Mara about her.

"All good I hope?" Catra responds, nervously laughing a little. Adora nudges her shoulder gently from beside her, after Mara had put her back down on her feet. She gives Catra a look and she instantly feels at ease and rolls her eyes at the blonde. Her message was clear: of course it was all good.

"Come inside, you two must be exhausted." Mara says, gesturing for them to go inside.

" *Let me get our bags and we can take them to my room and then chat for a little* ." Adora signs and Mara nods in agreement.

" *Do you need help* ?" Catra asks and Adora shakes her head.

" *I'm strong, I got it* ." She signs back with a grin. Catra rolls her eyes at her but she really wouldn't expect any less from Adora. Adora hops off the porch to the trunk of her car and Mara gestures for Catra to come inside. Catra follows her into the lit house.

Now that they were in an environment that allowed Catra to see Mara properly, she could see that she was correct in thinking the woman was *beautiful* . Mara radiates warmth, everything about her is welcoming, from her gentle smile to her warm personality, she has lines by her eyes that show that she's lived a happy life and smiles often. Catra doesnt know how old Mara is exactly , she recalls Adora saying she was in her thirties when she adopted Adora, which meant she had to be in her forties by now, but she looks *incredible* . She has, what appears to be, a hearing aid in her ear and Catra remembers Adora telling her that Mara taught her sign language.

Sign language is, unfortunately, not commonly known by those who are not deaf;Catra always thought it should be taught in school, but it is often not - the only reason Catra knew sign language was because her moms had the foresight to see the value in learning it. t makes sense for Mara to know it if she is partially deaf herself and was likely a way for her and Adora to bond when Adora was younger - a person Adora could finally communicate with. The thought makes her smile sadly. Mara really is a good person.

"have to ask,"Catra says, causing Mara to halt. "Does everyone here dress like this?" t isnt malicious, in fact, Mara even *laughs* .

"Oh, absolutely . Im sure Adora will show you."Mara responds with great amusement. "t' s only a matter of time before she puts her hat on."Catra wont lie that the thought of Adora dressing all cowboy , with the hat and everything, is an oddly attractive thought. Catra snorts. Adora in *anything* is attractive - Adora in *nothing* is also very attractive, Catra knows this personally.

Adora comes into the house carrying the luggage. “ *I could have helped you, Princess* .” Catra signs, an amused smirk spreading on her lips. Adora’s hands are a little full for her to sign, but she simply shakes her head in response, her own smirk on her face. Catra allows herself a moment to admire Adora’s biceps that she can see straining under that tight white shirt she’s wearing, that’s also tucked into her high-waisted skinny blue jeans.

“ Typical Adora,” Mara calls from the kitchen. “ Never asks for help, always has to do it herself.” Catra laughs at that and Adora turns her head to the side. She sets the bags down for the moment.

“ *What did she say* ?” Adora asks. Catra signs what Mara just said to Adora and Adora rolls her eyes in response. Mara appears in the doorway.

“ *Why don’t you show Catra around a little* ?” She suggests before she smiles at the pair and returns back to the kitchen.

The house is a single story home, the kitchen is nice and hung on the walls are various pictures of *horses* . No wonder Adora was such a horse girl. The living room is cozy and it’ s a relatively simple layout for Catra to figure out. There’ s Mara’s room, Adora’s room and the bathroom. There’ s a picture on one of the tables in the living room with Mara and another woman who must have been Hope, Mara’s wife that she lost. She’s smiling warmly in the picture, holding flowers that were clearly intended for Mara. Catra doesnt know how Mara managed to move on and heal after losing her wife, it must

have been incredibly hard. Seems Mara was not only strong physically, but mentally as well.

Finally, they enter Adora's childhood bedroom. Catra had been kind of dying to see her bedroom since Adora had come to visit Catra at her own childhood home. It's just interesting for her to see into Adora's past like this, a past she was not privy to. There are posters on the wall of horses. *Shocker*. *Not*. There are various trophies and medals around the room, most are sports ones, soccer specifically, with the odd one for outstanding academic achievement.

There is a cork board on one of the walls of Adora's rooms with pictures. Catra smiles at them. Some are recent pictures of her with Glimmer and Bow, ones she must have taken in college and put up here rather than in their shared apartment. Adora looks younger in one particularly, probably freshman year of college, she's wearing her BMU hoodie, she even looks slightly skinnier - Adora has clearly been taking advantage of the gym that athletes get to use for free at their university - she's still smiling as brightly as ever. Catra loves it when Adora smiles, it always makes her blue eyes shine, like they're glowing, and Catra just loves to see her literally light up with happiness.

Catra's eyes move down, there's another picture of a much *much* younger Adora, maybe about six or seven, she's standing beside a sickly pale woman, her inky black hair silky, falling on her shoulders. Adora's not smiling, she has her hands behind her and she's standing up straight, looking serious. It reminds Catra more of a soldier standing at attention than a kid posing for a picture. Catra shudders a little at the woman. *That must be Shadow Weaver*. Catra touches the corner of it. She sees Adora turn to her in the corner of her eye.

“ *I keep it as a reminder,* ”She signs. “ *That orphanage was horrible… So was Shadow Weaver, but it’s part of my history. It shows how far I’ve come* .”Catra smiles a little at that. She almost feels proud of Adora.

“ *You were a cute kid* ,”Catra signs. “ *What happened* ?”She teases. Adora shoves her playfully before she hooks her fingers in the waistband of Catra’s pants, pulls back and lets the fabric go, slapping Catra with it.

“Hey!”Catra yells, jumping a little but feeling herself grin wide. “ *You play dirty, Princess* .”Adora just winks at her .

Catra turns back to the board, looking away from that picture. There are quite a few pictures of Adora with Mara, a couple of Adora with an *actual* horse which makes Catra raise an eyebrow. There’s a really old looking picture that’s all bent and looks worse for wear, like it had been in a pocket for a while, definitely weathered. It’s two people holding a baby Adora between them and Catra realises that it must be Adora’s *parents* . Adora’s dad has a bushy beard, both of her parents have blue eyes but, if you ask Catra, she looks very similar to her dad, he’s well built and strong and Catra notices one of his legs is a prosthetic. Adora’s mom is slim but clearly pretty, her hair is voluminous and down around her shoulders. Interestingly , they both have light brown hair which is stark in comparison to the golden blonde of Adora.

“ *What were their names* ?”Catra asks curiously . Adora finger-spells out their names individually. Randor and Marlena. *Interesting.* Just as interesting as Adora, though, Catra stands by that name fitting Adora *perfectly* . Catra certainly adores her.

“ *I only know because of the picture* .”Adora signs before she lifts the picture up, showing some writing on the back of their names and Adora’s. She lets the picture go again. “ *I don’t remember them all that much anymore* .”Catra feels sadness at the thought. She can’t imagine not remembering her moms, they’re her entire life, Catra has no doubt that Adora was also the centre of Randor and Marlena’s life when they had been alive. Catra looks away from the board and instead looks at Adora. She seems to look somewhat sad. Catra can’t have that.

Catra spies a Polaroid camera nearby and picks it up before she pushes Adora towards the bed. Adora seems surprised but follows Catra’s clear instruction. The blonde falls down on the bed, on her ass, bouncing a little with her weight. “ *We’re adding to your collection* .”Catra states as she sits down beside Adora. Adora is already smiling. They lean into each other , Adora takes the camera, because she has more reach, and then she takes the picture. Catra takes the Polaroid and waves it around a little to speed up its development.

There it is. Adora’s smile .

Catra smiles at the picture before she stands and pins the image to Adora’s board. She turns back to Adora, who was currently watching her closely. “ *You know* ,”Catra begins. “ *We could totally have fun*

with that camera after sex ."Adora' s eyes widen and then she flushes pink, right to the tips of her ears. t' s totally worth it to Catra.

Catra crosses the room back to the bed and Adora sets the camera to one side as Catra climbs into her lap. " *Would you like that, Adora* "?Catra asks, pausing briefly to just nibble playfully at the blonde' s ear. The way Adora tightens her arms around Catra is one of the most satisfying things Catra has ever felt. Catra pulls back to sign again. " *Would you like Polaroids of me after you've had your way with me? Of me* ***wrecked*** *by you? For your eyes only, Princess.* " Catra winks. Adora lets out a breath that is closer to a *whine* if Catra is being honest.

Then the next second, Adora is pulling her down and pinning her to the bed. They tussle for a moment, Catra loves it when Adora laughs, she almost *snorts* , it's actually pretty adorable if you ask her. Adora ends up winning, pinning Catra to the bed, but Catra puts up a good fight. The air between them shifts, it becomes *charged* . Their laughing cuts to breathy panting as they stare at each other. Catra shuffles under Adora, very aware of the blonde's hand that was holding her hands above her head by her wrists. Adora leans down and uses her free hand to gently brush short curls out of Catra's face. The atmosphere is definitely charged, but Adora shakes her head and stands.

" *We can do that later, we should get back to Mara* ."She signs. Catra is only slightly disappointed. She knows Adora is right.

" *You're right, let's go* ."Catra agrees, of fering her hand. Adora smiles as she takes it.

They spend the rest of the night watching some movie and chatting. Catra learns that Mara is good at making a cup of tea. Catra also learns more about Mara, like how she still wears her wedding ring, despite having lost her wife so long ago, she also learns that Mara is a farrier which, to Catra's limited knowledge, is like a blacksmith but specifically for horseshoes. She makes and fits them and that indistinguishable building Catra hadn't been able to identify in the dark was in fact a *forge* . It was no wonder then that Mara was so strong when she bent metal for a living. The barn was for holding horses sometimes, when they came to be fitted, but most of those were for outside clients. Catra also learnt that Adora loved it whenever they did. Otherwise, Mara worked for a local horse ranch.

Adora had fallen asleep at some point, not that Catra blamed her - she had driven them all the way here with limited breaks between. So Catra was gently rubbing her back with the blonde lying with her head on her lap, she had a blanket thrown over them that she had grabbed off the back of her couch. She was out *cold* , snoring softly as Adora always does in her sleep. Catra was nursing an empty mug of tea as Mara was telling her something about a certain shoe she had been making and how it had gone wrong.

There's a lull in their conversation for a moment. "Adora has never brought someone home before, you know?" Mara asks gently . Catra looks up at that, her cheeks darkening a little with a blush.

"Yeah?" Catra asks.

"Yeah," Mara nods in confirmation. "You must be really special to her." Catra smiles softly as she looks down at Adora's head in her lap. She gently threads her fingers through her blonde tresses. Catra feels her heart grow at least three sizes as she looks at Adora.
"You're in love with her." Mara states out of nowhere. Catra blinks. *Was she really that obvious?*

She slowly looks up at Mara, feeling her cheeks warm ever so slightly. "I really thought I'd last at least a couple of days before you figured me out." Mara laughs softly. Despite being caught, Catra doesn't feel the fear she thought she would feel with her feelings being exposed. It's actually nice to talk so freely about how she feels about Adora.

"You should tell her," Mara says gently, encouragingly. "It's never a bad thing adding more love to the world. And, believe me, it's better to tell people how you feel than it being too late." Catra smiles at that. Mara certainly has a way with words.

"I'm planning to tell her," Catra confesses. "I'm just...scared, I think."

"Feelings are scary, the thought of being rejected is *terrifying*, I understand what you're saying." Mara says carefully. "Wearing your heart on your sleeve, giving someone the power to hurt you, *really* hurt you, being vulnerable with someone...it's hard. I think we're almost programmed to not be honest about our feelings, but when someone else is the same back to you...There is nothing like it." Catra hums as she looks down softly at Adora. "I can't speak to how Adora feels, obviously, but I do know that, despite everything she's

been through, she has a good heart. You both deserve love. And she brought you here, you obviously mean a lot to her."

"I feel like I've known her my whole life," Catra says quietly. "I can't explain it. It's like I knew her before I even met her, and she knew me. She was familiar to me in every way almost immediately, there was a *connection* between us that I've never felt with someone before." Catra is acutely aware that her words right now may be slightly cheesy, but she means them with her whole heart. "I feel like I don't know. I don't really believe in soulmates, but Adora feels like she might fit that description the best." It's the only way Catra can describe the enormity of her feelings for Adora, for their bond. *Soulmates*. "I know I only met her in autumn, but the moment I saw her, I knew."

"Connections like that are rare," Mara says softly. Catra can see her smiling at her. "Just don't let her go."

"I won't," Catra swears, holding Adora close. "I promise." She whispers into her hair.

"Well, I'm going to hit the hay," Mara says, standing. "Not literally, we do have actual beds, we're not that cowboy." Catra finds herself laughing at the joke. Mara takes the cups they'd used into the kitchen, Catra hears the faucet turn on before shutting off and then Mara disappears into her room, leaving her and Adora alone.

Catra sighs softly, sinking down on the couch. "I love you, Dummy," She whispers, kissing Adora softly on her nose. "So much. I just hope you feel the same." Catra makes the decision to sleep on the couch, too reluctant to wake Adora up from her peaceful slumber - and maybe she didn't want Adora's comforting weight off of her. She falls asleep with Mara's words on her mind.

***

After they woke up the next morning and had breakfast, Adora had disappeared to go dressed. When Catra sees her next, she's not sure what she was expecting, but Adora dressed in a flannel shirt, tucked into tight blue jeans with actual *chaps* and *cowboy boots* was not it. The chaps leave the blue jeans of her crotch exposed and they have a *fringe* going down the side of each leg. Adora has the sleeves of her shirt rolled up, meaning the material clings to her muscles, and she has a white cowboy hat on her head. Cons of Adora wearing a cowboy hat: she's wearing a *cowboy hat*. Pros of Adora wearing a cowboy hat: she has to let her hair down out of that ponytail of hers and Catra can't deny that she's a big fan of seeing Adora's golden blonde hair falling around her shoulders like that.

Basically, Adora looks like a cowboy threw up on her, and yet Catra finds it strangely attractive? She really can't explain it, it's like cowboy chic or something, but it is so weirdly attractive to her. She's always found cowboys weirdly attractive, at least the style, she even thinks there's some kind of masculine energy to it that gives her some gender envy. Still, Catra is *not* country and she's finding it hard to believe that chaps are just an everyday item of clothing, even here. "*Are you seriously going out dressed like that?*" Catra questions, raising an eyebrow. Adora looks down at herself.

“ *Yeah* ”She signs, shrugging. “ *You can borrow some of my clothes* .”Adora signs. Catra must look confused, or not convinced, because Adora begins to explain. “ *We’re going to the ranch to see my friend, you don’t need the chaps or whatever, but you can’t go in your regular clothes* .”Catra wants to ask why but at this rate, she’ s not sure it even matters. *Well, when in Rome. Right?*

“ *I don’t think your clothes will fit me, Princess* .”Catra signs back with a little amusement.

“ *Clothes from my teen years will probably work* .”Adora signs as she gestures to her room. Catra rolls her eyes and walks into Adora’s room.

“ *There’s something very embarrassing about the fact I’m going to be wearing your* ***teen*** *clothes* .”Catra signs back. Adora just pokes her in the side.

Catra watches as she roots around in her drawers for some clothes for Catra. Catra doesnt typically wear the same colours as Adora, Adora likes her blue high-waisted jeans and white shirts, Catra likes *red* and she’s more the black ripped skinny jeans kind of lesbian, but she can see that Adora is considering this fact anyway. Eventually, Adora makes a sound of success and then gives Catra a pile of clothes for her to change into. Catra takes them. The excitement on Adora’s face is enough for Catra to actually get dressed.

Catra changes into the clothes. They're still a little big on her , and Catra wonders how muscular Adora was as a *teen* . She takes one look at herself in the mirror before she exits the bathroom with an unimpressed look on her face. Adora just *beams* at her. Catra was in a red and black flannel shirt which she had tucked into her black jean pants. The pants were the biggest on her and she admits, quietly , that it did give her a sense of gender euphoria, but she's not about to admit that to Adora.

Adora strokes her chin for a moment before she goes to her drawers and pulls out something. She steps up to Catra and starts attaching something to her jeans. It' s only when Adora draws them over her shoulders that Catra realises they're *suspenders* . Adora disappears again and returns with black cowboy boots that Catra pulls on, tucking her jeans into them before Adora grabs a black hat of f the nearby hook, placing it on top of Catra's head. Catra just stands there as Adora smiles so brightly at her.

Dammit .

" *I look ridiculous* ."Catra signs, but she already knows she' s going to wear this stuff - Adora's smile is *impossible* to say no to.

" *You look perfect* ."Adora signs back, rolling her eyes fondly .

" *Is the hat necessary* ?"Catra asks, raising an eyebrow .

“ *It’s **all** necessary* .”Adora signs, stepping forward. She tilts Catra’ s hat back so she can lean down and kiss her on the lips. “ *It’s only for today, promise* .”Catra looks up at Adora. Fine, she can deal with a day.

“ *Fine* ,”Catra signs, pushing Adora back by her firm chest. “ *But you better make it up to me tonight* .”

“ *Whatever you want from me* .”Catra already has a few ideas. Y ou know what they say: save a calf, ride a cowboy. Catra pats her shoulder with a smirk.

“ *Come on, I want to see just how much of a horse girl you really are* .”Adora rolls her eyes, but holds her hand out. Catra takes it.

They drive to the ranch, and Catra meets the horse in Adora’ s pictures in the flesh. Catra is informed that the horse’s name is Swift Wind, and that he only really likes Adora. Catra is also informed by the ranch owner that Swift Wind and Adora have a special bond and that he is an excellent horse but a *difficult* one - *unless* you're Adora. Catra *sees* that and, honestly, it’s something she has in common with the creature.

Catra’s never really seen a horse excited, she didnt even think horses *could* be excited, but Swift Wind lets out the loudest whinny at the sight of Adora. t makes Catra smile. “Swifty!”Adora exclaims, enthusiastically. Hearing Adora so happy and excited is a privilege that Catra will always be honoured to be privy too, even if it is

directed at a horse. Swift Wind nuzzles Adora as she takes their snout in her hands. Catra has never really been around horses before, and she never realized just how *big* they are - they're *huge*. "Catra." Adora says, waving with her hand for Catra to come over. "Come?" How could Catra say no? Especially when Adora is looking at her like that.

Catra finds horses kind of.terrifying actually. Something about them just causes her fight or flight instinct to kick in, even if they are kind of cute, but Adora gives her an encouraging look and Catra feels a little braver. She cautiously reaches a hand out and feels Swift Wind letting out a huff. He sniffs her hand first and then Adora takes her by the wrist and guides Catra's hand to press her palm to Swift Wind's snout while the blonde continues to stroke him. "Huh… you're not so bad actually." Catra says to Swift Wind and he makes a low sound as though he was agreeing with Catra.

She pets him a little longer until Adora opens the stable door. She starts getting him ready to ride and Catra watches her as she meticulously makes sure the saddle and everything is on him perfectly. She grabs him by his reins and gestures for Catra to follow after them. Adora is clearly very good with horses and, though Swift Wind was apparently stubborn, he follows Adora without protest.

Catra decides she'd rather not die and opts instead to watch Adora put Swift Wind through his paces. Catra's never ridden a horse before, but she's almost certain it can't be easy. She watches as Adora hoists herself up - *why is that so hot?* - and then she slips her feet into the stirrups. She makes a clicking noise and gently clicks her heels into Swift Wind to get him to move forward. Catra really doesn't know what it is, but right now she just can't stop thinking about being railed by Adora when they get home later that night.

Adora puts Swift Wind through his paces. Catra had been informed by Adora that he was a jumping horse, and a pretty good one, but no rider had ever been able to bond with him well enough to get him to actually perform the jumps like Adora had. She warms Swift Wind and herself up first, running him around the track and Catra watches them with great interest.

Once Adora seems satisfied with that, she moves to start jumping. Catra thinks she should maybe be wearing a helmet while doing this, but she's not - which makes Catra only *slightly* apprehensive. Catra watches as Adora says something to Swift Wind and then she clicks her heels and Swift Wind launches into action. Okay, so maybe Catra can admit that watching Swift Wind jump over hurdles with Adora is impressive. She wonders if Adora used to horse ride competitively when she was younger - Catra would have to check those trophies of hers a little closer - she's certainly skilled enough to look like she did this regularly.

Adora also looks like she's having fun. Sure, she's being all impressive riding around, jumping stuff, but what makes Catra's heart really ache (in a good way) is seeing how much Adora clearly *loves* it. Catra has never seen Adora light up so much as when she has when seeing her riding Swift Wind. Her blonde hair trails behind her in the wind, she's smiling so *wide* and she just looks *happy*. That alone makes it worth it coming out here to see where Adora grew up. She's clearly missed getting to ride Swift Wind.

Once Adora is finished she rides over to Catra and drops her reins to sign to her. "*Come on*," She signs, extending a hand. Catra's eyes widen.

“ *Are you trying to kill me ?*”Catra asks, raising an eyebrow at the blonde. Adora rolls her eyes, taking her hat off briefly to wipe the sweat from her brow before putting it back on.

“ *You’re dressed for it* ,”Adora says with a grin and *oh* , *that little shit* . Catra realises this was always Adora’s plan. “ *You’ll be with me the whole time. I got you* .”Catra huf fs before she reluctantly climbs over the wooden fence. Catra may not trust horses, but she trusts Adora.

Catra reaches up and as soon as Adora has hold of her, Catra is being lifted up easily. One moment she’s on the ground, and the next she’s in the saddle, right in front of Adora. This saddle is definitely not made for *two,* but Catra is pretty light so Swift Wind only makes a small huffing sound, like he was annoyed that someone other than Adora was on his back, and no other complaint. Catra is squeezed between Adora and the horn of the saddle, but she at least has something to hold onto when Adora takes the reins again and steers Swift Wind back towards the track.

t’ s *weird*, Catra thinks, and strangely hurts her legs. Adora guides her from behind as to how to move correctly - having Adora’s hands on her hips and basically rubbing against her from behind is awfully distracting however. Once Catra has the basics down, Adora sets Swift Wind off. Catra clings to the horn. She’s *really not* a fan of horses, she makes this decision. Catra can’t even tell Adora to slow down, so she hits her leg instead. Adora laughs from behind her. “Ow!”She complains. Catra rolls her eyes and turns to look at her to see Adora was grinning. *Little shit.* Adora does slow down after that.

They go around the track a few times and then Adora stops. She dismounts first and then helps Catra down. Catra's thighs are already *aching* and she wasnt even doing that for that long - she understands now why horse riding is a sport. Adora smiles at her and kisses her sweetly on the lips, probably to make up for the stunt she just pulled. " *So, how do you feel about horses now?* "Adora asks with a smile.

" *Hate them.* "Catra signs back. " *But… They make you happy, so I guess they're okay* ."Adora *beams* at that.

They spend the rest of the day helping out on the ranch, particularly in the stables where Adora is specifically skilled and knowledgeable. Time passes quickly and before Catra knows it, it' s relatively late, around eight o'clock. " *I want to take you somewhere* ,"Adora signs. " *What do you say?* "Catra wants to ask if she can change but she' s far too intrigued to say no.

" *Sure* ,"Catra signs. " *But we're driving there. I've had enough horses for one day* ."Adora laughs as she takes Catra' s hand and drags her off towards the car.

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Where Adora takes Catra is some country bar, the very one that Catra had seen on the night they'd first driven through town - the one with the cowboy hat on its roof. They were already two beers in and Catra was having an amazing time, surprisingly . She never really

thought a country bar would be her scene but it's weirdly camp - plus Catra and Adora's attire means that they blend in easily with the crowd. The music in the bar is some country music, none of which Catra recognises, it's not exactly her genre of music.

There's a sudden commotion as people quickly start filling out onto the dance floor. Adora, beside Catra, lights up and gestures to the dance floor to Catra. Catra instantly understands what she's asking and begins shaking her head. "No way ."She says and Adora pouts at her. Adora presses her hands together and gives Catra her *puppy dog* eyes. It takes Catra about five seconds before she caves.

Adora pauses briefly to check what song it was that was playing before she nods. She takes Catra by her hands and then they're on the dance floor, in a *line* . Catra's eyes widen and she turns to Adora. " *I don't know how to line dance, Adora* ."Catra signs.

" *Don't worry* ,"Adora reassures. " *It's easy to pick up, trust me, plus people kind of break off from lines anyway. I can't hear the music, we'll be fine together* ."Adora squeezes her hand. Catra realises that they are, in fact, a little apart from the line, giving them plenty of space to dance to their own rhythm. Catra nods.

Catra notes that the music is *much* louder than it had been a moment ago and she wonders if perhaps this bar is familiar with Adora. Catra can feel it vibrate under her feet and she knows Adora likely can too - meaning she can *feel* the rhythm.

Suddenly, everyone starts moving, Adora included. Catra never really thought Adora was much of a dancer, she's a little clumsy sometimes, but this dancing is more like hitting your feet to a rhythm and Adora is moving with the others almost entirely in sync with them. *Do people just know these automatically? Is it stored in their country hats?* Catra takes a moment, but she's a pretty fast learner and she actually has rhythm - even if it is to country music. She learns the steps and dances in time with Adora.

Catra can hear people laughing around her and she finds herself laughing as she and Adora move in their own mini line, dancing separately yet together. Adora is smiling so wide her face may just get stuck that way if she isnt careful. Adora is right, once the beat picks up, people stop dancing in the line and instead form more groups like pockets, dancing to the rhythm of the music and just having fun.

Catra decides she wants to get a little revenge on Adora for pulling her into participating in this dance, so she moves her hips, letting her ass do all of the work. When she turns to see Adora, she is pleasantly surprised to see the blonde's jaw almost on the ground. Catra smirks and pats her on the butt before she winks and tilts her hat at her. Adora is flushed and her chest is rising and falling rapidly - she also looks extremely turned on.

Mission accomplished.

The lively music eventually tempers off and then the crowds dwindle down as they pair off together as softer music plays. Adora comes over to Catra and wraps an arm around her waist while she takes

Catra's hand in her other. It's a country slow song, and it has the most ridiculous lyrics Catra has ever heard, yet it's still oddly catchy.

" *I wanna sweep off your feet tonight, I wanna love you and hold you tight.* "

The song plays as Adora holds her close. Catra sways in time with her. She had fun today. She never thought she could have fun in a country town like this, but she finds she doesn't mind this at all. Adora spins Catra slowly before bringing her back in. Catra thinks she could have fun with Adora anywhere.

" *Cause you're the one I want, you're the one I need, baby, if I was a king, you would be my queen. You're the rock in my roll, you're good for my soul, it's true. I'm head over boots for you.* "

Catra snorts at the lyrics, but she's strangely loving this. Adora moves her hands down to Catra's hips and presses their crotches together as she guides Catra. Catra looks up at her, already knowing that was unnecessary and knowing exactly what Adora was attempting to do. They're not really dancing anymore, they're *grinding* against each other.

Catra isn't one to shy away from getting to grind against Adora anyway. Catra laughs and shakes her head as she grabs Adora's hips instead and starts rolling them in time with her and the music. Adora wiggles her eyebrows. *Dork* .

Honestly? The bar is quite nice too. It's a bit more wood and rustic than the clubs of Bright Moon, like, pretty much everything is made out of wood, but it's cozy and oddly warm. Catra was worried it might have jackass people, but Eternia seems to know everyone. Perks of a small town, Catra supposes, everyone knows everyone. They're all neighbours, and friends, there's even a picture of Mara behind the bar as the town's reigning arm wrestling champion. Adora had said she'd take that title some day, Catra had simply laughed.

The music changes to another slower song, a country song Catra *actually* recognises. *You have to be kidding me*. Catra laughs and Adora looks at her curiously. "*Your arm*." Catra signs. It's a song, one that is recognisable even to those who do not know the country genre.

"*Baby, lock the door and turn the lights down low.*"

Catra grins as she turns in Adora's arms and puts her *ass* against Adora's crotch. She hears Adora gasp behind her. Around the room things seem to be getting spicier between other couples too. *Is this the careless whisper of country music?* Catra is sweating a little, especially with the cowboy hat sat on her head, but she's also enjoying moving Adora's hands to the music, grinding her ass up against her girlfriend and moving Adora's hands in order to essentially feel Catra up.

"*I've been thinking 'bout this all day long. Never felt a feeling quite this strong.*"

Catra has *definitely* been thinking about *something* all day long. This song is weirdly sexy and she likes teasing Adora. So Catra leads the blonde's hand down to the waistband of her jeans and just, ever so slightly, has her dip them just under . Adora practically *whines* from behind her and Catra feels her put her chin on her shoulder. Adora's reaction is very satisfying to Catra, and she can practically feel Adora's desire radiating off of her. *Fuck* . She cant wait to drag Adora home and to fuck her. *Who knew this song could be an aphrodisiac?*

Catra turns during the instrumental and wraps her arms around Adora's broad shoulders with a smirk. She knows that Adora knows exactly what she had been intending by doing all of that, but she's far too smug to give in to Adora just yet.

Once the song is completely over, they retreat back to the bar and get fresh beers. Adora spots something and decides she wants to ride a *mechanical bull* . Catra would be opposed to it normally, she doesnt exactly want Adora to break something - especially when she's planning to put her to use when they get back to her house - but Adora's confidence that she can do it is oddly attractive. So Catra lets her.

Catra stands at the barrier, holding her own beer and Adora's beer as Adora climbs over the padding surrounding the bull and then climbs on its back. Catra watches as the blonde gives her a thumbs up before the thing starts moving. Adora is an excellent horse rider, so Catra was hoping that skill would come in handy right about now when she decided that showing off to Catra by riding a mechanical bull, that was basically, to Catra, a death trap, was a good idea.

t starts pretty okay and Adora settles into a rhythm. Despite Catra' s apprehension that she was doing this, she jst cant stop watching. Adora moves so fluidly, even when the bull gets more violent and jerky . Adora moves her hips so well she's practically one with the bull and Catra knows that she must look impressed because Adora looks like the cat that caught the canary.

She clearly decides she wants to show off a little more and takes a hand off of the bull, riding it with jst one. Catra' s eyes widen at the action. Next thing Adora does is take her hat off and hoist it above her head, letting out a ridiculous "Y eehaw!"

Tat turns out to be her fatal mistake, and it messes up her flow so much that she gets thrown from the bull. Catra winces a little at the sound of Adora's body impacting the mat but the blonde qickly pops up that Catra's pretty confident the idiot is at least okay. Adora struggles back over to Catra, her hat in her hand and a giant goofy grin on her face. " *Impressed* "? She signs and Catra rolls her eyes as she hands Adora her beer.

" *You're an idiot* ." Catra signs back. Adora jst laughs and takes back her beer that Catra offers to her. Te blonde places her hat on her head and then she leans back, exposing that gorgeous neck of hers, as she downs the bottle of beer. She drinks so qickly that a little bit of liqid runs down her chin and drips from it. Catra isnt sure why, but it is a huge fucking turn *on* .

When Adora is done drinking her beer, Catra grabs her shirt in her hand and drags her forward, kissing her deeply, tasting the beer on her tongue. Maybe Catra hasnt been riling Adora up as much as

Adora has been riling *her* up. She just needs Adora to take her home and fuck her. *Right now* .

Catra pulls back from the kiss to see wide baby blues staring at her, and Adora's pink soft lips a little puffy from the intense kiss. " *Take me home* ."Catra signs and Adora nods quickly . She hops over the barrier and offers her hand. Catra just hopes Adora will speed a little so they can get back to hers ASAP.

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They hurry back to Adora' s house but instead of leading Catra into the house and into her bedroom, Adora instead leads her towards the *barn* . Catra was a little hesitant to have sex in a barn but she's here now and she's a little *desperate* . Today has felt like the longest foreplay Catra has ever been subjected to, from the way that Adora' s cowboy get-up had her already horny this morning, to the horse ride, to the way they were dancing and grinding against each other at the country club. Catra is so entirely ready to let go of that sexual frustration already.

Adora giggles a little as she opens the barn door and leads Catra inside. The door squeaks a little on its hinges but then Catra hears it shut behind them. She grabs Adora by her hand and into the centre of the barn, kissing her fully and hotly. She wants to get Adora undressed ASAP, so that's exactly what she does.

Catra has never been more frustrated undressing someone until she tries to undress Adora in her chaps. Somewhere along the way, Adora starts laughing at her and Catra glares at her in the dark. "I got it."Adora says. Unfortunately , thanks to the dim lighting, signing is a little hard currently, so Adora has instead resorted to verbally telling Catra things. Catra can see Adora moving and decides to speed her own undressing up at the same time. She grabs the hem of her shirt and pulls it up and over her head before she kicks off those dumbass cowboy boots and pulls her pants down and off. Next, she wiggles out of her binder and returns back to Adora.

Catra can tell that Adora is at least half undressed, she's at least chap-less. Catra reaches up and just pulls Adora' s shirt apart, ripping the buttons right off of it. "Hey! I liked that shirt."She protests. Catra isn't in the mood to sign an apology so she instead takes Adora's hand and just places it on her boob. That silences Adora pretty damn quick. Catra rolls her eyes but grins before she reaches for the button on Adora's jeans.

Adora clearly no longer cares about her shirt and is, instead, busying herself with feeling Catra up while Catra works on undressing the blonde completely. It' s a little hard when Adora keeps touching her like *that* . Adora squeezes and flicks her thumb over Catra' s erect nipple, making her gasp and practically *squirm* . God, she needs to be fucked by Adora *right now* .

Adora is kissing down her neck now as she palms at Catra's breast, she presses open mouthed kisses, *biting* and *sucking* , it's driving Catra insane. She manages to get Adora's pants pulled down half way when the blonde suddenly gropes her *ass* with her free hand. Catra lets out a whine at the sensation and she feels like she may possibly implode if Adora doesnt touch her properly soon.

Catra abdons trying to undress the blonde and instead guides the hand that was on her ass around to her front. She guides Adora's hand down and under the waistband of her underwear and presses her fingers over Adora's fingers which she presses to her own clit. Catra *moans* at the sensation and looks up at the blonde. Adora kisses her and then she pulls back long enough to whisper "Show me." hotly against Catra' s lips. Catra shudders.

Catra knows that Adora is by no means a bottom, she knows this qite well. hat being said, Adora enjpys *direction* , she enjpys *praise* , she likes to know she's doing a *good job* . hat means, more often than not, she's subbing. here' s definitely nothing wrong with that, and Catra knows it's jst how Adora is. t also means that when she *is* topping, she's usually *servicing* . his is a perfect example of jst that.

Catra knows that Adora cant hear her but she has learnt that the blonde still enjpys it when Catra speaks to her during sex - she especially likes it when Catra whispers against her lips. Catra guides Adora's fingers, as Adora had reqested, and brings them either side of her clit so Adora can roll it between her fingers. "st like that." Catra encourages, rolling her hips a little in time with the movement in her underwear. Sex with Adora is always incredible, but this is some of the best they've ever had and it' s happening in a *barn* . he thought makes her laugh a little.

Adora moves her face down and then Catra feels her *mouth* around her *boob* . Catra almost falls to the ground with the pleasure that crashes over her. "Holy sh-" Catra' s words choke off in a moan

instead. Adora's fingers are moving faster and Catra can feel the tightening in her stomach.

"So wet." Adora murmurs when she pulls back from Catra's breast. Catra almost collapses again, she definitely gets *wetter* when Adora says that. If Catra's being honest, she's been wound tight since she saw Adora in those stupid cowboy clothes. *Stupidly attractive Adora*. Adora goes back to sucking and Catra *mewls*. Thank *god* there are no animals nearby currently, Catra would have woken them by now.

Catra guides Adora's fingers lower, to her entrance and Adora pulls back to look at Catra. Their vision had adjusted to the dark now, at least their immediate surroundings, Catra could make Adora out anyway and the moon was shining through the slats in the wood, meaning they could sign now if they urgently needed to. Adora's eyes held the question plain as day to Catra. Catra nods and holds her free hand up, showing Adora one finger and then two. *One, two*. Her instruction was clear. Adora nods.

Slowly, Adora presses one finger into Catra and Catra lets out a satisfied sigh. She keeps up the movement on her clit herself while Adora works her perfectly from the *inside*. With just one finger, she works Catra up well before she slips in the second one. Catra keens at the sensation, Adora has to use her other hand to help keep Catra upright while she thrusts in and out of her relentlessly. "Holy fucking shit!" Catra gasps as she feels herself *gush* at Adora's thrusts. Adora's fingers are pretty fucking fantastic. They're long and slender and when they *curl* they hit Catra in all the right spots. They fill her all the way up. Adora's fingers are *amazing* and Catra has known this since she admired them all those months ago when the blonde walked into her coffee shop.

"You're so wet for me, Catra." Adora says. Her voice is lower than usual, laced with desire as she has her way with Catra. Catra wants to call her an asshole for saying that to her, because she almost just passed out with the way her stomach tightened at that, but all Catra is really capable of doing currently is clinging to Adora. Catra *is* wet, she can *hear* it with every thrust Adora does, and can *feel* it too.

"I'm going to-" Catra cuts off as she moans Adora's name instead. She's so close, she's right on the edge, if Adora would just do that thing where she- *Just like that*. Catra knows that she's loud when she comes but she doesn't really care. She practically fully collapses against Adora who catches her in her strong arm, keeping them both on their feet. Catra's orgasm is *intense* and she feels the aftershocks roll over her continuously. She pants softly as she clings to Adora's torso before she calms down.

Once Catra is fully conscious again, she helps Adora pull her pants and boots the rest of the way off and Adora helps Catra out of her ruined underwear. They discard their items of clothing everywhere and anywhere before Adora picks Catra up and carries her over to a pile of hay in one of the corners of the barn.

Adora lands on top of her and starts kissing her again. "There's something I've always wanted to try." Adora says. Catra turns her head to the side in a question of "*what*" and Adora grins. "I believe it's called tribbing." Catra's breath catches at that. Adora moves her hands away so she can sign now instead. "*You'd have to be on top since you're lighter and more… flexible.*" Adora wiggles her eyebrows a little and Catra scoffs.

She grabs Adora and flips their positions, pinning Adora by her shoulders against the hay. “*Yes*.” is the only thing Catra signs but she really doesn't need to say anything more, she *really* wants to do this with Adora. Adora grins up at her, nodding her head.

It takes them a moment to find a position that is *comfortable*. That’s the most difficult thing about this position, but Catra thinks Adora was right in her decision that it would be easier if Catra was on top.

As soon as Catra starts moving, Adora falls back against the hay, letting out a soft moan of pleasure. Catra smirks as she finds a rhythm and position that is pleasurable for them both.

Catra admits that she has never done this with anyone before, it feels far more intimate than say using your fingers to fuck someone, or even going down on someone. She doesn't know why she thinks tribbing is more intimate, but she does. Maybe it’s the fact that they are *literally* rubbing against each other. Whatever it is, Catra kind of loves *this* and she definitely feels comfortable doing it with Adora.

Catra grabs Adora’s leg and grinds down harder, feeling her own pleasure spike at the same time that Adora grabs at the hay under her. “Ah. Catra.” Adora moans, it only encourages Catra more. Catra is in full control of this, Adora is under her and she isn't grabbing for Catra in any way, she is lying there and taking it how Catra wants her to take it. Catra grinds harder, faster, at the thought. She can *hear* their mutual wetness as their clits rub together - it’s almost like a slip n’slide down there.

Catra goes even harder and faster, pushing both of them towards their ends quickly. Adora starts moving her hips in time with Catra and it feels *so good*. Catra thinks she might combust from the heat she feels building between them.

"Catra-!" Adora gasps suddenly. "Fuck. I'm almost. I'm almost there." Catra gently grabs her face and then signs a quick '*wait*' to her. Adora's eyes widen, and she swallows thickly, but nods her head all the same. Catra is close too, but after already coming once, she needs a little longer to let it build. If she's honest, Adora is pretty easy to get off, it doesn't take her all that long. Catra, on the other hand, needs a little more work - although Adora does seem to be able to get Catra there awfully quick.

Catra can see Adora attempting to hold her orgasm at bay and that, for some reason, makes Catra feel all tingly with pleasure. She likes seeing Adora take her orders without protest, she likes seeing Adora doing it because she wants to *please* Catra. Catra reaches a hand out and cups Adora's jaw, making her look at her. She doesn't know if Adora can read her lips in this lighting, but she's just going to say it anyway. "Good girl." Catra purrs before she bites the inside of Adora's leg.

"Catra! P-Please." Adora begs softly. Catra would be lying if she said that really didn't just do it for her. She feels her arousal spike and goes harder, rutting against Adora, *fucking* her. Adora has her eyes screwed shut, and a look of pure concentration as she tries her hardest to not come yet. Catra pats her to tell her to let go and when Adora lets out an almost *screaming* moan, Catra feels herself fall over the edge as well.

They both come and Catra keeps up her movements until it becomes too much for the both of them and then she rolls off of Adora, landing in the soft hay. Something about the fact their juices definitely mixed together when they both came, is a huge turn on and oddly satisfying. Catra half wishes she had her strap so she could rail Adora again from the inside, but, sadly, she does not. She could always use her fingers, but Adora seems pretty spent.

Catra turns to her and examines her closely. Her chest was rising and falling steadily with her breaths as Adora continued to come down from what it was that they just did. Adora' s body is beautiful. Catra trails her fingers over her toned abdominal muscles, pressing her hand flat to them. Adora's skin is smooth and soft and pleasurable to touch, she's also warm, like a mini space heater, which is nice when they're so exposed like this. Catra moves her hand up and gently squeezes Adora' s boob, causing the blonde to squeak in surprise. Catra snorts at that as Adora finally opens her eyes to look at her. "You're perfect." Catra says. She' s not sure Adora understands, but she doesn't really care when Adora starts wrapping herself up in Catra.

Adora brings Catra into her chest and holds her close and Catra sighs in contentment as she holds Adora right back. They start kissing each other, Adora kisses Catra on her collarbone, Catra can feel her hands on her lower back, holding her close. Catra knows that what they just did is intimate and significant, but sometimes she enjoys the simple intimacy of holding someone close and just kissing them.

Once they're done with their after care, Adora stands a moment later to go retrieve something. In the meantime, Catra cleans herself up as best she can before Adora returns with a fleece blanket. Catra laughs softly. "*I guess we're staying out here*?" Catra signs in question and Adora nods.

"*I figured we might as well*." Adora answers as she unfolds the blanket and then lays it over the both of them. They cuddle back up together under the blanket. Catra's only a little worried about where she's going to be finding hay in the morning, but this has been pretty much the perfect day to her, and it was a perfect way to end their night too.

Adora moves so that she's the little spoon in their cuddle. Catra smiles a little at that. She had learnt that Adora rather enjoyed being the little spoon whenever they cuddled, and Catra likes holding Adora too, but it was truly adorable that the six foot tall jacked soccer player liked to be held like this. Super cute. Catra drifts off to sleep, after she presses a kiss to Adora's shoulder blade, feeling warm and satisfied.

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When Catra wakes up, it's to the sun beaming through the wooden slats of the barn they're inside. She blinks a few times to adjust to the brightness and then stretches as she feels life slowly return back to her limbs. She sighs softly when she feels Adora shifting beside her. The blonde turns over so she can face Catra. "Morning," She mumbles, leaning forward to kiss Catra on her lips. Catra smiles into the kiss.

"Morning," Catra returns as she hoists a leg over Adora and sits on top of her. Adora looks surprised by the change in position but she quickly gets a smug smirk on her lips. She reaches up and grabs her stupid white cowboy hat that she must have moved last night when she got the blanket and she places it on top of her head. Then her hands land on Catra's hips and she licks her lips as she lifts her hips up a little. The blanket that had been over them last night was now around Adora's legs, they were very much naked and Catra was very much looking forward to taking full advantage of that fact.

Catra leans down and starts kissing Adora much more passionately than the morning kiss Adora had given her. Adora already knew Catra's intentions from the moment Catra moved herself on top of her. Catra moves her hips at the same time that Adora starts moving her *by* her hips, dragging Catra over her abs and providing her with friction that has her mouth falling open. Adora decides to take advantage of this by sliding her tongue into Catra's mouth. Catra moans before she catches the sound of something behind her that makes her freeze.

Catra sits up suddenly, straining to hear what it was that she heard. When Catra hears the barn door open, she instinctively grabs the blanket Adora had brought with them last night and throws it over herself and Adora - though with her on top of the blonde, she was practically shielding her anyway. "Good morning partners," Mara says and Catra glances over her shoulder to see that she had her hand held up to block Catra and Adora from her vision. Catra wants to *die* . This is quite possibly the most embarrassing position she has ever been caught in. "Don't mind me, I just need my kit and some supplies I think I left in here."

Catra looks down at Adora who was currently just staring up at Catra, a small smirk on her lips. Catra narrows her eyes at her and shakes her head. Adora *should* look ridiculous now, and it really isn't fair that she can look so hot and wear a fucking *cowboy hat* as she has *sex* with Catra. That simply isn't fair .

"I'm sorry , Mara," Catra apologises over her shoulder , ignoring Adora under her. Adora clearly isn't so apologetic because Catra can feel her hands wandering over her body under the blanket. Her touch is like a spark and Catra is the kindling, catching fire under Adora's hands.

"No need to apologise," Mara says with a chuckle. "Y ou're only young once. Besides, Adora should've known better, probably." Mara laughs. "I'll see you two tonight. Oh, and be careful of the barn mice." Catra's eyes widen and she catches a playful smirk on Mara's lips before she slides out of the barn door.

Once the door is closed, Catra shoves Adora by her shoulders - not super hard, but hard enough. "I'm going to kill you." Catra speaks but with the way that Adora laughs, Catra knows that the blonde knew exactly what she just said. Catra rolls her eyes and flicks the rim of Adora's stupid hat. " *What is this about mice?* " Catra signs.

" *Don't worry* ," Adora signs back. " *They don't bite.* "

" *That's not even remotely funny, Adora.* " Catra deadpans. Adora just grins up at her and then grabs her by her waist. Catra squeaks a

little as she's pulled down into the hay and they tussle for a moment, play fighting and completely *naked* - Catra was certain she was going to find bits of hay in odd places for weeks to come.

Eventually, Catra concedes, letting Adora pin her down in the hay. The blonde kisses down her stomach to her hips and Catra taps her shoulder. " *Do you really want to go again?* "Catra signs, raising an eyebrow. She never thought she'd unlock this side of Adora, the side who loves having Catra under her, or on top of her. Adora just smirks and then winks, tilting her hat.

“ *I want you to sit on my face* .”Adora signs and the statement completely knocks the wind out of Catra’s lungs. She blinks up at Adora as she slowly processes what it was that Adora was suggesting, then she nods her head quickly . Absolutely, she *definitely* wants to do that. Adora nods but then pauses. “ *The hat stays on* .”

“ *Are you serious* ?”Catra signs in disbelief.

“ *It’s my condition* .”Adora signs with a goofy smile. Of course it is. Catra doesn't know what the point of the hat is, but she really wants to sit on Adora’s pretty face. So if this is a condition of that happening, then she will allow it - Catra suspects it *may* just be an Adora being a goof thing, but she'll allow it. She likes this side of Adora anyway.

“ *Fine* ,”Catra signs. “ *Get on your back, Princess* .”Catra orders. She sees Adora shudder a little with the instruction before she does just that. She lands back in the hay with a huff but her grin stays firmly in place.

Catra does what she did before Mara walked in this morning and throws her leg over Adora. She kisses her first, because she enjoys kissing Adora. She was already a little worked up, but she needed a little more before she sat on Adora’s face. "Touch me," Catra whispers against Adora’s lips as she guides the blonde's fingers down, giving her a clear instruction as to what she wanted.

Adora presses her fingers to Catra's clit and strokes her a few times and Catra’s breath stutters out of her as she continues to kiss Adora. It's ridiculous how ready Catra already feels to take Adora, but she knows the wetter she is before she sits on Adora's face, the better. So she lets Adora have her way with her. There's so many things Catra wants to try with Adora in the bedroom, like, *so many* , like how they tried tribbing last night, Catra would love to do that with a vibrator between them. She wants to explore more BDSM related sex with Adora and, while their sex never feels vanilla, it has been for the most part as they figure each other out. Catra thinks they know each other pretty well by now.

Catra is getting wetter with anticipation, and with the thoughts swirling around in her head as Adora’s fingers stroke her. Adora moves her fingers lower, pushing tentatively at Catra’s entrance. *Fuck* . Catra would gladly ride Adora’s long fingers until she came, but her intention is to ride her face, not her fingers. Catra reaches up and pushes Adora down by her shoulders, a warning for her to stop and to get ready. Adora blinks up at her before she smirks and licks her lips pointedly. Here Catra goes.

Catra has only ever sat on a couple of people's faces. Usually she prefers to be the seat, but she trusts Adora - plus, it's not like Adora hasn't had a face full of Catra's pussy before. She lifts herself up and then hovers just above Adora' s mouth. Adora looks at her with intense eyes and nods her head before she reaches up and pulls Catra down onto her mouth. Catra's knees land either side of Adora's head and she stares in surprise before she feels the first swipe of Adora's tongue.

Catra almost falls over from the pleasure that shoots through her. It's almost unfair how skilled Adora is with her tongue. Catra knew this from the first time they slept together, but Adora's tongue is just… She knows how to use it, put it that way. Catra thinks that Adora figured her out that first night and she now knows *exactly* how Catra likes it, she knows *precisely* how to drive Catra insane.

Adora, as always, focuses mostly on Catra's clit at first. They both know that is the easiest way to get Catra riled up and ready, Adora uses her hands on Catra's hips to angle her just right and she sucks, bites and uses the whole surface area of her tongue to rub Catra in all the right ways. The *sound* that Adora was making down there was plenty panties wetting alone, never mind the actions of her tongue. Adora alternates her strokes, she's good at that too, and she moves from Catra's clit down and then back up in a pattern that has Catra seeing stars.

She starts grinding down against Adora's mouth at some point, but Catra loses pretty much all sense as she lets go, surrendering herself to Adora, and to pleasure, completely. Adora's tongue presses at her entrance and Catra feels as it slips inside of her,

making her cry out from pleasure. She goes to grab Adora by her hair, but quickly is reminded of the fact that Adora is wearing her goddamn cowboy hat. The thought weirdly makes Catra feel hotter and wetter. Why? She doesn't know. There's just something about your girlfriend wearing a cowboy hat while she eats you out that is apparently a big turn on.

Adora thrusts into her with help from Catra; she bounces a little to help and Adora guides her with her hands. Catra is already embarrassingly close, she knows she isn't going to last much longer, especially when Adora is doing that specific move where she thrusts and then puts pressure on her clit. Adora moves one of her hands from Catra's hip and moves it between her thighs, Catra feels Adora suck her clit into her mouth at the same time she feels the blonde's fingers push inside of her. "Holy- *Fuck*!" Catra practically screams. Maybe Catra is being slightly loud, but she doesn't really care.

Catra starts moving her hips much more feverishly after that, essentially fucking herself onto Adora's fingers while Adora's tongue worked her clit. It's *incredible*. It's *amazing*. Catra can feel that red hot coil in her stomach getting hotter and hotter and hotter. She can feel herself right on the edge; she just needs that little bit more and she'll crash right over.

Adora swipes her clit just right and Catra feels herself topple right over. It's an amazing feeling, right from her stomach, to her brain and then every single part of her is flooded with pleasure. She feels herself come and she knows that's it's a *lot* but when you see the entire universe behind your eyes, you don't really care about that. Catra is aware that Adora is still using her tongue, licking up the likely mess that Catra has made.

Eventually, Catra rolls off of Adora and lands beside her with a satisfied sigh. She feels beyond relaxed, float-y and satisfied. When Catra peeks an eye open, she can see Adora has turned on her side and is giving Catra a bright smile. Her face glistens a little with Catra's wetness that she hadn't fully managed to discard the evidence of. "Y eehaw."Adora says with a smirk as she tilts her hat down. Catra cant *believe* she just said that. *Is that why she wanted to wear the hat? What a dork.*

Catra surges forward, kissing Adora so intensely that she lets out a soft grunt of surprise. Catra can taste *herself* on Adora's tongue and it's intoxicating, she just can't get enough. After a long moment, Catra breaks the kiss when oxygen becomes a necessity for the both of them. " *We can cuddle for a while and then I have something planned* ."Adora signs. Catra sighs as she leans back in the hay bed.

" *What have you got planned* "?Catra signs curiously .

" *We're going fishing* ."Catra snorts at Adora' s response but when she sees that Adora isn't joking, she blinks up at her . She didn't think Adora was serious about that. Well, she supposes, they're going fishing, but, for now, she wants her snuggles. Catra turns Adora over and spoons her from behind. As long as she gets her cuddles.

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" *What* ..." Catra pauses her hands, taking in all of Adora. " *What are you wearing* ?" Adora stops what she's doing to look at Catra directly. She was wearing cargo shorts, with a shirt that said 'Women Want Me Fish Fear Me' that was a khaki green colour, on her feet she was wearing sandals with socks and then, to top it all off, she was wearing a bucket hat and some kind of fishing vest. Catra doesn't think Adora could look more like a dad if she tried. That's not even the worst part, Adora *still* looks so hot. How does a person committing the worst fashion crimes Catra has ever witnessed in her entire life, still look so attractive?

" *What* ?" Adora asks. " *We're going fishing* ." Of course that's Adora's answer. Catra wants to kiss her super attractive and dorky face. So she does.

Adora grins at her as she pulls away and then picks up the supplies she had been packing. "Why don't you get ready while I get everything packed for our day?" Adora suggests, verbally , with her hands full. Catra pats her on her butt and nods.

She showers and gets dressed. She decides against dressing like Adora and is happy she can go back to wearing something that isn't straight out of a budget western movie. She wears her ripped skinny jeans and combat boots with one of Adora' s hoodies and then puts Adora's letterman jacket over the top.

Catra exits the bedroom to see Adora standing by the door. Catra stuffs her hands in her jacket. " *Ready* ?" Adora asks. Catra nods her head and follows after Adora, outside.

Adora drives them there and parks. Catra helps her carry some of the stuff but Adora still takes the majority of them. Catra deals with the guy where they hire a little boat, with Adora paying. Then they're by the lake side, Adora loads the boat up with everything they need.

Catra was slightly nervous, if she was honest, she doesn't exactly know how to swim. She taps Adora on her shoulder, grabbing the blonde's attention. " *I don't know how to swim* ."Catra admits. Adora turns her head to the side. This seems to perplex Adora for a moment before she turns and grabs some big orange vest and pulls it over Catra's head. Catra gives her an unamused look.

" *Sorry,* "Adora signs. " *Safety first. If you can't swim, you have to wear a life jacket.* "

" *Are you saying you wouldn't save me* "?Catra asks, mostly teasing. Adora shoves her gently before she moves her head towards the boat.

Adora gets in first and then helps Catra in and Catra sits down on one of the wooden benches. She starts sulking. She feels ridiculous in this life jacket, but she thought it was best for Adora to know - just in case she did fall in and need rescuing. She can see Adora smiling slightly in amusement across from her and Catra flips her off, making Adora laugh out loud. " *Sorry* ."She signs. Catra is being a brat, she knows this, but she wants to feel sorry for herself for a little longer.

Adora drives (sails?) them to the middle of the lake and then she sets up the fishing rods. Catra watches her in silence before she finishes and hands a pole to Catra. Catra looks at it. " *I don't know how* ."She admits and Adora smiles softly . She sets her own rod to one side and then gestures for Catra to watch and follow what she was doing.

" *First the bait* ,"Adora signs. " *Now to cast.* "She pulls it back and then casts out the line. " *When you get a bite, you will feel it* ."Adora signs after she hands the pole to Catra. " *Then you just reel it in with this* ."She moves the reel and shows Catra how to do it. Catra nods in understanding and then Adora looks at her. " *You can take the jacket off, I was joking, mostly. Just don't fall in. I don't feel like getting wet today, at least, not in an un-sexy way* ."Adora winks and Catra feels her mood lift already. She rolls her eyes playfully and hands the rod to Adora as she takes the vest off. She hits Adora with it and the blonde yells in protest but laughs all the same. God, Catra really does love that big blonde idiot.

Catra learns that fishing really is just mostly waiting, but she doesn't mind it so much. At some point, the two of them slip into the middle of the boat, sitting with their backs against one side and their feet pressed up against the other. Catra likes the silence, she's enjoying just being around Adora, listening to the nearby birds in the trees all around the lake with Adora's steady breathing and warmth beside her. It's kind of perfect actually . She gets why people fish, there's a certain kind of peacefulness to it. Adora hands Catra a beer that she brought in a cooler and Catra pops it open as she looks up at the sky. She clinks her can to Adora's and they fall back into their silent relaxing. Catra never thought she'd really enjoy fishing, but she's starting to see its benefits.

Catra’s relaxation is interrupted when she feels a tug on her rod. She jumps a little at how violent the interruption feels. It had been quiet and peaceful and then suddenly she had a *bite* . She sets her beer to one side and taps Adora on her shoulder to get her attention. Adora helps her, because, honestly, Catra has no idea how the hell you're supposed to reel in a fish. Adora gestures with her hand to reel whenever Catra should reel and helps her to pull the rod whenever appropriate. Catra was not expecting fishing to be quite so taxing.

Finally, the fish makes it the last few metres from the boat and Catra sees it splash as it tries to resist her. Catra never thought fishing could be so adrenaline inducing, yet here she is, feeling her heart pound in her chest and her blood pumping in her ears. They manage to hoist the thing onto the boat and then Adora unhooks it and lifts it up with a grin. "Big."Adora says. She hands it to Catra who takes it with a slight grimace when she feels the slime on it.

“ *Let me take a photo* ,”Adora signs. She pulls out her phone and Catra smiles for the camera, lifting up the fish. Once Adora has done that, together, they release the fish back into the lake. Catra smiles. It’ s weird, maybe, but she was slightly proud of that catch - plus the one sitting next to her, aka Adora Grayskull. Adora presents her phone to Catra and Catra sees that she’s now the lockscreen of Adora’s phone - her and her big fish. Catra laughs before she kisses Adora on her cheek. Maybe not her best picture, but Catra’s lockscreen is a picture of her and Adora pulling silly faces in a selfie. She adores that picture.

They spend a few more hours on the lake and then Adora drives them back. Adora catches a few fish and Catra adds only one more onto her tally before they leave. When they get to the shore, they sit

and have a picnic until the sun goes down and then Adora confesses that she had other plans for them to do.

That’s how they end up here, with Adora carrying a blanket in one hand and holding Catra’s hand in her other as the blonde drags her up some steep bank in the middle of nowhere. When they reach the top, Catra can see the lights of the town below them, well, the few that were on and the street lights anyway. Adora spreads the blanket and then gestures for Catra to get comfortable. Catra smiles as she sits.

“*I thought we could stargaze*,” Adora signs.

"*Sounds perfect*." Catra responds. She looks up at the sky. It is a clear night, kind of the perfect one for staring at the fireballs of space that are burning miles away. "*Did you know that some of the stars we see may have actually died?*" Catra asks. Adora gives her a quizzical look to carry on. "*Yeah, their light travels light years so that by the time we see it, they could already be dead. It's kind of morbidly beautiful, you know? That even though they're dead and long gone they still shine on somewhere, and are seen long past their time*." Catra isn't so sure where this part of her is coming from, but once she starts she can't seem to stop. If she's honest, she's kind of always liked space, she found it very interesting as a kid, if she didn't want to be a lawyer, astrophysicist would have been her next chosen career path. Adora, at least, is watching her signs closely, showing that she's paying attention to Catra’s words. It warms Catra’s heart. "*Although, most are actually probably still alive, but I always liked that idea of the dead still being seen.*" Adora smiles at her and shuffles closer.

Catra feels her heartbeat picking up, she thinks about blurting it out, of telling Adora in a rush of feelings just how much she actually feels for her, but she can't. She has to do this properly and coherently. Catra, instead, stares up at the sky and signs " *Beautiful.* "It's a pretty night.

When Catra looks back at Adora, Adora isn't looking at the sky, she's staring right at Catra. " *Yeah* ,"She signs. " *Beautiful* ."Adora is staring *directly* at Catra and it makes Catra blush. Catra leans forward and kisses Adora on her lips.

"I love you, Adora."Catra whispers against Adora' s lips. Catra looks away from the blonde. She thinks about what Mara said, about how they deserved love, how it was never a bad thing to add more love to the world, and her resolve hardens. It' s hard being vulnerable, but there's no one Catra wants to be that with than Adora. Catra looks up and her mismatched eyes meet Adora's intently. She can see the question in Adora' s eyes but she doesn't say anything, just waits.

Catra gestures for Adora to pay attention to her hands, if she's going to say this, she wants it to be in a way that Adora understands and that she knows what Catra is saying absolutely. Catra lifts her hands and then, very purposely, signs her next words very slowly for Adora to understand. " *I love you* ."Signing the words is almost more intense than having to speak them, but it's out there now. Catra bears her soul for Adora to see. She's not sure what she expected. A rejection maybe? Adora to tell her she didn't feel the same? But what she gets instead is Adora's eyes softening and her lips turning up in a gentle smile.

Adora reaches her hands forward and wraps her fingers around Catra's hands. She kisses Catra's hands before she looks up at her with a wider smile than before. "I love you too."Adora says, *out loud*. The words knock the wind right out of Catra's lungs. She takes a moment, letting them wash over her and settle in the centre of her chest, right in her heart. Adora *loves* her. There's something significant about the fact they each said that in each other's language. "*You really love me?*"Adora signs with a grin. Catra actually laughs before she pounces on Adora, pinning her to the ground. *She's such an idiot. But she's my idiot.* Catra thinks fondly.

"*I love you so much*."Catra signs back. "To the moon and back." Catra speaks before she grabs Adora by the front of her shirt and pulls her up into a heated kiss.

They kiss for a long moment under the stars of Eternia. Catra feels like she won some kind of love lottery. As they continue to kiss, having confessed their love, Catra thinks that maybe her thoughts weren't unfounded. Maybe Adora actually is her soulmate, maybe it was fate that brought Adora to that coffee shop one chilly autumn day, Catra doesn't know. What she does know is that Adora is in love with her, and Catra is in love with Adora.

This was the beginning of the rest of their lives.

Chapter End Notes

Okay so the line dancing scene was inspired by the Footloose (2011) scene, you should look that up. The two slow dance songs were Head Over Boots by Jon Pardi (also the title of this chapter because it fit their feelings far too well) and the absolute classic that is Your Man by Josh Turner. These two finally

confessed they're in love with each other. They even dropped the L word (and I don't mean Lesbian xD) out loud. Thank you for the continued support !! All comments are deeply appreciated. See y'all next time for the final chapter :)

You can find me (and M) on Twitter @colordadora and on Tumblr @eraswordstrap

all good things

Chapter Summary

Adora leans down and kisses Catra. This kiss is a lot less messy, a lot less desperate, but no less intense. This isn't a kiss meant to distract, but a kiss that bares their souls to each other. Adora remembers walking into that coffee shop, she remembers the disappointment of being unable to sign with Kyle and then she remembers Catra. Her saving grace. In a lot of ways, Catra has breathed a new life into Adora. She never felt hopeless before, but maybe Adora had surrendered herself to the motions, stopped trying, not knowing how to communicate with people outside of her little bubble, and then along came Catra. Adora had stopped living until she saw her again. She woke her up.

Chapter Notes

Happy New Year !! New year, new chapter - and the final chapter at that. I would like to thank everyone for their patience with me and updating the last chapter of this fic; I've been extremely busy with uni and simply didn't have the time to write (I really probably should get back to writing essays but alas :P). Thank you for reading, thank you for the kudos, the comments, just everything. The support and love for this fic has blown me away. I really hope you all enjoy this final chapter to their story . I have enjoyed every second of getting to write these two, I'm going to miss them dearly. The chapter title is 'all good things' because, as I'm sure you all know , all good things must come to an end - as much as I wish they didn't.

Anyway, I'll save the rest for the end notes. Please enjoy!!

Warning, (light) NSFW ahead !!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

You can hear it in the silence, silence, you
You can feel it on the way home, way home, you
You can see it with the lights out, lights out
You are in love, true love
You are in love

- You Are In Love, Taylor Swift

Summer

Adora stares at her laptop screen. Maybe 'stares' is putting it lightly, she's more *glaring* at the screen as the cursor of her open document blinks at her, practically taunting her. Adora has been staring at it for. She doesn't even know how long, a while definitely. She's been feeling anxious all day, knowing she should have started this essay probably days ago but being unable to actually sit herself down to do the research, and the reading, and the *writing*. She's frustrated with herself. She knows she should be doing and focusing on this one task, but her mind just won't let her.

And that's not even the worst part. She *wants* to, oh how she wants to, she would love to get this stuff out of the way, off her mind, reassured that it's done and dusted and not have to panic at the last minute, but of course she just *can't*. She's frustrated with herself, and she hits her desk with her fist as she closes the lid of her laptop a little more forcefully than she probably should. It's not due for a few more days, but Adora is starting to feel more panicked the more she *doesn't* do anything for it and even the anxiety isn't enough to focus her mind.

Adora clenches her fists, feeling *overwhelmed* . She needs a break. Probably. But then maybe not. Maybe she should open her laptop up and force herself back into writing *something* . She knows that's not going to work, shell only torture herself more. She groans in frustration. She is a masochist after all.

She opens her laptop back up, glancing at the textbook that was open on her desk. *Catra* . Maybe she could ask Catra to go to the library? No, that wouldnt work. Adora knows she has a shift right now at the coffee shop on campus. Maybe she could go there, do some studying and then go to the library after? But then that' s trapping Catra in her misery too. What time is it even? Adora doesnt remember the last time she saw sunlight, and she's been unshowered and sitting in her boxer shorts and hoodie for the whole day.

Adora stands and peers out of her door. Glimmer and Bow are home and theyre watching TV . *Shit* . Maybe it's later than Adora first thought. Her curtains are pulled closed so she hadnt really noticed. She walks over to her window and pulls the curtains open. It' s dark. It' s *definitely* later than Adora first thought. She knows Catra is on the closing shift tonight, which means she still wont be finished, but she frowns. *How did so many hours pass and she hasn't done anything ?* Adoa can feel that familiar panic inside of her again, the overwhelming feeling that she should be doing something *right now* , yet the inability to motivate herself to do so.

She crosses back over to her desk and plops down on her chair. She grabs her phone and decides to text Catra. It' s 7pm, Adora knows the shop closes at 7:30pm and they usually clean up for an hour if

it’s been especially busy - only half if it was quiet. It usually gets quiet around about now , so Adora risks texting her girlfriend. She thinks Catra is about the only person who can lift her current mood.

Princess

Hey, how is the shop? Sick of dealing with hipster college students yet?

Adora’s leg bounces a little as she locks her phone and waits for a response. Catra typically keeps her phone on her while she’s working, but if she’s making a coffee, or cleaning, or doing whatever, then she wont instantly reply to Adora. Adora sighs as she slumps in her chair. She feels off. She puts it down to being tired, but she thinks maybe it might be more.

Kitten

Not too bad

Are you okay?

Adora snorts at the fact Catra can seemingly sense that Adora is in mild distress even when she is nowhere near her - and her text wasn't even that unusual. Adora has a tendency to lie when asked that question, she still has the urge as she stares at the question on her phone. She thinks her thoughts are too big to express over text, she’s not sure she can bombard Catra with all of that while she's working. So she decides to avoid the question completely .

Princess

How do you make yourself concentrate?

Kitten

Depends. Not saying this because Iwork in a cof fee shop,

but caffeine helps with that. Having trouble focusing, Princess?

Princess

Something like that

Kitten

Do you want me to bring you a coffee home from work?

Im bringing you a cof fee.

Princess

You dont have to do that

Kitten

Shut up

Adora laughs at the text Catra just sent her , telling her to shut up. She guessed that meant that Catra was coming over, and she was going to see Adora's state. Adora *did* have plenty of time to fix herself up, but she just didnt have the energy . She sighs when she receives another text.

Kitten

Go get a snack too

Unless you want a stale ass leftover muffin

You know what, Ill bring you one of those too

Princess

My hero.

Adora smiles at her phone. Catra always makes her smile. After that text she tosses her phone down on her desk. Catra's right, maybe a snack will make her feel just a little bit better .

Adora stands back up from her desk and exits her bedroom. She doesn't see Bow and Glimmer look at her, but she does feel their eyes land on her. She ignores them and heads, instead, directly for the kitchen. She doesn't need them giving her worried glances.

Adora pulls the fridge door open and looks inside. *Wow* , she really needs to go grocery shopping. Most of this is Glimmer and Bow's

stuff. Sometimes they share, but Adora prefers it when she buys her own stuff. Glimmer and Bow are dating, they don't seem to care about sharing food, but Adora is more particular about that stuff. She wouldn't be mad if Glimmer or Bow used her stuff, but she would feel bad if she used *their* stuff. She can't explain it, it's just how her brain is.

She grabs a protein bar that is stuffed behind some sad looking broccoli and kicks the fridge shut with her foot. She almost jumps out of her skin when she sees Glimmer standing there. Adora glares at her and begins to sign angrily at her best friend. " *What have I told you about that* "?Adora asks, hitting her hands together in a very aggressive and frustrated way. Glimmer winces a little.

" *Sorry* ,"She signs and Adora lets out a breath. She's not really mad with Glimmer, she's just wound too tight at the moment, she can't take it out on her friend - even if Adora hates it when people don't make an effort to announce their presence to her in some way. " *You were looking in the fridge and* -"Glimmer stops moving her hands when Adora rolls her eyes, not wanting to listen to her excuses. " *I'm sorry* ."Glimmer signs again.

Adora walks past her pink-haired friend and into the living room, aggressively biting open her protein bar. Bow peeks up from the sofa, giving her a sheepish look. *Oh, so this is an ambush* . " *I'm fine* ."Adora signs. She doesn't feel like getting into this with her roommates. She just wants her girlfriend, and for Catra to give her kisses and cuddles. Bow gives her a look of disbelief from the sofa and she imagines Glimmer is probably doing the same. Adora is frustrated, and she knows sometimes that if she pushes too hard, she can snap. Better to remove herself from the situation.

She doesn't say anything else to her two best friends. She crosses the room to her bedroom, opens the door, closes it (maybe a little more forcefully than she intended) and then sits down at her desk. She angrily chomps on her protein bar as she frowns at her computer and her blank document. She hates feeling like this.

***

Catra knocks on Adora’s apartment door. She knows Glimmer and Bow are in because she got a text from Glimmer as well as Adora. She still doesnt fully understand the meaning of Glimmer ’s text, but she knows Adora must be going through something or she doubts the blonde would have texted her *and* that Glimmer would have. Speaking of the devil.

Glimmer opens the door and Catra steps inside, no greeting between them necessary. "Sparkles, what the hell does 'code red' mean?" Catra asks, stopping so far into the apartment. She turns to look at her, spotting Bow on the couch.

"It means that Adora is going through something," Glimmer says. Catra scoffs at her and rolls her eyes, crossing her arms over her chest.

"Obviously," Catra says. "I got that from the text she sent me. So what? You two are conspiring in here behind her back."

"It's not like that," Bow protests from the sofa. He sounds almost offended by the suggestion. "Adora gets like this, no matter how hard we try. She thinks she has to shoulder everything, she never wants to 'burden' her friends with her problems." Bow looks sad at that and Catra sighs.

"And you think I can help her?"

"If you can't, no one can." Glimmer says. *Great* , so no pressure then. Catra looks at Adora's bedroom door and then walks towards it. She had texted Adora that she wasn't far away so she was probably expecting her, meaning Catra knew she could just open Adora's bedroom door and slip inside.

Catra isn't sure what she's expecting, the way Glimmer and Bow were framing it, she was expecting to see Adora completely *broken* , but she just looks like regular Adora - if a little dishevelled. She does seem mildly stressed by the crinkle that's in her brow, and she's wearing boxer shorts and a hoodie as she stares at the screen of her computer.

Okay, maybe it's a little depressing in here after all. Catra finally takes the whole room in, realising it was dark, and the only source of light was coming from the screen of Adora's open laptop. There was a wrapper of a protein bar on her desk as well as an open textbook that looked familiar to Catra - it was the one from the library, the one Adora had been so happy to get her hands on. Catra is a pre-law

student, she is no stranger to academic stress, but she also knows Adora doesn't necessarily tackle it as regular students do.

Catra sighs and places the coffee cup she had in her hand down on Adora's desk along with the little bag with the muffin inside. Adora turns to her, she seems a little startled, but not completely, and she smiles gratefully. Catra caves at that smile, she just can't help it. Adora has one of the most heart melting smiles in existence, it turns Catra into goo as soon as she sees it. " *Your stale muffin, as promised* ."Catra signs and Adora lets out a soft laugh.

Catra decides she isn't going to let Adora feel sad anymore and climbs into her lap. It's a little awkward, and they almost topple backwards in Adora's desk chair before Adora saves them by grabbing hold of her desk, but they manage. Catra settles in Adora's lap and she reaches over to flick on her desktop lamp. Adora seems surprised by Catra's sudden intrusion of her lap but she also looks *tired* and relieved to have Catra's physical affection.

Adora wraps her arms around Catra securely, pulling her closer and cuddling her tightly. "I missed you."Adora whispers quietly . Catra answers her with a soft peck on her cheek.

Catra glances at Adora's laptop to see a blank document. She reaches her hand out to close its lid so it was out of sight. Once she has what is clearly torturing Adora out of sight, she turns back to her, wrapping her arms around her girlfriend's neck. She smiles and sees Adora's features light up a little in response which warms Catra's heart. She leans in, kissing Adora on her lips softly.

Catra had intended the kiss to be soft, sweet even, but it quickly deepens. Adora lets out small satisfied sounds, soft moans as she takes the lead. Catra is just happy to be kissing Adora, she's more than happy to deepen it and meet Adora's enthusiasm with her own. Catra pauses when she feels Adora's fingers at the waistband of her pants.

She pulls back from the kiss, resting her fingers on Adora's hand. Adora looks at her curiously. " *Are you… Sure about this?* "Catra doesnt know exactly what was up with Adora, though she has her suspicions, but she doesnt want to have sex with her when she's upset either - she doesnt want it to be used as a distraction from the topic by the blonde.

Adora looks at her with an expression Catra cant quite place before she leans forward to kiss her. She takes her hands away to sign her words. " *I'm okay, I promise* ."She signs. Catra is inclined to believe her. Adora isnt in the habit of lying to others, though Catra thinks she isnt always completely honest to herself. " *I need a break from staring at my blank document* ,"Adora explains. " *And I'd really like to… touch you* ."Catra would be lying if she said she didnt want Adora to touch her too.

" *Okay* ,"Catra signs and she smiles a little when she sees Adora light up. " *But we have to be quiet, your roommates are next door* ."

" ***You*** *have to be quiet* ."Catra rolls her eyes at that.

“ *I’m staying tonight, so I’m going to steal your clothes in the morning* .”Catra warns and Adora laughs softly , nodding her head. Then they're kissing again. Catra hadnt exactly planned for *this* to happen, but she isnt mad about it either .

When Catra had first met Adora, her eyes had been drawn to her hands, and her fingers, and now that she’s had said fingers buried inside of her, *multiple times* , Catra can safely say that she was right to be drawn to them. They're long and nimble, they're also slightly callused and they feel *incredible* . Catra doesnt think anyone has ever been able to please her quite as well as Adora has.

Catra buries her face in Adora’s neck, hiding her face and muffling her quiet moans into the blonde’ s neck so that Glimmer and Bow wouldnt hear anything. It’ s *hard* . Adora seems to be bringing her A-game, warming Catra up perfectly, rubbing her clit before she starts a steady rhythm by burying her fingers inside of Catra. Catra finds it hard to keep her mouth shut, especially when Adora whispers soft praise to her.

Catra comes almost embarrassingly fast. Usually it takes her a while to get there, but she supposes she was more wound up than she first thought - plus Adora’s fingers are like magic. Besides, this wasnt meant to be like their usual times, more like a quickie. Catra thinks she completed it pretty successfully.

“Good.”Adora says quietly , probably when Catra tenses up. She had been a little more vocal than she had intended but she’s fairly

confident that she kept it down enough that Glimmer and Bow would have no idea what it was that they just did. Adora stills her fingers, pulling out of Catra, but she keeps her hand in Catra's pants.

"Okay?" She asks. Catra laughs a little and then nods, leaning forward to kiss Adora on her lips. Catra came here to make *Adora* feel better, instead the blonde had ended up making her feel good. That's the thing about Adora though, making other people feel good, makes her feel good.

"*We should clean up*." Catra signs and Adora nods in agreement. She pulls her hand from Catra's pants and holds it up, showing Catra the mess she had made. *Shit*, maybe Catra needed a shower too. Adora is staring at her hand, and Catra can see *exactly* what it is that she's thinking. She grabs the blonde by her wrist and shakes her head. "*Unless you want to get out the strap, I wouldn't*." Catra warns. Adora smirks at her. That stupid sexy smirk. Catra is pretty sure Adora is unaware just how attractive she is, even when she's smug. Now that Catra thinks about it, she kind of wants the strap to come out, maybe she's way more wound up than she thought she was, or maybe it's just Adora who makes her feel this way, whatever it is, she needs a cold shower to shake it off.

"*Maybe later tonight*." Catra signs. She's more than willing to have sex with Adora, but right now she wants to focus on taking care of Adora in the none sexual sense. Adora, thankfully, agrees and nods her head.

Catra stands from Adora's lap and she grabs Adora by her wrist, dragging her towards her bedroom door. She opens it and they

quickly make their way towards the bathroom, ducking their heads to avoid the eyesight of Glimmer and Bow. The last thing Catra hears as she closes the bathroom door is Glimmer laugh which makes Catra blush furiously.

When Catra turns to Adora, she cocks her head to the side in confusion like some cute golden retriever puppy. Catra just shakes her head, telling Adora not to worry about it. "*Maybe we should shower*?" Adora asks, before washing her hands under the faucet of the sink. Maybe Adora is right, Catra's underwear has become *uncomfortable* to say the least, a shower wouldn't be the worst thing in the world. Catra nods and turns to the shower, running the water to let it heat up for them.

Catra turns back to Adora who places her hands on Catra's hips. "Can I undress you?" Adora asks, her eyes seem a little darker and her voice low. It makes Catra shudder . She doesn't know how this keeps happening, but she supposes that getting help undressing wouldn't be the *worst* thing in the world.

"*Do you usually get horny when you're stressed*?" Catra signs. She watches as Adora's eyes follow the movement of her fingers before she sees Adora's cheeks turn a rosy pink. *Interesting.* Adora shakes her head, and then she seems to stop and consider it.

"Huh." She mutters under her breath and Catra laughs. She thinks she just helped Adora find something out about herself. Adora notices Catra's laugh and a soft smile spreads across her face. Adora looks less lustful now and more soft, happy, *relaxed* . That

was better. "Maybe." She admits before she leans forward to peck Catra on her lips.

Suddenly they're making out. Catra doesn't really mind, Adora is an *incredible* kisser. Her lips are soft and she tastes like vanilla. Her hands slip under Catra's shirt and she slowly lifts it up, her hands trailing along Catra's sides. It makes Catra shiver . Adora seems to be enjoying this. She seems more than happy to kiss, touch and undress Catra and Catra is more than happy to let her. She struggles a little with Catra's binder but once she's free, Catra wraps her arms around Adora's neck and pulls her close, closing the distance between their lips. Catra feels Adora's hands travel down to her ass and *squeeze* . *Fuck* . Adora needs to be careful or she's really going to start something they probably won't be able to finish.

Catra's pants hit the floor and then her underwear, which she steps out of, then she's right back to kissing Adora. It's getting heated in the bathroom and Catra doesn't just mean their make out session, it's *literally* getting hot in there. Catra opens her eyes and notices the mirror is steamed up and then she remembers that she started running the water. She pulls back from kissing Adora. " *We should get in the shower before all the hot water runs out* ." Catra signs. Adora pouts a little at the fact that they were interrupted but she nods. " *Wait, we need clothes* ."

" *You get in and I'll join you in a moment* ." Adora signs back. She gathers up Catra's scattered clothing and dumps it into the laundry hamper that was in the bathroom. Catra stares for a moment before she turns to the shower and steps inside.

She sighs when she feels the hot water hit her skin. She knows Adora has gone to retrieve them some clean clothes so they can get dressed when they get out of the shower, and she knows it might be strange, but seeing Adora gather up her clothes and put them into her laundry basket really made Catra feel all… *warm* . t made her think domestic, sparkly, rainbow thoughts.

f Catra was honest, she would love to live with Adora next year . She knew the renewal on her lease would be coming up relatively soon and as much as Catra loved living with her best friend, Scorpia spent most of her time at Perfuma's nowadays. Living with Adora.Catra is surprised by how much she *wants* that. Even if for some reason their relationship did break romantically, shed want Adora to be in her life still. Catra couldnt imagine being without her anymore. Shed have to talk to Scorpia about it, and Adora.

Catra hears Adora enter and then shuffle around a little, it took her a little longer than Catra was expecting but she thinks maybe she took that time to drink the coffee Catra had brought her - and eat that stale muffin too. The blonde slips into the shower behind Catra. Catra turns and reaches up, pulling Adora's hair out of its tight ponytail, letting it fall down her shoulders. Adora sighs happily, probably because the thing was giving her a headache being that tight, before she wraps her arms around Catra. Catra sighs happily. Her favourite place to be is in Adora's arms.

The warm water is nice against her skin, and the company is nice too. They take turns bathing each other . t' s a little sensual but mostly theyre just enjoying each other 's company. Catra is more than happy to do this. She's *very* aware of Adora's hands on her, but she also has her hands on Adora's *naked* body. t' s somewhat distracting. Catra runs her fingers through Adora's golden locks and

kisses her softly on her lips. They stay in there way longer than necessary, just enjoying being like *this* with each other.

When they finally get out, Adora gives her a towel and Catra begins drying herself down. She doesn't want to bother with drying her hair with a hairdryer so she uses the towel instead. It'll do. It makes her hair fluffier and curlier but she doesn't really care when it's this short. Adora also towels her hair until it is relatively dry but still somewhat wet due to its length. They smile at each other, elbowing one another in the tight space.

Catra puts on the clothes that Adora brought her. Just some sleep shorts and Adora's hoodie, but Catra loves this hoodie. It's one of Adora's soccer hoodies, it's big and loose, hides her chest perfectly, is comfortable and smells of *Adora*. Catra would live in this thing if it was an option. Adora also gets dressed and then they stand at the sink. "*I just realised I don't have a toothbrush here*."Catra signs. "*What am I going to do*?"

"*Just use mine*."Adora signs back. Catra blinks.

"*Yours*?"Catra asks, raising an eyebrow.

"*I'm sorry*,"Adora signs. "*You'll stick your tongue in my mouth, but using my toothbrush is too far for you?*"Okay, does Adora have a point? Maybe. But Catra feels like it isn't the same. She shrugs and looks over at Adora who had turned her attention back to her hair. She was brushing it, ready, probably, to put it back into a ponytail.

“ *Do you want to be bald by the time you’re thirty* ?” Catra asks and Adora pauses.

“ *Not particularly* ,” Adora signs back.

“ *I say we relax for a little while, order some food, hang out with your roommates and you let me braid your hair instead* . *Sounds like a deal* ?” Catra looks at her girlfriend. She can see Adora thinking it over in her head before she seems to agree.

“ *Okay* ,” Adora nods her head as she signs. “ *But only because you asked so nicely* .” Catra rolls her eyes and shoves Adora a little.

They finish up in the bathroom and then exit into the living room to join Glimmer and Bow . “Oh look, they did the walk of shame and now they’re joining us.” Glimmer comments. Catra flips her off at that but Glimmer simply laughs.

Catra settles on the couch and Adora sits down in front of her, letting Catra comb her fingers through her hair so she could start braiding it. “I was thinking,” Catra says to Glimmer and Bow , “we could watch a movie and order pizza?” She suggests.

“I’ll order the pizza,” Bow says happily , pulling out his phone. He gets Adora’s attention and begins signing to her about what she wanted

to order while Catra continued braiding her hair.

"You're now officially the Adora whisperer." Glimmer comments. Catra snorts a little.

"She isn't a dog, Sparkles." Catra points out. "Is it really hard for you guys to get Adora to relax?"

"Well, we can't exactly sleep with her to get her to calm down." Glimmer says. Catra feels her entire face flush red at that.

"Shut up before I make you, Sparkles." Catra warns, though, it does make her curious about something. "Has Adora ever... You and Adora, have you *never* done anything like that before?"

"Hooked up?" Glimmer asks. "No, we've kissed a few times, but just friendly, like what you do on drunk night outs. I know she has hooked up with Mermista before- Wait, why am I telling you this? Can't you ask your girlfriend yourself?"

"I can," Catra grumbles. She admits that she felt a *little* jealous when she heard that, but it wasn't nothing she couldn't handle. She looks at Glimmer. "Thanks. I... For everything." Glimmer stares at her for a moment.

"Did you just thank me?" Glimmer asks, and she has a smug expression on her face. This is why Catra never says these kinds of things, she swears. "Oh my gosh, Bow , get making the friendship bracelets, Catra *thanked* me."

"Sparkles, if you don't stop talking, I'm going to punch you in the face." Catra groans but, if she' s honest, it's nice. Her and Glimmer have always been opposites, people who clash, but that somehow makes her easier to be friends with. Catra doesn't like to admit it, but Glimmer might actually be a lot like her, which is why they butt heads so often but get along so easily.

"Punch me in the face?" Glimmer asks. "Sounds like we *definitely* need those bracelets. You're now part of the Best Friend Squad."

"I'll get on making them!" Bow says excitedly . Catra rolls her eyes but, secretly, her chest feels warm and she knows she's smiling a little. This feels easy , comfortable. Adora considers Bow and Glimmer like family, and they're basically accepting and welcoming Catra into their family. It' s. Nice. Wholesome.

"Just don't make it pink," Catra responds playfully . Bow and Glimmer start talking quietly , discussing pizza, Catra knows Adora already gave Bow both her own and Catra's order because she had watched her sign it to him.

Catra finishes braiding Adora's hair, she seems completely relaxed now and Catra rests her hands on her broad shoulders to let her

know that she was done. Adora turns and smiles, she pushes herself up onto her knees and then climbs onto the couch beside Catra, snuggling up to her to the point she practically has herself draped over Catra. Catra doesnt mind, Adora feels like a warm weighted blanket.

Catra hears Bow begin ordering the pizza and so she signs to Adora the discussion that she missed because Catra had been busy braiding and Adora hadnt been in the position to see them sign any of it so they'd simply talked. Adora snorts when Catra gets to the part about the friendship bracelets. " *You know he's absolutely going to make them, right* "?

" *I figured* ."Catra responds with a small smile. Honestly , she isnt even mad about it, she'd kind of love to have a bracelet. When you've spent your life like Adora, it' s not just about blood that makes a family. She lost her parents, she spent years in an abusive orphanage with some evil woman, she's adopted and she has her friends who are all her family. Adora may have lost her blood family, but she found a family all the same. Being part of the Best Friend Squad' means Catra is also part of that family .

Catra pulls Adora closer by her shirt and kisses her softly on her lips, Adora responds just as happily . " *I love you* ."Catra signs after a moment. Adora gives her one of her classic soft smiles and she moves in to kiss Catra again.

"I love you too."Adora whispers against Catra' s lips before she closes the space between their lips again. Catra melts into it, feeling her heart ache in her chest. She loves Adora *so much*. Catra doesnt

think she could ever go back to a time when she didn't know her. She wants to be with her *forever*. It's kind of scary, to think you've found your soulmate, and the person you want to spend the rest of your life with, at twenty-one, but Catra is confident that she has.

The rest of the evening they eat an obscene amount of pizza, put on some chick-flick movie and enjoy each other's company. Adora falls asleep at some point, against Catra, as Glimmer does snuggled up to Bow. "Goodnight, Catra." Bow says as he stands from the couch. He leans down to lift Glimmer up and carry her off to bed.

"Goodnight, Bow." Catra replies softly. She watches as he disappears into their shared bedroom and then she looks at Adora. Catra doesn't think she could lift Adora if she's honest, sure Catra is pretty strong, but Adora is six feet tall and pretty much *all* muscle. She doesn't want to risk it. At least Adora seems to be relaxed now, she deserved it, tomorrow Catra would help her write her paper if she needed it.

Catra wakes Adora up by gently shaking her. She blinks a few times before she smiles happily and stretches. Catra winces a little when she hears some of her bones crack but Adora only lets out a satisfied moan. "*Sex*?" She asks. Catra stares at her before she bursts out into laughter.

"*Seriously*?" Catra asks, raising an eyebrow. "*You still want to do that*."

“ *Always* .”Adora signs back and Catra blushes. “ *You said I could use the strap. Please? I want to make you feel good* .”Catra feels herself blush harder and then she lifts her hands up to cup Adora’s face before she smirks.

“ *Such a good Princess* ,”Catra signs and Adora’ s eyes widen. “ *Take me to bed then* .”Adora grins and then scoops Catra up from the couch. Catra was definitely going to have to apologise to Glimmer and Bow in the morning, because there was *no way* this was about to be quiet.

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Catra rolls her eyes at her girlfriend and pats her on her butt as they enter the BMU state of the art gym. The athletes got a free pass, which had Adora in luck, other students had to pay a membership - at least it was usually lower than the normal gym membership. Every now and then Adora was allowed to bring a guest, but Catra had her own membership anyway. Catra has no idea why it had taken them so long to actually do this together, but they're here now - and she gets to enjoy the view of Adora in tight sporting clothes, her favourite sight to exist. She was wearing black compression shorts with white shorts over the top and a white tank as well. She had her soccer hoodie but it was thrown over her gym bag since it was pretty warm out.

As they approach the front desk, the receptionist seems to light up. “Adora! Hi!”She greets happily . Catra raises an eyebrow a little. She knows Adora comes here pretty regularly when she doesn't have soccer training, even her degree kind of requires her to be here

somewhat, but that seemed overly friendly to Catra. Adora waves politely in greeting and smiles. It's Catra's suspicion that the receptionist knows Adora is Deaf but that she doesn't know sign language.

The receptionist smiles and then she seems to notice Catra for the first time. "Oh. And this is your friend?" She asks. Catra glances at Adora. Adora is pretty good at reading lips, or at reading situations, so she's pretty sure she has a general idea of what the receptionist, Rebecca, Catra gets from her name tag, is saying.

"Catra." Adora answers. She seems quieter than usual. Catra knows it makes her slightly uncomfortable having to speak verbally to people she isn't close to. Adora goes to speak again but Catra lays her hand on her bicep - Rebecca's eyes zero in on that.

"I have a membership," Catra says, slapping her card down on the desk. "And she's my *girlfriend*." Maybe it's a little petty and possessive, but Catra wants to make sure that Rebecca knows the true nature of their relationship. She picks Catra's card up, examining it before she hands it back.

"Enjoy your session." She says, a little tightly, but Catra won't blame her for it.

Catra nods and then drags Adora further inside so they can start their workout. Once they're far enough away, Catra starts signing to

her. “ *She was totally flirting with you, you know that, right?* ”Catra asks. Adora’s eyes widen a little before she shakes her head.

“ *No, she was just being friendly* .”Adora protests. What a cute oblivious puppy Adora is.

“ *She wanted you to take her on the desk, Adora* .”Okay , maybe Catra is being a *little* dramatic, but Rebecca clearly had a huge crush on Adora all the same. Adora flushes red and Catra laughs a little. She leans up and kisses Adora’s cheek. “ *It’s okay, I told her I was your girlfriend* .”Adora raises her eyebrows, her shocked expression suddenly becoming a smug one - somewhat like her saying ‘oh yeah?’ it makes Catra blush. “ *Come on, I’m going to kick your butt* .”

It wouldn’t be them if they didn’t have some friendly competition. They start out with cardio because Adora insists it’ s the best way to warm up after they’ve done their appropriate stretching. Catra ribs her about being a goalie and not exactly having to run a lot and Adora rolls her eyes. Sure enough though, Catra beats Adora. She always has been *fast.* She used to run track in high school as well as gymnastics. Still, Adora gives her a good run for her money, both of them increasing their incline and speed setting in response, grinning at each other. Only when Adora nearly trips over her own feet does she concede and let’ Catra win, turning her speed down.

Catra takes a water break, sipping her water as she watches Adora for a moment. The blonde was currently strapping up her fists with tape so she could have a go at the punching bag. Catra wasn’t really a big fan of punching things when working out, so she’s content just

to watch Adora. *God,* Catra has the hottest girlfriend in existence, she swears. Adora lifts her hands up and Catra's eyes are fixed on her. She's shamelessly ogling her, but it's only her right, right? Adora *is* her girlfriend. Catra gets to thirst after her whenever and however she pleases.

Adora lifts her hands and then she starts hitting. Catra watches closely, she's completely forgotten about her water bottle despite the fact that her mouth suddenly feels very *dry* . Adora's muscles are *impressive* , they ripple as she hits the bag, hitting it with a lot of force. Catra knows Adora wants to help people for a living, but if she wanted to give all of that up to punch people in the face for a living, Catra would support her. She's a simple lesbian, what can she say? Catra understands now why her teammates call her She-Ra.

Adora is working up a sweat and Catra is feeling something else entirely building within herself. Adora stops, which is probably good for Catra, and then she lifts the hem of her shirt up to her forehead to wipe away her sweat. *Shit* . Catra was wrong. It exposes her abs and Catra's eyes are transfixed on the way her muscles seem to flex. Catra is like, so gay. She feels like she was the one to do the workout, not Adora.

Adora jogs back over to Catra, loosening the white wrap she had put around her fists to protect them. As soon as Adora is close enough, Catra grabs the front of her tank top and drags her in for a passionate kiss. The kiss quickly turns heated, Catra feels *desperate* . Honestly, if the gym locker rooms were a little more private, she may have even dragged Adora off for a 'private session'. Not to worry, they'd have one of those back at Catra's apartment once they had wrapped up here.

Catra releases Adora from her grip and Adora pulls away, a dreamy look on her face. Her eyelids slowly flutter open and Catra resists the urge to laugh at her girlfriend. She likes seeing the effect she has on Adora. Sure, Catra knows how she feels about her, but it's different when she sees the physical manifestation of it on her stupidly attractive face. " *What was that for?*" Adora questions once she's conscious enough to do so.

" *You looked stupid so I wanted to kiss you* ." Catra signs, giving Adora a playful grin so she knew she was joking. Adora rolls her eyes at her. Adora is ridiculously hot - like, *ridiculously* . She got lucky in the looks and body department. Catra is attracted to her in every sense of the word. She loves the way her blue eyes reflect in the sun, she loves her soft features, the way her mouth tilts up lopsided in a cute and endearing way, she loves her smug smirks, the way her eyebrow cocks too, she even loves that stupid hair poof she has. Adora is perfect to Catra. Every inch of her. She is unbelievably pretty, Catra doesn't know how she got so lucky .

" *Come on* ," Adora signs as she discards her wraps. " *My turn to kick your butt* ."

" *In your dreams* ." Catra signs back.

Their next stop is at the weightlifting station. They agree they'll spot each other and they'll do a set of fifteen reps, just so they can increase the weight until one of them taps out. Catra makes a joke that it's similar to lesbian sex;as in, it can go on forever and ever

until a person has to tap out to stop it. Adora had only rolled her eyes at her but also Catra definitely heard her laugh under her breath too. Catra wasnt wrong.

Catra already knows she probably isnt going to win this one. Sure, she's strong, her looks are pretty deceiving in that regard, Catra has muscles but Adora is built for raw power. She has obvious beef, she's sculpted herself to be that way and Catra knows she's very serious about it. f Catra wins, she would be surprised. Tat doesnt mean Catra is jst going to take it easy on Adora.

Catra manages to hold her own surprisingly well, even Adora seems impressed by Catra's surprised show of strength. Catra has the strength of a gymnast, carefully trained muscles that can appear unassuming but shouldnt be underestimated. Adora' s muscles are much more bulky. Catra admits that she gets somewhat distracted spotting her as her eyes draw to Adora's biceps. Tis feels like the longest foreplay Catra has ever had. t' s really unfair seeing Adora's bulking biceps, her *abs* , jst *her* , all sweaty and grunting and showing off. t' s really working for her. Catra might need to jmp her bones in the locker room after all.

Adora wins, but only jst. Catra fumbles a little on her last rep in her set and has to be bailed out by Adora catching the bar and lifting it back to the safe position. t stings only a little because Adora kisses her. Catra will give her that one, but next time, she's going *down* .

Once theyre done with the weights, Catra trails over to the gymnast rings that were in there. She meant it when she said that the BMU gym was state of the art, they were eqipped for any and all sports.

She decides she wants to have a go and she smiles smugly when she catches Adora staring at her the entire time. Oh yeah, so Catra is attracted to Adora's show of strength and Adora is attracted to Catra's gymnast ability, go figure.

t takes a lot of strength and control to do the rings but Adora seems to think she can do it just because she' s *strong* . Catra gestures to them, giving Adora a knowing look. There is no way she' s going to be good at this.

Adora manages to hoist herself up into a sitting position, her feet extended out in front of her, but it clearly takes a significant amount of effort for her. Her arms shake with the effort and then she finally concedes and drops to the ground. " *How did you do that* ?" She signs and Catra laughs, shaking her head.

" *With a lot of practice* ."Sure, Adora has the strength, but she doesnt have the skills or training to know how to do moves on the rings.

After that, they get cleaned up, since they were kind of sweaty from their work out, and agree to go get some smoothies from the smoothie bar on their way out. Catra gets a berry blast' smoothie and Adora gets some green coloured one that looks absolutely disgusting if you ask Catra. They exit the gym holding hands, sipping their smoothies and feeling satisfied with their workout. Catra feels a pleasant burn in her muscles, it's been too long since she had a good workout like that and she had forgotten how good it felt after one.

Once they finish their smoothies they dispose of them in a nearby trash can. They were heading back to Catra's place just to hang out but Catra was enjoying this walk. It was warm, thankfully, the temperature hadn't quite reached that phase where it was *uncomfortably* warm. It also wasn't too humid today and there was a very slight breeze that was nice and cooling in the heat. Adora lets go of Catra's hand so she can sign to her. "*That was a good workout, we should do that more often*."Catra has to agree with that and so she nods at the blonde.

"*We can finish our cardio at my place*."Catra responds with a wink. Adora flushes pink at that but she doesn't protest. Catra grins a little. She wasn't wrong, sex is great cardio, but Adora wasn't wrong about it being a good workout too.

Catra pauses in her steps for a moment and Adora pauses after a couple when she realises Catra is no longer beside her. "Hey"… Catra trails off, unsure if she should even bring this up. "*Do you… We've never really had the exes talk*."Catra signs. Adora tilts her head to the side a little. She seems confused, but Catra can't really blame her. Catra shrugs a little. "*Just wondering if there's anyone I should be aware of*."Adora smiles a little and then shakes her head.

"*Not really*,"She signs. "*I've had a few hookups,*"Catra recalls Mermista, Adora's teammate, that Glimmer had told her about. "*But nothing substantial. Not until you*."Catra feels a warmth in her chest at that. "*You?*"

“ *Did I ever tell you I dated Scorpia ?*” Catra asks. Adora’ s eyes widen a little. Catra honestly cant recall if she ever told Adora that she had dated her roommate. “ *We decided we were better as friends. It felt strange doing relationship stuff with her, you know ?*” Catra loves Scorpia dearly, but not in that way. She had felt awkward and kind of bad kissing her, like she was leading her on despite them technically being together anyway. t took her a little while, but Catra figured out that she didnt exactly have romantic feelings for Scorpia. She was her best friend and that was all. t had been a little awkward after but theyd survived it. “ *Mex before her was an asshole* .” Catra signs. Double Trouble. Not seeing them again until she died would be too soon.

“ *They hurt you ?*” Adora asks. Catra slowly shakes her head. Not exactly, anyway. Their relationship had been more of friends with benefits but Catra started to develop certain feelings towards DT, an attachment, and DT couldnt have cared less about her .

“ *Maybe emotionally , break ups, you know ?*” Catra signs. They start walking again.

“ *I’ve only had a couple girlfriends but those were in high school and they rarely worked out* .” Adora informs her . “ *I have a language barrier with most people and even if I find someone who does know sign language doesn’t mean they’ll like me, or I’ll like them. Guess I struck gold with you* .” Catra smiles and laughs softly a little at Adora’s comment at the end there. Thank god for her moms insistence she learn sign language.

“ *Sex I can usually communicate with a person enough to get and give consent, if I can’t then I won’t. Imrista knows a little sign language, she’s picked it up over the years, but she isn’t all knowing like you, or Bow, or Glimmer. Usually when I’m in groups of friends I’m reliant on Bow and Glimmer to translate for me so I know what’s going on, I also try to lip read, otherwise, I’m just… excluded from the conversation since I can’t hear it* .”Adora explains. Catra’ s heart clenches a little at the thought of Adora being excluded from conversations simply because she cant hear and no one bothers to translate it for her. “ *That’s why I was so happy when you started translating what Scorpia was saying that one time, because you* ***included*** *me and it wasn’t even a second thought to you, you just did it. I think I fell in love with you then and there* .”Catra snorts a little at that and bumps her shoulder against Adora’s. She sits with that for a moment before she signs back to Adora.

“ *Well, with me, you don’t have to worry about being excluded. I’ll always translate for you* .”Catra promises. “ *Although, the only situation I may have an issue with is if my mom is speaking Spanish to me. Only because I’d have to translate from Spanish, to English, to sign language, and that might hurt my head in the moment, but I’ll sign to you after* .”Adora snorts a little.

“ *Deal.* ”She signs back. Catra smiles happily and wraps her arms around Adora’s arm, holding her close. Adora holds her hand up and signs a gentle ‘ *I love you* ’, Catra signs it back to her . So Catra was the only substantial girlfriend to Adora. Something about that warmed Catra’s heart. Now, they could enjoy one another's company back at Catra’s and she could get lots of snuggles in. She wasnt letting Adora go any time soon.

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"Catra?" Catra looks up from her phone to see Glimmer staring at her with great confusion.

"Why is Adora texting me gibberish?" Catra asks. She hadn't heard from Adora for hours, which had worried her. They went periods where they weren't together and didn't talk, when they were busy studying, or doing other things, but never as long as it had been currently. Plus, Adora was sending her confusing texts when she finally had texted Catra back, none of it made any kind of sense. Glimmer looks over her shoulder.

"Bow! Where's Adora?" Glimmer yells and Catra winces a little at the volume.

"Oh! Last I saw her , she was in her room." Bow says from inside.

"That doesn't explain why she's texting me gibberish." Catra says, walking forward and brushing past Glimmer. Bow waves happily from the couch where he was sitting with books around him. He was in his usual crop top with tight booty shorts, Catra's kind of gotten used to it by now.

"Hey Catra!" He greets happily . "Did Adora call you?" Bow asks. "I'm surprised Adora was lucid enough to do that."

"Lucid"? Catra asks with a frown. "What does that mean"? Catra carries on towards Adora's room and pauses when her hand lands on the handle only because Glimmer calls from behind her.

"Are you really just going to walk in? What if you see something"? Glimmer asks.

"Sparkles, I've seen Adora naked. The only way I'll see something I don't like is if Adora has another woman in here." Glimmer blushes at Catra's words, which amuses Catra somewhat, before Catra finally opens the door to Adora's room.

The first thing that greets her is Adora face down on her bed in only a sports bra and boxer shorts. The curtains in her room are drawn but they still have some of the summer sun shining through them. Catra stares in mild concern for a long moment, thinking maybe Adora was dead, before the blonde slowly raises her head. At least she's not dead, but what the hell was up with her?

Catra walks into the room and taps Adora's calf with her hand. The blonde jumps, clearly surprised by Catra' s presence. When she sits up she looks... paler than usual, and covered in a sheen of sweat. She moves to the end of her bed, where Catra had sat down, and sits there. " *Hi* ." She signs. Catra knows it's only one word, but Adora's sign seems sluggish, which is unusual given that she signs almost every day of her life - her signs are usually flawless from years of speaking that way.

Catra presses her hand to Adora’s forehead and her eyes widen at the heat she feels. She pulls her hand away to sign to her. " *Are you sick* ?Catra asks. Adora shakes her head as she attempts to hug Catra by her waist.

"Sick? Nooo."Speaking only gives Adora away further . She *sounds* sick, her temperature basically confirms it and the fact that Adora is usually always moving, or doing something, fidgeting, but had been passed out cold when Catra got here, and moving sluggishly;Catra is not an idiot, Adora *is* sick.

" *One moment* ,"Catra signs before she gently pushes Adora back in her bed. She turns and exits into the living room to see Glimmer and Bow both on the couch now. "Is Adora sick?"Catra asks.

"Oh yeah."Glimmer says.

"Definitely ."Bow adds.

"Why is no one looking after her?"Catra asks.

"Are you kidding? Adora will never admit she's sick and, even if she did, she wouldn't let anyone take care of her."Glimmer says, shrugging. "Bow made her some lemon tea before. She tried to deny she was sick, and that she wouldn't drink it out of principle. We all know she's sick, but she refuses to admit it. Plus, we both have big

tests coming up, so we can't get sick."Catra pinches the bridge of her nose. Of course Adora can't admit she's sick, of course.

"And Ihave a mock trial coming up,"Catra says, dropping her fingers. "But... Bow , can you make that tea again?"Bow stands up immediately.

"Of course."He says. He' s always so dependable.

"Y ou really think you can get Adora to drink that?"Glimmer asks, raising an eyebrow.

"I have my ways,"Catra says with a wink. "Has she eaten today?" Bow and Glimmer shake their heads.

"I'll make her some soup later , Ithink the tea will be a good starting place."Catra says thoughtfully . Bow slips by her to go to the kitchen to make that tea.

"Good luck,"Glimmer says with a wry grin. "Adora may not be a doctor yet, but the 'doctors make the worst patients' saying is still true for her. Ithink it' s because when she was in that orphanage… Well, you probably get the picture. She had to take care of herself most of the time, Idoubt her so-called caretaker gave a damn and would maybe even punish her for getting sick."Catra shudders a little at that thought. Glimmer is probably right, but that's an uncomfortable thought.

Bow returns with the tea and hands it to Catra who takes it with a grateful smile. "Thank you, Bow. You're a good friend." She says to him. For a moment, his eyes get all sparkly, and he looks like he might just cry, but he quickly gets a handle on it.

"I have something for you," He says happily. He disappears for a quick second into his and Glimmer's room and then reemerges holding what looks like a bracelet in his hand. He gestures for Catra to extend her hand and then slips the bracelet on. It's that friendship bracelet he mentioned, with a little cat charm attached to it. Catra stares for a long moment at it. This feels...official. Catra is officially a part of their friendship group. "I have one," He says with a big smile, lifting his hand to present his golden bracelet with a little heart charm on it. "Glimmer has one," He points at his girlfriend and Glimmer holds her wrist up to show a pink and purple bracelet with a sparkle charm on it - and yes, Catra finds that ironic considering she calls her Sparkles. "Adora also has one, you should see when you go in." Honestly, Catra doesn't know how she missed it when she signed to her, but she'd been pretty distracted by Adora being sick.

"Thanks Bow," Catra says, and she means it genuinely. She smiles softly at him and then lifts the tea up. "I better go look after this big blonde idiot. Will you listen out for Scorpia? I'm going to ask her to bring my stuff over so I can work and keep an eye on Adora."

"Sure thing," He says, returning back to the couch. Catra lingers for a moment to see Bow kiss Glimmer softly on her lips and for Glimmer to giggle when her sparkly chapstick transfers to his lips. Catra smiles softly at the scene. "They're pretty cute together, and they

clearly love each other. Falling in love with your best friend is the best thing in the world.

Catra enters Adora's room with the lemon tea to see the blonde was currently half asleep, lying on her back, propped up by her pillows. Catra sets the tea down on the bedside table and then sits Adora up, adjusting her pillows so she could lie more comfortably. Adora doesn't talk, and she seems too tired to sign, so Catra just holds the tea up and glares menacingly at Adora. The message is pretty clear and the blonde reluctantly takes the cup from Catra. She lets out a soft sigh when she begins sipping on it so Catra's pretty confident she made the right choice.

Catra starts cleaning up a little and then she cracks a window just to let some air flow through the room. Once Adora is finished drinking the tea she sets it to one side again. Catra sits down beside her on the bed. Adora begins to sign but she moves much slower than usual. That's when Catra notices the gold and white bracelet on her wrist with a unicorn charm - perfect for Adora. " *I don't want you to get sick* ."Adora signs and Catra shakes her head.

" *Forget it, I'm going to look after you* ."Catra signs back. Adora frowns, and lifts her hands as though she were going to protest but Catra quickly catches her wrists, giving Adora a look. Adora holds her gaze for a long moment, they have a mini staring competition before Adora looks away. Catra wins. " *How do you feel* ?"Catra asks.

" *Headache* ,"Adora signs. " *Feel shitty* ."

“ *You have a fever* ,”Catra signs as she stands. Lots of fluids would help, and she hoped that they had some cold and flu medicine in the bathroom. She exits Adora’s room, grabbing a glass from the kitchen and filling it with water. She crosses back to the bathroom and grabs the medicine before she returns back to Adora. She hands her the medicine, which Adora pouts at, and then the water and watches as Adora takes both.

Finally, Catra settles down beside Adora. Maybe she should keep her distance, but she wants to provide Adora with as much comfort as possible. Adora seems hesitant herself, but she doesnt protest for too long before she’s pulling Catra close against her. t doesnt take very long for Adora to pass out again. She sleeps so chaotically, drooling in her sleep and snoring softly, but she’s warm and comfortable, it’s endearing in a way, and Catra too drifts off to sleep too.

Catra is woken up when Bow enters to drop her bag of books inside. Catra stands after that and gets to work, commandeering Adora’s desk to lay out all her papers and books and her own laptop as she gets to work preparing for her mock trial in class. t was a graded piece of work too, and Catra needed it to go well. t wasnt jst about the grade, it was also about beating her classmate, it was proving that she was worthy of her degree and becoming a lawyer. She’d decided to team up with Lonnie, and so Lonnie was her second chair. Unfortunately, that means she has to video chat with her so they can discuss it.

s that your girlfriend half naked behind you?Lonnie asks. Catra turns to look behind her. Yeah, technically, that is ture. Adora is jst

in her sports bra and boxers, and she'd taken her blanket of f at some point in her sleep. "Seriously , Catra?"

"Shut up," Catra says, turning back to Lonnie. "She' s sick, Im taking care of her."

"I bet you are."

"Not like that!" Catra yells, blushing.

"Should we be talking here then? W ont we wake her?"

"Unlikely ," Catra says. "She' s Deaf, Lonnie, didnt Itell you that?" Lonnie makes an 'oh' face at that before she nods. They go back to their planning and with those set in place, Catra hangs up and begins working independently on her side of the research. When Adora wakes up, she smiles at Catra. She gets up briefly to go to the bathroom and kisses Catra before she comes back and collapses back in her bed.

t takes a few days for Adora to fully recover . Catra makes her plenty of soup, Bow supplies the tea and Catra makes sure Adora rests and drinks plenty of fluids - she also has to email Adora's professors when the blonde insists she can go to class when she really shouldnt. Catra starts to feel a little sick herself but she manages to power through it to pull off her mock trial.

After, she comes back to Adora's apartment and flops face first into bed beside her girlfriend. She feels Adora pull her into her arms and kiss her gently on her temple. "How'd it go?" Adora asks verbally. Catra sighs, turning in Adora's arms.

"*Good*," She signs. "*Kicked ass*." Adora grins.

"That's my girl." She says proudly. Catra blushes at that. "I made you sick." Adora looks, and *sounds*, guilty when she says that. Catra shakes her head and lifts her hands up to cup Adora's beautiful face in her hands.

"Worth it," Catra says, pulling Adora down for a kiss. She doesn't know if Adora got what it was that she just said but the fact that she relaxes and kisses her back makes Catra think that she probably did. It's the weekend after tomorrow anyway, Catra is fine staying with Adora and just cuddling her girlfriend.

"I'll take care of you." Adora whispers. Catra really didn't think being sick could be so romantic but this is strangely romantic. So long as Adora was feeling better, Catra was happy. She could stick this out if she had the comfort of her girlfriend. Not for the first time does Catra think about the fact that she would happily spend the rest of her life doing this with Adora.

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Catra's keys jingle a little as she unlocks the door to her shared apartment with Scorpia. The end of term was quickly approaching and so was the time for them to renew their lease. Catra needed to talk to Scorpia about the whole living situation as soon as possible if she wanted to make the cut off for the lease application.

She pauses when she hears what sounds like grunting echoing from the living room and then covers her eyes as she loudly closes the door and walks inside. "Please tell me you are not having sex in our living room." Catra says, still shielding her eyes. She doesn't know what Scorpia and Perfuma do in the bedroom and she would rather not find out.

"Oh, Wildcat," Scorpia says. "You're home!" Cheerful as ever. Catra is pretty sure they're *not* having sex by that response alone and so she removes her hand from her eyes. What she sees instead is much worse if you ask her. Scorpia and Perfuma are doing *yoga* and Scorpia is in some leotard, as is Perfuma.

"So no sex but foreplay?" Catra asks with a teasing grin. Perfuma is blushing so red she almost matches the colour of Scorpia's prosthetic. Catra decides to ignore them for the time being and disappears into the kitchen to grab a bottle of water. She returns back to the breakfast bar that separated the living room from the kitchen.

"You should join us," Perfuma says as she sits on her mat cross-legged. "It might help you clear your mind and relieve some tension."

"I prefer to relieve tension in another way," Catra says, sipping her water. "Mainly with the help of Adora." Perfuma squeaks a little at that. Is Catra being kind of crude? Maybe, but seeing Perfuma flustered is pretty entertaining to her. Perfuma stands from her mat.

"Anyway," She says. "We're done for today. I'm going to clean up, my love." Perfuma kisses Scorpia softly on her lips and Catra watches the exchange, she watches as Perfuma rolls up her mat, attaches it to her bag and then disappears into the bathroom.

Scorpia looks back to Catra and then stands, rolling her own mat up. "Is everything okay?" Scorpia asks as she drifts towards the kitchen counter. Catra offers her her bottle of water silently and Scorpia smiles softly at the gesture, accepting it and then downing nearly half of it. Over the years, Catra has kind of gotten used to living with Scorpia. She hates to be vulnerable, and she'd rather die than admit it, but she is going to miss this hunk of muscle if they do decide to separate and move in with their respective partners. Catra has somehow become someone different because of Scorpia. Scorpia, in many ways, has been like a rock to her. She's Catra's *best friend*.

"Yeah," Catra says quietly. Scorpia gives her a look and Catra sighs. Scorpia knows her too well. They've known each other for years now, Scorpia has always been somewhat tuned in to Catra's emotions. "I mean, our lease is coming up." Catra brings up. It's a topic she doesn't know how to really breach but there it is, out in the open. Scorpia nods.

"I know," She says. "We can talk to our landlord and renew it if you like?" Scorpia asks happily. She's always so positive. Sometimes that used to annoy Catra. Scorpia is definitely a the glass if half-full' kind of person, Catra, on the other hand, can be somewhat of a pessimist. It's what makes them work in some ways, they balance each other out. Adora is similar in that way, except she's pretty much always a pessimist towards herself, stressing over work and being a failure and putting entirely too much pressure on herself while she is always the optimist to her friends and Catra.

"I was actually thinking." Catra trails off. She doesn't want to hurt Scorpia's feelings but she doesn't think this will hurt her, right? This is just a normal question that people ask. "You spend a lot of time over Perfuma's, and I was just thinking that maybe... you'd want to live with her next year?" Catra says, finally managing to spit it out.

For a little while, Scorpia doesn't say anything. Catra feels tense, she doesn't want to upset Scorpia, not even a little bit, and her usual easily readable face is hard for Catra to figure out. She really hopes she didn't just burn down the one friendship she's had for years and somehow managed to cling onto, despite their ups and downs and the fact that their friendship even survived a breakup.

"I don't want you to be alone, Wildcat." Scorpia says after a moment. Catra looks up in surprise at that. That was the last thing she was expecting to hear. She stares at Scorpia before she lets out a soft laugh. Of course that's what Scorpia is worried about. Like Catra said before, Scorpia is her rock, someone who has stuck with her, no matter what. She's loyal, and kind, and Catra is lucky to have her as a friend.

"I was going to ask Adora if maybe she'd want to live with me," Catra finally admits, reassuring her friend that if she wanted to live with her girlfriend then she should - Catra didn't want a pity stay anyway. Even if Adora did say no, Scorpia clearly wants to live with Perfuma, Catra wouldn't want her to stay just because she was worried about Catra being alone. "You should move in with Perfuma, really." Scorpia stares at her for a moment before she seems to find whatever it is she's looking for. She practically lights up like a Christmas tree and she steps around the counter to pick Catra up off of the ground in a bone-crushing hug. Catra complains the entire time but, really, Scorpia gives great hugs.

"I'm going to miss you, Wildcat." Scorpia practically sobs. Catra sighs as she pats Scorpia's bicep, still trapped in a hug with the strong woman.

"I'm not going anywhere," Catra says, laughing. In a way, she gets what Scorpia is saying. They've lived together since starting college, it's going to be strange for Catra to be apart from her. She'd gotten used to her footsteps in the morning, to waking up to the smell of bacon and eggs, to the tea that Scorpia sometimes made when Catra was having a hard time. You live with someone, you get to know them in a way that you just don't with regular friends. Scorpia is one of Catra's closest friends for that reason. She has seen Catra stressed, she's seen her mean because of said stress, she's seen Catra be messy, and *human,* and Catra has seen all that of Scorpia too. They've also had the privilege of getting to see each other find and fall in love and Catra had no doubt that they'd be lifelong friends.

"I'll still miss you," Scorpia says mournfully. Catra relaxes a little and allows herself to hug Scorpia back.

"Yeah." Catra whispers. "I'm going to miss you too, big gal." They stand hugging each other in their shared kitchen for a while before Scorpia reluctantly puts her back down on the ground. Catra is glad she's no longer being suffocated, but she also feels strangely sad about this whole thing. Scorpia wipes her face with her arm.

"You're the best roommate I've ever had," Catra is pretty sure she's the *only* roommate Scorpia has ever had, but she'll take it. Catra chuckles and pats Scorpia's arm comfortingly. "You're the best friend I've ever had." *Dammit*. Catra really doesn't want to cry, but Scorpia saying that really hits her square in the chest.

"We're always going to be best friends." Catra reassures.

"You promise?"

"I promise," Catra responds. "And you know I always keep my promises." It's one of the things Catra prides herself on. She's pretty loyal when it comes to friends and other relationships. Sure, sometimes she comes off a little mean and standoff-ish but once you get past that, once you're her *friend*, Catra would do anything for her friends. She plays with the red and black friendship bracelet on her wrist. Maybe she's getting better at making friends, maybe Adora has taught her how to open her heart more.

"I'll ask Perfuma." Scorpia says happily. Catra watches her practically hop over to the bathroom and enter after knocking and

announcing it was her. Catra laughs before she pulls out her phone. She needs to ask Adora soon, which means setting up some time she and Adora can be together. *Shit* , maybe she should have asked Adora first, because if she says no then Catra's going to have to find a new apartment. She wont be able to af ford a two bedroom apartment on her own. Well, there's no reward without a little risk. Catra would ask her soon.

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Adora enters Catra's apartment after knocking on her door to announce her presence. As far as she knew, this was just a casual hang out. They were getting closer and closer to the end of summer term and things were getting hectic to say the least. They hadnt really been able to spend all that much time together, swamped by homework and preparing for exams that were fast approaching, but they'd managed to carve out this day to spend time together .

When Adora enters, she doesnt immediately see Catra. She assumes she's either in her room, or the kitchen. "Catra," Adora calls, sitting down on the couch. "I'm here." She sits there for a little while before Catra emerges from the kitchen holding a bowl of popcorn. She smiles nervously before she sits down beside Adora. Adora offers her the remote but Catra shakes her head, declining so Adora can choose a movie.

Adora feels a little on edge if she' s honest. Catra is acting off, and, maybe Adora has only been here for a few minutes, but she knows when Catra is acting normal and when she's acting *off* . Adora flicks through different movies before she chooses just a random one,

wanting just something to focus on other than her racing thoughts. After a moment, Catra reaches over and takes the remote. Adora wonders if she's going to pause the TV but she doesnt. She turns the subtitles on. Adora almost laughs, in her hurry to pick something and try to distract herself, she hadn't even put the subtitles on.

This is weird. Adora feels like she's being weird, but she has anxiety and this is kind of stressing her out. She doesnt know what to do, she's just *waiting*. Catra definitely picks up on Adora's nervous energy, or maybe she just notices Adora's leg bobbing up and down, but Catra leans forward, placing the popcorn down on the coffee table. She turns to Adora and Adora quickly looks at her, searching her face. Adora sometimes expects the worst, and she's wondering if she did something wrong, if Catra is maybe breaking up with her. Instead, Catra stares her in the eyes. And then, they're making out.

Adora isnt sure who makes the first move, but she's pretty sure that it's Catra. She drags her in and kisses her hotly. Adora is a little confused, but she isnt going to protest kissing Catra. Catra presses against her and moves closer, almost sitting in Adora's lap as she leads the kiss. Adora loves the way Catra tastes, she also loves the way she smells. She almost always smells vaguely of coffee and she tastes sweet. It's an intoxicating mixture and Adora just cant get enough of it. The kiss is somewhat intense. This is familiar at least, they usually do make-out while watching movies instead of, you know, *watching movies*, but Adora cant help but feel like Catra is avoiding whatever it is that she actually wants to say by sticking her tongue in Adora's mouth.

Eventually, Adora finds the strength to gently push Catra back so she can ask her what's really wrong. "*Are you okay?*" Adora signs. She's slightly alarmed if she's honest. Catra seems nervous, it's the

same kind of nervous energy she was giving off before she told Adora that she loved her. Catra pauses for a moment before she nods. She lifts her fingers up and touches them to her lips before she puts her hand back down. She looks ruffled and a little breathless.

" *Okay* ," Catra signs back. Adora gives her a look, because she doesn't exactly believe that. Catra purses her lips before she lifts her hands back up again. " *I wanted to ask you something* ." She signs. Adora raises an eyebrow. She doesn't know what the question is, but she's nervous because Catra is nervous. Catra is *never* nervous, not without reason anyway. Adora gestures for her to carry on. " *I was wondering… I was thinking… I…"* Catra stops and starts her signs before she finally seems to settle on what exactly it was that she wanted to say. " *I know you live with Glimmer and Bow, and I know you love them, they're your best friends, but Scorpia and I were talking. We have to renew our lease before the term is up if we still want to stay here, and I told her she could stay with Perfuma if she wanted* ." Catra signs and Adora nods, paying close attention to all of Catra's signs, including the names she signs. " *I was wondering if maybe you'd want to live with… me* ?" Adora's eyes widen and her eyebrows raise. She hadn't exactly been expecting *that* .

Adora looks from Catra's hands to her face. She definitely looks nervous still, but maybe not as much, it's probably a relief for her to get it off of her chest. If Adora was being honest, she had been thinking about that exact same thing herself. She loves living with Glimmer and Bow, she really does, but ever since they became a couple, she has walked in on far too many awkward moments for her to really articulate and it might be nice for them to have space as a couple, as it would be nice for Adora and Catra to have a space to be a couple too. Adora would be nervous about potentially breaking up with Catra. They've been together for several months, nearly a year when Adora really thinks about it, but Adora isn't really all that

concerned about the possibility of them breaking up. She wants to be with Catra for as long as shell have her .

Adora shuffles closer and takes Catra's hands, she smiles softly at her. "I would like...nothing more." Adora says. Catra stares at her in complete shock, like she hadn't expected Adora to actually say yes. It makes Adora laugh. " *I've been thinking about it too* ," Adora admits, going back to signing. " *It would be really nice to come home to you every day* ." And it really would. Adora could think of nothing better. In fact, she' s kind of loving the idea of getting to live with Catra. She gets to be with her as much as she pleases.

Catra says something that looks a lot like 'oh thank god' to Adora and Adora snorts at her. Catra lifts her hands up to Adora's face. Adora gazes down at her . Sometimes she gets caught off guard by just how attractive Catra is. Adora can barely understand how it is that she even got Catra. She is the luckiest person in the entire universe, because Catra is. She is *everything* . Adora loves every single thing about her, from the way her eyes light up when she starts signing about law, the way she wants to use the law to *help* people, the way her beautiful mind works, she's so incredibly smart, Adora is amazed by her in every way . Catra is confident and, though she sometimes gives people grief, deep down she is nothing but loving. She has a big heart, probably the biggest of anyone Adora has ever met, she has so much love to give and Adora is honoured that Catra has chosen Adora as one of those people to share her love with. Catra can be guarded, but once those defences are down, she is a big pile of mushy goop. Kissing Catra feels like coming home, and now Adora is actually going to get to come home to her - hopefully for the rest of her life.

Adora leans down and kisses Catra. This kiss is a lot less messy , a lot less desperate, but no less intense. This isn't a kiss meant to distract, but a kiss that bares their souls to each other. Adora remembers walking into that coffee shop, she remembers the disappointment of being unable to sign with Kyle and then she remembers Catra. Her saving grace. In a lot of ways, Catra has breathed a new life into Adora. She never felt hopeless before, but maybe Adora had surrendered herself to the motions, stopped trying, not knowing how to communicate with people outside of her little bubble, and then along came Catra. Adora had stopped living until she saw her again. She woke her up.

All of these feelings fill Adora's chest to an almost breaking point. She loves Catra so much it's threatening to burst out of her chest. She decides to channel them into the kiss instead. She gently lowers Catra down onto her back on the couch, hovering above her to kiss her passionately, letting her love for her flow out. Adora pulls back. " *Is… Will it only be us* ?"Adora signs. She wants to know if Scorpia will be back at any point. Catra nods, reaching her arms up to wrap them around Adora's neck.

"Just us."Adora doesn't hear but her eyes haven't left Catra' s lips since she stopped kissing her. Adora leans back in to kiss Catra, her hands travelling to her hips. Suddenly, Catra sits up, interrupting Adora. " *We should lock the door just in case* ."Catra signs before she wiggles out from under Adora. Adora blinks and then follows after Catra as she locks the front door.

Catra turns at the exact same time that Adora reaches her, pinning Catra to the door. Catra smirks at her. " *Imagine this when it's just you and I and we don't have to lock any doors* ,"Adora signs. " *I could take you in the kitchen if I wanted* ."Catra bites her lip and

then wraps her arms around Adora's neck, using Adora to ground her and hoist herself up to wrap her legs around Adora. Catra leans back against the door to sign to her.

" *I mean, it's basically our kitchen already, right?* "Catra asks. Adora raises an eyebrow before she grins. They could always apologise to Scorpia later if they made a mess. " *I'm going to have to clear out a drawer for your rainbow strap* ."Adora laughs at that before she carries Catra over to the couch. She places her down there for the time being. They had all day , Adora planned to make the most of it, celebrating the fact that they were going to *live* together next year. Adora was beyond excited for that. But, for now, she was going to kiss Catra as much as she pleased and have some fun with her.

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Autumn

Catra sighs as she brushes a strand of her hair behind her ear and out of her face. She was leaning against the counter of the coffee shop she worked at part time, sketching away in her sketchbook. Outside the leaves were turning orange, littering the ground in a patchwork of orange, red and yellow that was beautiful to look at. Catra had about two hours of her shift left to go and it was going pretty slow. The sun was setting a little outside, dousing everything in a pretty orange glow. Catra keeps her attention on her sketchbook, drawing the most familiar thing to her in the entire world.

"Catra," Kyle calls and Catra looks over at him. "Your girlfriend is here." He says. Catra smiles a little. Her *girlfriend*. She walks over to him, telling him that she'd handle it and her smile only gets brighter when she sees Adora's pretty pretty face.

Adora is wearing her letterman jacket with her white hoodie under it, she's wearing her high-waisted blue jeans and those god forsaken canvas sneakers. Her hair is pulled up into her classic ponytail, her undercut freshly shaved. She's smiling happily, bouncing a little on her feet when she sees Catra appear in front of her. The sight of her, her clothes, *everything*, has Catra feeling like she's being smacked in the face with nostalgia. Suddenly, it feels like a year ago when they first met, except this time she can kiss Adora.

That's exactly what Catra does, she reaches her hands out and grabs the front of Adora's hoodie to drag her in for a kiss. She hears Adora let out a noise of satisfaction when their lips meet and the blonde melts into it so easily. Catra smiles into the kiss. Adora so often becomes like warm metal when under Catra's lips and hands: soft, malleable, waiting to be shaped and bent, whatever and however Catra wants her to be. Catra loves kissing Adora, it's easily become one of her favourite activities.

When Catra pulls back, Adora has a dopey smile on her lips. They stay like that for a moment, inches apart from each other's lips until Catra takes a step back. Adora brings her hands up to sign to Catra. "*Is that how you greet all customers?*" She asks and Catra rolls her eyes fondly.

“ *Only the cute ones* ,”Catra teases, winking at her girlfriend. “ *The usual* ?”Catra asks and Adora nods at her . Catra gestures for Adora to follow her as she moves down to where the drinks were prepared. *What is it with gay people and iced coffee?* Catra smiles a little as she sets about beginning to prepare the drink. Adora is watching her closely.

The blonde leans over the counter and picks Catra’s sketchbook up. Catra doesn't really care anymore, Adora knows that Catra draws her, she’s even posed for a few of them - and by posed, Catra means mostly when she’s naked, lying beside her in bed, post-sex. Funny how that inspires Catra. Adora makes a sound and holds the book up, grinning. Catra glances at it, blushing a little. So maybe she had been missing Adora and had started drawing her from when she'd watched her soccer practice the other day . What about it? *You’re really good* .”Adora signs. Adora knows Catra can't take compliments very well.

Catra takes her book back, giving Adora a look, but that doesn't even make a dent in Adora’s positivity. She sits down on the side of the counter, closer to Catra and Catra raises an eyebrow as she finishes making the latte. She pours it over ice and then adds more ice. This time, unlike the first time, Catra writes Adora’s name on her cup, and puts a heart next to it, before she does a little doodle of herself on there too. She hands the cup to Adora who smiles happily at it. She places the latte down for the time being. “ *Thank you* ,”She signs. “ *I missed you* .”

“ *You saw me this morning* .”Catra points out.

“*And I still miss you*.”Adora signs again and Catra chuckles a little. She leans against the counter, moving closer to Adora’s face. She wants to kiss her again, she *always* wants to kiss Adora. Instead, they just gently bump their noses against each other in an affectionate way. “*I’ll see you at home*?”Adora asks. Catra sighs. She wishes Adora could stay, but she knows that Adora has work to do and it wouldn't be fair of her to keep her .

“Yeah,”Catra says. “ *See you at home* .”Catra confirms. *Home* . They have a home together . Sure, that apartment will only be their home so long as they're both still students, and then they'll have to leave, but it’s home all the same. Catra thinks that she could be anywhere;so long as she has Adora, she has her home.

Adora leans forward and pecks her on her lips, bringing Catra back to the present. She watches as the blonde picks up her cup again. “ *Hey Catra* ,”Adora signs and Catra looks up at her . “ *I like you a latte* .”Adora holds her cup up and it is so clear that she is so incredibly proud of that pun that Catra just can't stop herself from laughing at it.

Dork . Catra is pretty sure she’s going to marry Adora one day.

“ *I love you a latte* ,”Catra signs back. She has never seen Adora smile so widely before. It feels good to be here with Adora. Catra feels complete. She’s going to graduate, get her degree, go to law school and then start practising law for real. Adora is going to graduate, get her degree, go to med school and start practising medicine. They have the rest of their lives ahead of them and Catra is honoured that they have it ahead of them together.

“ *I love you too* .”Adora signs back to her before she takes a sip of her drink. She makes a ‘mmm’ sound and Catra laughs. “ *You’re good at everything you do* .”

“ *Get out of here before I kick your ass* .”Catra signs, blushing. Yeah, she still hasn’t learnt to take a compliment in the last five minutes. Adora laughs out loud before she holds her hands up and retreats, exiting the coffee shop. Catra couldn’t wipe the smile off of her face even if she tried. She’s happy. Adora makes her the happiest she’s ever been, and that wasn’t going to change anytime soon.

‘ *I like you a latte* ’ Adora had signed. What a huge fucking dork, but she was *Catra’s* dork and the sound of Adora’s laughter was going to warm Catra’s chest for the rest of her shift until she could go home and snuggle up in Adora’s arms. Catra was wholly and completely in love with Adora, and she always would be. She’d found her life partner, and to think it all started right here, in this coffee shop. You just couldn’t make this stuff up.

Chapter End Notes

> And that's a wrap! I've already expressed how much I loved writing this fic, but it really has been something I've loved writing start to finish. It's a love letter . It's just me being a big pining lesbian dkjsfhkjs the amount of comments I got saying 'this makes me want a girlfriend', or something along those lines, is just like, yeah! Me too! dkfdkfejf That's pretty much what this fic is: just me pining for this kind of love. Their love is just so,,, incredible, and I'm kind of glad I made people desire their love because that's really all it's about. This fic has been a fluff-fest from start to finish for that reason, and there's been little to no

conflict, and it's just... them, college age, like me, finding love. It really is just me pining, my god dkfjhds I'm kidding (kind of).

I want to say thank you for all the kudos and the comments (again), they've been the best. Please feel free to leave comments and/or kudos for this chapter, I'll definitely try to respond to all comments at some point. Otherwise, you can find me on twitter (with M) @coolordadora and my tumblr has changed to shitterasswords !!

I have future fics planned, so you will definitely see more of me :) However, the current plan is to complete Lord Adora before committing to a new project (just in case any of you were worried). Anyway, Happy New Year everyone. May 2022 be better and gayer than any other year ;)

End Notes

Sorry for any spelling and/or grammar mistakes :)! See you next time! Feel free to leave comments and/or kudos and come say hi on twitter @colordadora

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!